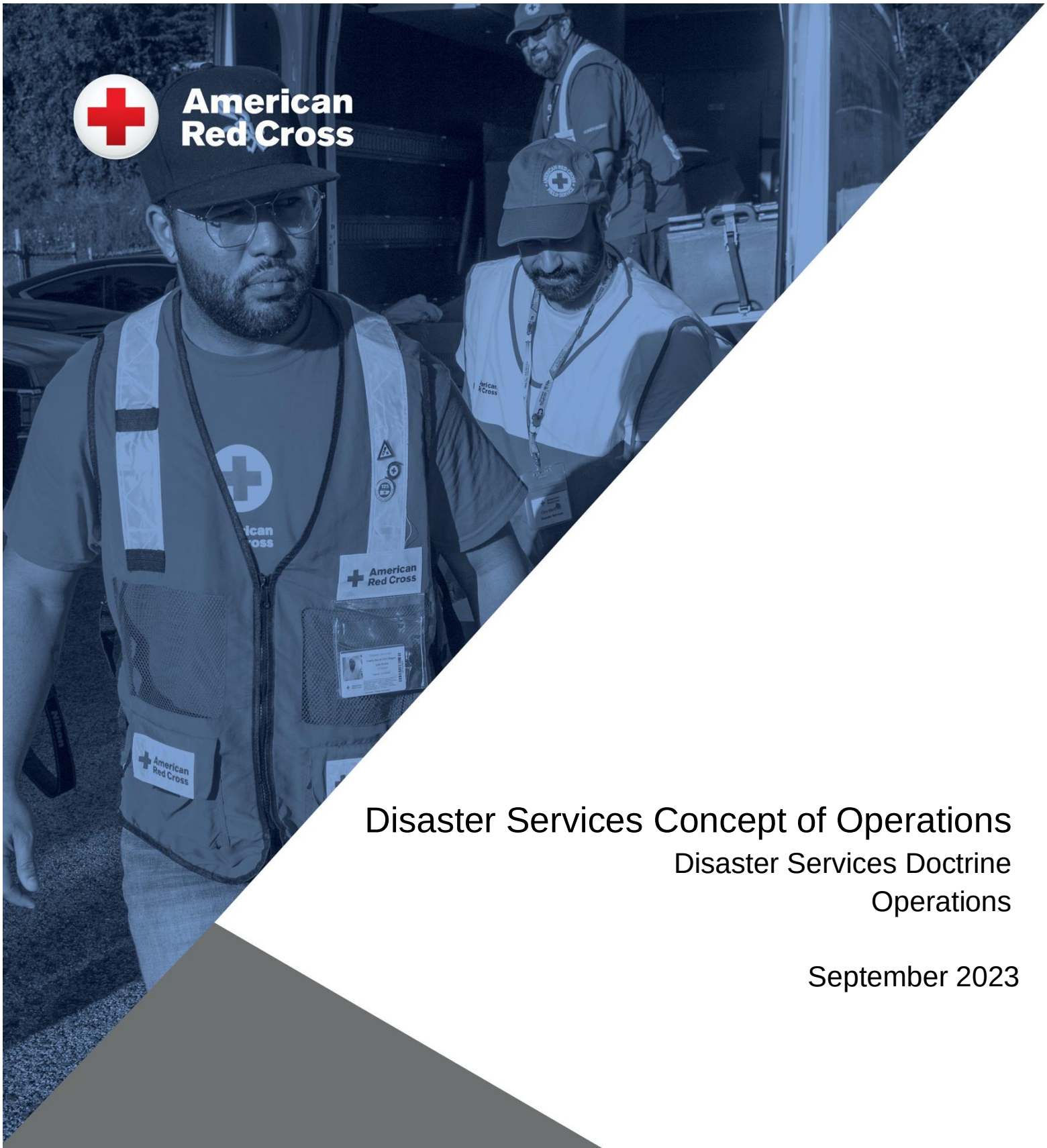


Disaster Services Concept of Operations

Disaster Services Doctrine

Operations

September 2023

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CHANGE LOG

The table below outlines the major content changes in this version of the Concept of Operations. Please participate in a Concept of Operations 5.0: What's Changed offering for more details about the differences between Version 4.0 and Version 5.0. This list is not a substitute for reading the updated doctrine.

Chapter	Document Section	Change
1	Disaster Services Vision	Added language about the Disaster Services 5-year vision plan and priorities
1	Commanders' Intent	Added language from the FY23 Seasonal Readiness materials about commanders' intent for operations, the workforce
2	Field Structure of the Red Cross	Updated division and region maps
2	Table of Operational Authority and Responsibility	Updated authority for Level 4 operations
2	Care and Safety of the Workforce	Updated list of responsibilities for caring for the workforce (several mentions throughout document)
3	Operations Section	Reflect new scope of Client Care programs
3	Operations Section	Added new Deputy Assistant Director Operations
3	Logistics Section	Added new Fulfillment activity
3	External Relations Section	Updated descriptions of External Relations section and activities
3	Long-Term Recovery Operation Structure	Added high-level information about long-term recovery operations
4	Performance Management Against Plan	Added new definition and description of the Performance Management Against Plan (PMAP) framework
5	Trailered Inventory Packages	Added descriptions for Cots, Comfort Kits, Blankets (CCB) trailer and Clean-Up Kit (CUK) trailer
5	Disaster Services Technology Responsibilities	Edited definition of DST responsibilities to reflect recent changes
5	Types of Systems and Financial Instruments	Added mention of the DOCC Portal, Shelter Client Information App (SCIA) and Disaster Current Operations Report
5	Scaling Up a DRO	Added information about RVSO support for DEBVs
6	Division Level Operations	Moved description of Level 4 operations to National level
6	Division Level Operations	Added triggers for the DRO Pet Liaison, DRO DAT Liaison, and DRO Call Center Liaison
6	National Level Operations	Added information about the adjudication of staff assignments for National operations
6	Organizing Service Delivery on Large Operations	Included requirement that VPOL approve any use of districts
6	Organizing Service Delivery on Large Operations	Introduced the differences between zones and districts, when to use zones/districts, and the appointment of Zone Coordinators
6	Large Disaster Relief Operation Support Mechanisms	Introduced Mobilization Center, including definition, triggers, and staffing
7	National Command & General Staff	Added definition of National Command & General Staff

7	Disaster Workforce Engagement	Added responsibilities for Disaster Workforce Engagement
7	DRO Director	Updated reporting line for DRO Director in National operations, responsibility for overseeing EOLN, and accountability for DRO Work Evaluations
7	DRO DAT Liaison	Added responsibilities for the new DRO DAT Liaison position assignment
7	Community Adaptation Program Liaison	Added responsibilities for the new Community Adaptation Program Liaison position assignment
7	Deputy AD Operations	Added responsibilities for the new Deputy AD Operations position assignment
7	Zone Coordinator	Updated the Itinerating Deputy AD Response responsibilities to reflect the new title of Zone Coordinator and shifted reporting line
7	Mass Care Chief	Added responsibilities of the Deputy AD Response to the Mass Care Chief to reflect shift in Operations Section structure
7	DRO Pet Liaison	Added responsibilities for the new DRO Pet Liaison position assignment
7	Client Care Chief	Edited the Deputy AD Recovery responsibilities to reflect that these are now held by the new role of Client Care Chief
7	DRO Call Center Liaison	Added responsibilities for the new DRO Call Center Liaison position assignment
7	Elected Official Liaison Network	Updated definitions and reporting line

CHAPTER 1 – INTRODUCTION: CONOPS / RED CROSS

Chapter 1 Topics

- Document Purpose, Applicability, and Organization
- Mission and Vision
- Commanders' Intent
- Volunteer Powered
- National Readiness Target

Document Purpose, Applicability, and Organization

ConOps: Purpose

The Disaster Services *Concept of Operations* (*ConOps*):

- Is a standardized management tool for meeting the demands of Red Cross disaster relief operations of all types and sizes; and
- Establishes a framework that enables effective and efficient operational management within a common organizational structure.

The *Concept of Operations* describes how the Red Cross organizes its people and activities to serve Red Cross clients. The ConOps is intended to enable consistent, timely, high-quality, and compassionate service to clients.

ConOps: Applicability and Audience

The Concept of Operations applies to:

- All incidents and disaster relief operations from Disaster Action Team (Level 1) to large-scale (Levels 5-7).
- All Red Cross Disaster leaders and managers at regional, divisional, and national levels involved in planning, establishing, scaling, sustaining, and demobilizing disaster relief operations.

Mission and Vision

Mission Statement

The Red Cross prevents and alleviates human suffering in the face of emergencies by mobilizing the power of volunteers and the generosity of donors.

Fundamental Principles

The Red Cross movement is founded on the tireless pursuit of seven Fundamental Principles. The principles provide the decision framework for all service delivery and inspire the purpose behind our mission.

Table 1.1: Fundamental Principles

Fundamental Principle	Meaning
Humanity	The Red Cross, born of a desire to bring assistance without discrimination to the wounded on the battlefield, endeavors—in its international and national capacity—to prevent and alleviate human suffering wherever it may be found. Its purpose is to protect life and health and to ensure respect for the human being. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation, and lasting peace amongst all peoples.
Impartiality	It makes no discrimination as to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class, or political opinions. It endeavors to relieve the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by their needs, and to give priority to the most urgent cases of distress.
Neutrality	In order to continue to enjoy the confidence of all, the Red Cross may not take sides in hostilities or engage at any time in controversies of a political, racial, religious, or ideological nature.
Independence	The Red Cross is independent. The national societies, while auxiliaries in the humanitarian services of their governments and subject to the laws of their respective countries, must always maintain their autonomy so that they may be able at all times to act in accordance with Red Cross principles.
Voluntary Service	The Red Cross is a voluntary relief movement not prompted in any manner by desire for gain.
Unity	There can be only one Red Cross society in any one country. It must be open to all. It must carry on its humanitarian work throughout its territory.
Universality	The Red Cross is a worldwide institution in which all societies have equal status and share equal responsibilities and duties in helping each other.

Red Cross Values

The American Red Cross has established values that are essential to our continued success. These values drive how we accomplish our goals and conduct ourselves to execute and achieve our Strategic Journey.

Table 1.2: Red Cross Values (Five C's)

Value	Meaning
Compassionate	We are dedicated to improving the lives of those we serve and to treating each other with care and respect.
Collaborative	We work together as One Red Cross family, in partnership with other organizations, and always embrace diversity and inclusiveness

Creative	We seek new ideas, are open to change and always look for better ways to serve those in need.
Credible	We act with integrity, are transparent guardians of the public trust, and honor our promises.
Committed	We hold ourselves accountable for defining and meeting clear objectives, delivering on our mission, and carefully stewarding our donor funds.

One Red Cross

We are one Red Cross. Those who serve the Red Cross share one mission statement and follow a common vision and Fundamental Principles. Volunteers and employees work together as one Red Cross family, in partnership with other organizations, and always embrace diversity and inclusiveness.

The Red Cross does more than shelter, feed, and provide emotional support to disaster clients. The Red Cross also collects and distributes lifesaving blood products, teaches skills that save lives, provides international humanitarian aid, and supports military members and their families. The entire workforce brings together diverse backgrounds and skills, united by a shared passion for the mission—to prevent and alleviate suffering in the face of emergencies. By leveraging the resources and passion of the entire enterprise, the organization and its partners create greater efficiencies, increase collaboration, and become better stewards of donor dollars.

Disaster Services Vision

Changes in our climate have driven disasters from being an episodic or acute part of American life to a chronic condition that both exacerbates and is exacerbated by other chronic social conditions.

The increasingly complex relief and recovery needs of communities on the front line of the climate crisis have accelerated the demand for American Red Cross services and require a compelling vision for how together we will build our capacity and adapt our work.

The visual accompanying this text depicts what the successful implementation of our vision looks like between 2023 and 2028. Our vision begins with people, all kinds of different people, from all walks of life. Some are volunteers, some are partners, and some are disaster survivors, but the center of our vision is community. Our vision rests on three strategic priorities supported by five core actions.

Our three strategic priorities are in the center of our vision: Be the most trusted disaster relief provider, move our service delivery from equality to equity, and ensure that every encounter with a client transcends the transactional and achieves the transformational.

Becoming the most trusted disaster relief partner in all communities, not just some communities, is our destination. Whether we're talking about communities, neighborhoods, non-government partners, government partners, employees, volunteers, and survivors, we are striving to be the most trusted disaster relief provider everywhere, and we know that takes work. We know that focusing on readiness & capacity building and simplifying our training and how individuals volunteer with us will be key to us achieving our vision.

Our second strategic priority is moving our service delivery from equality to equity. We want to prioritize identifying and connecting with those who have the greatest unmet need. Keep in mind to do that, we need to know our communities and have access to them, we need to utilize data and we need locally based information around impacts. The foundational understanding about how communities want to connect with the Red Cross will be critical, if we're going to move from equality to equity. To achieve this vision, we will focus on improving access to services and resources for all as well as being physically present and seen in our communities.

Our third and final strategic priority is ensuring that every encounter with a client transcends the merely transactional to achieve the transformational. Looking at our recent past, we have built and focused on platforms and software to try and speed up the process to get folks access to the financial resources that they need. While speed to need is important because help can't wait, the transaction of providing disaster survivors with emergency supplies, shelter, or financial assistance does not necessarily change or transform a poor recovery outcome for a disaster survivor: we want to change that dynamic so that we can truly empower our clients to recover. Understanding that access to safe, available, and affordable housing, providing access to partners who provide both mental and physical health care, and providing food to our food insecure families is key to providing meaningful help to our impacted communities.

We believe that if we can alleviate the barriers that are facing most of the individuals and families that need our help in those three areas, then that will make a huge difference in how people recover from disasters of all sizes when they cannot return home.

Commanders' Intent

Commanders' Intent for Operations

The Red Cross provides compassionate, thoughtful, and equitable care for individuals and families impacted by a disaster. "Equitable" means that everyone is welcome to Red Cross services, and we prioritize serving those with the greatest need first. We translate equity into operational outcomes by:

- Rapidly learning, understanding, and mapping the conditions and needs of affected communities, and prioritizing service delivery to those most negatively impacted; and
- Reducing the duration of shelter stays through timely, empathetic, and data-driven casework that provides our clients with access to the most capable resources and partners needed to overcome their most challenging recovery barriers; and
- Improving conditions for those who are displaced and help those who can safely remain in their homes do so; and
- Advocating and empowering our clients' agency to respond to and recover from disaster; and
- Preventing clients displaced by disasters from falling into or deeper into poverty through excellent casework and case management, even after they leave our shelters.

Commanders' Intent for Our Workforce

Our workforce:

- Feels respected and valued
- Conducts meaningful service delivery
- Makes a positive impact on the lives of our clients.

Commanders' Intent for our Clients

Our clients receive compassionate care from every Red Cross worker.

Commanders' Intent for Our Partners

Our partners:

- Understand what we do,
- Appreciate our value, and
- Welcome us to the table.

The Red Cross:

- Understands what our partners do,
- Appreciates their value, and
- Helps our clients access our partners' resources and services.

Volunteer Powered

Volunteer Powered

As the Mission Statement above makes clear, the Red Cross is a volunteer-powered and volunteer-led organization. The Red Cross workforce, primarily comprised of volunteers, is the organization's most important asset. Volunteers constitute the vast majority of Red Cross's disaster workforce, and by contributing their unique and diverse backgrounds, talents, and skill levels, make it possible for Red Cross to respond to more than 60,000 domestic disasters every year.

"Volunteer-powered" means it is a priority to act with intent to recruit, train, and retain volunteer leaders and workforce members for all operational levels and functions. All roles and functions in Disaster Services operations can and should be performed by volunteers, and it is everyone's job, whether volunteer or employee, to create and improve conditions for our workforce in lead and support successful disaster relief operations.

The Red Cross is fortunate to have a diversity of volunteers who want to participate, including partner volunteers, event-based volunteers, and corporate volunteers, each one interested in devoting time and energy to the Red Cross and the community. All volunteers are equal and should receive the same exceptional experience.

National Readiness Target

National Readiness Target

The Red Cross maintains the operational capability to provide services, especially mass care services, to people affected by disasters across the United States and its territories. To respond to disasters using the standards our clients and donors deserve, the Red Cross must sustain the capacity and capability to accomplish its mission in coordination with our partners.

Within the Red Cross organizational structure, the region is the primary organizational level responsible for readiness and service delivery to our communities. A region's ability to conduct successful disaster relief operations is proportional to its ability to maintain a baseline level of operational readiness prior to disaster. This readiness includes:

- Availability of trained people;
- Accessible infrastructure, programs, and systems;
- Availability of necessary supplies (including vehicles);
- The relationships of a supportive community.

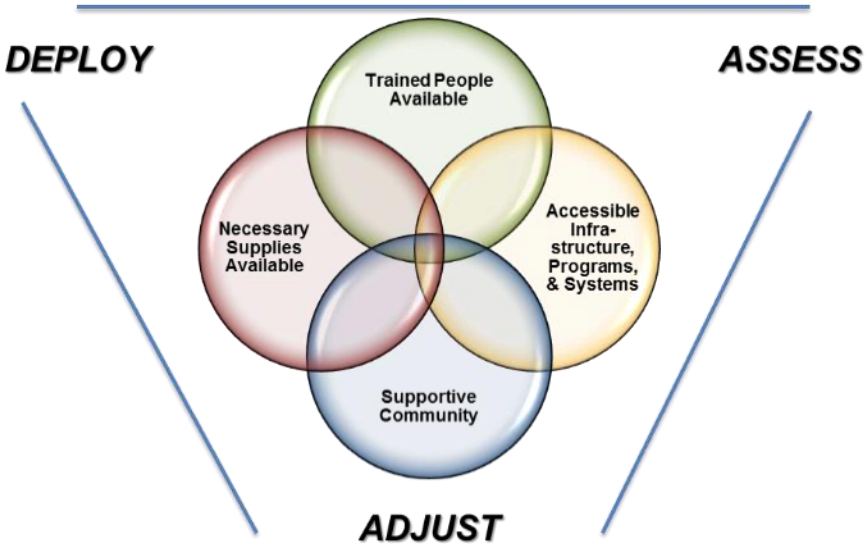


Figure 1.1: Readiness Elements

Readiness means the Red Cross has the right resources in the right place at the right time. The National Readiness Target (NRT) provides data, information, and accountability for resources in each of the four elements of readiness needed for us to respond to high probability risks in the communities we serve.

CHAPTER 2 – INTRODUCTORY CONCEPTS

Chapter 2 Topics

- What is the *Concept of Operations?*
- Field Structure of the Red Cross
- Accountability and Operational Authorities
- Incident Complexity and Levels of Disaster
- Guiding Principles for All Disaster Relief Operations
- Communication on Disaster Relief Operations

What is the Concept of Operations?

ConOps: Common Incident Management Framework

The *Concept of Operations (ConOps)* is a common incident management framework (adapted from the Incident Command System) for all Disaster Services disaster relief operations based on incident complexity. The *ConOps* is used for a broad spectrum of short-term and long-term disaster relief operations, ranging from a single- and multi-family fire response to a catastrophic incident relief operation.

ConOps: Standardized Methods and Structures

The *ConOps* standardizes the methodology and operational structures for organizing and managing the resources, capabilities, and capacities available to the Red Cross to accomplish its mission.

ConOps: Establishes and Explains Organizational Levels

The *ConOps* establishes three organizational levels (regional, divisional, and national operations), and a structure for each, with the goal of achieving:

- **Speed to need**: Arrival of initial resources and delivery of service at the point of greatest vulnerability and need;
- **Speed to scale**: Sustainable escalation and replenishment of growing operations to the meet the scale of need.

This doctrine provides the guidance needed to ensure an efficient and effective operation of those structures, including how to activate, expand, transition, and demobilize, as well as guidance on coordination, resourcing, and reporting.

ConOps: Defines Roles and Relationships

The *ConOps* defines the roles and positions of the participants and stakeholders involved in Red Cross disaster relief operations, including links with leadership at the regional, divisional, and national levels. It also demonstrates the baseline expectations for scaling Red Cross disaster relief operations.

ConOps: Strategic Framework for Operations

The *ConOps* establishes a strategic framework for ensuring:

- Equitable, inclusive service to clients;
- A workforce that is trained, engaged, and cared for;
- Partnerships that are developed and sustained across the disaster cycle.

It is intended to empower frontline leaders to make decisions and execute actions in the best interest of the individuals, families, and communities served in alignment with the strategic and operational priorities and objectives of the Red Cross.

This strategy is:

- Focused on service to clients and communities;
- Based on local knowledge of communities, volunteers, and relationships;
- Grounded in engagement of and collaboration with partners, community groups, leaders, and businesses, and community mobilization;
- Aligned with partners at every level of government;
- Supplemented and scalable with locally, regionally, and nationally available Red Cross and partner human, material, technological, and managerial resources.

ConOps Summary

Each of the concepts below is covered in greater detail throughout the document.

Every Red Cross disaster relief operation delivers service and receives a designated organizational level based on incident complexity. The three organizational levels are:

- Regional level
- Division level
- National level

Each organizational level builds on a modular structure adapted from the widely used Incident Command System (ICS), which integrates human and material resources, facilities, procedures, and communications within a common organizational framework and incorporates the activities of seven major functional areas:

- Command
- Operations
- Information & Planning
- Logistics
- Workforce
- Finance
- External Relations

The Red Cross workforce performs activities in every functional area on every disaster relief operation. The *ConOps* provides the framework for those activities to be consistent, effective, and efficient whether they are being performed by employees or volunteers, two people or 2,000 people, or directly by trusted partners.

Regions maintain the lead role in accomplishing routine day-to-day operational activity, with the divisions and national headquarters playing a support and oversight role, augmenting regions as needed, and assuming command for the most complex incidents.

Within the regions (at the chapter and territory level), Disaster Action Teams (DAT) respond to single-family and multi-family fires and localized events. Each of these is considered a regional-level response, and Disaster Action Teams are the first building block for disaster relief operations.

Operational accountability elevates to the division as complexity and cost increases. This typically happens in response to large multi-family fires, floods, tornadoes, wildfires, and hurricanes, among other disasters.

The largest and most complex operations are managed and led at the national level.

Regardless of the size of the operation, Disaster Services executes an orderly process to demobilize resources and smoothly transition operational control to the accountable region after completing ongoing, large-scale service delivery.

At all levels of operations:

- Responders follow a set of guiding principles and a common planning architecture to inform decision-making and performance;
- Division disaster staff provides operational coordination, oversight, and support across their respective divisions;
- National Command and General Staff provide operational coordination, oversight, and support across the entire organization;
- Disaster Services national headquarters and divisional staff are available to provide programmatic guidance and support.

Field Structure of the Red Cross

Field Structure: Divisions

Our field structure is divided into six divisions, each led by a Division Vice President (DVP), who is accountable to the President of Humanitarian Services for ensuring all elements of the division perform Disaster Services functions effectively and efficiently and achieve approved goals.

Every division has a Division Disaster Leadership Team led by a Division Disaster Executive (DDE), who is accountable to the Division Vice President for leading and managing the implementation of Disaster Services throughout the division. This includes working across all lines of service to coordinate resource support and activities during periods of response (primarily Service to the Armed Forces and Biomedical Services).

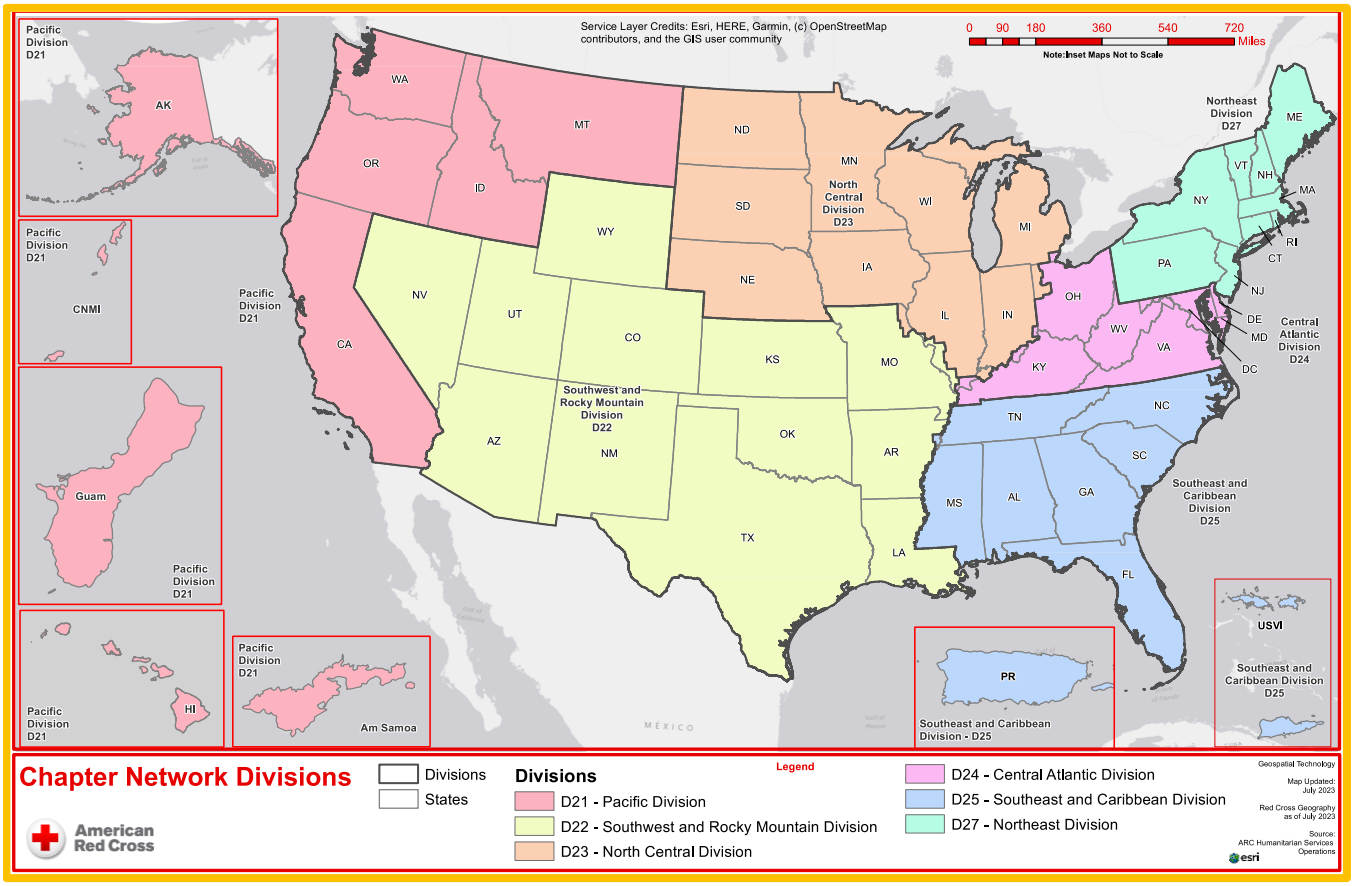


Figure 2.1: Division Structure of the Red Cross

Field Structure: Regions

The six divisions are further divided into regions and chapters, with each region having at least one chapter. Some chapters are divided into “territories,” or Disaster Action Team response areas, which are geographically defined response areas that do not cross or overlap regional borders and may align with chapter jurisdictions.

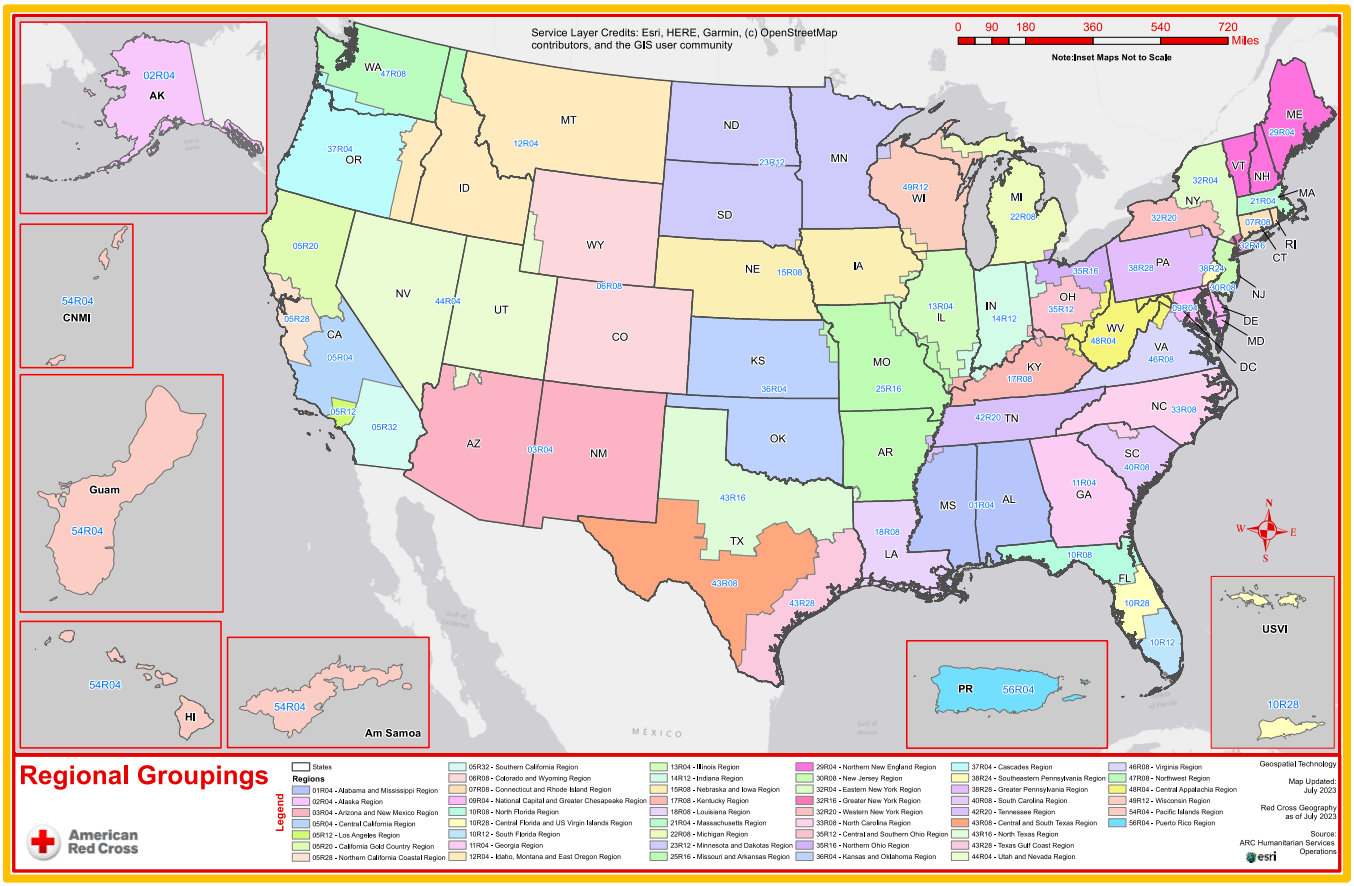


Figure 2.2: Region Structure of the Red Cross

A Regional Executive (RE) leads each region and is accountable to the Division Vice President for ensuring, in coordination with the division's disaster response and steady-state leadership, that the region performs Disaster Services functions effectively and achieves approved goals.

Every region has a Regional Disaster Leadership Team led by a Regional Disaster Officer (RDO), who is accountable to the Regional Executive for leading and managing the implementation of Disaster Services programs in the region. Every region has one or more disaster response areas, led by a geographic Disaster Program Manager or Specialist (DPx). This DPx is responsible for engaging volunteers and mobilizing the community in the delivery of all DCS programs in their assigned geography, along with capacity building. Each disaster response area may have one or more DAT response areas, responsible for the hyper-local focus on the individual community. The geographic team aligns by county with assigned Executive Director and/or Community Volunteer Leader.

This geographic team is supported by functional Disaster Program Managers and Specialists who provide operational, technical, and administrative support at the geographic or regional level across the region. Although disaster volunteers and other resources may be positioned or used within the region or local area, the

Regional Disaster Officer (or designee) directs the operational deployment and use of all assigned disaster resources. Regions are accountable for:

- Region program delivery as outlined in the Key Elements document;
- The capacity and capability for readiness (according to the National Readiness Target) to resource divisional and national-level operations as directed; and
- Initating services based on speed to need in their local community.

Mission Essential Functions

Mission-essential functions are:

- DCS functions directly related to accomplishing the Red Cross mission;
- The framework for all disaster operation resource adjudication and decision-making.

DCS prioritizes the mission-essential functions listed below to ensure resources are allocated, adjudicated, and used appropriately. When faced with limited resources and/or competing operational demands, national headquarters, divisions, and regions must prioritize the readiness for and execution of MEF-1 above MEF-2, MEF-2 above MEF-3, and MEF-3 above functions or activities not listed.

Rank	Mission-Essential Function (MEF)
MEF-1	Providing life-sustaining emergency shelter/lodging in response to disaster (including Disaster Action Team operations). MEF-1 missions take priority over all other missions. MEF-2 and/or MEF-3 missions must not affect the local region's capacity to fully execute MEF-1 and readiness to respond to larger events locally and nationally.
MEF-2	Supporting Red Cross Biomedical Services to ensure the availability of the nation's blood supply.
MEF-3	Providing life-sustaining mass care services (other than emergency shelter) — only in the event of a critical gap that cannot be filled by other available partners.

Accountability and Operational Authorities

Accountability and Authorities Required for All Operations

As incident complexity increases, more senior leaders and managers engage to provide operational management and oversight. (See Incident Complexity and Levels of Disaster below for more information.) As listed above, the three organizational levels are:

- Regional level
- Division level
- National level

This section defines accountability and the five types of authority exercised at all organizational levels and on every operation. The *ConOps* assigns these authorities in different positions depending on the organizational level of the operation.

Accountability Definition

An individual who is accountable, has overall responsibility, and is answerable for the performance and results of an operation, program, function, or activity. Accountability cannot be delegated. Accountable individuals can delegate responsibility for activities to others, but remain accountable. Only one person can be accountable for a specific result.

Budgetary Financial Approval Authority Definition

Budgetary approval authority is the ability to authorize a disaster relief operation to make commitments and expenditures up to the dollar amounts specified in the field operations budget (*Statistical and Cost Report of Disaster Operation, Form 2066*). The field operations budget sets the direction for and assists operations leadership in managing the incremental costs of a disaster relief operation.

An individual who has been assigned financial authority is accountable for approving the field operations budget and ensuring alignment with the Service Delivery Plan (SDP). In most cases, individuals with budgetary approval authority as designated in Section 7.1a of the Financial Manual of Policies and Procedures (FMPP) may be, but are not limited to the:

- Regional Executive;
- Division Disaster Executive;
- Vice President, Disaster Programs; or
- Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics

This fiscal authority may be delegated in writing as outlined in the *Financial Manual of Policies and Procedures (FMPP)*. The list of those with budgetary (or Service Delivery Plan) approval authority is in the *Disaster Relief Operations Planning Standards and Procedures*, available on the Information & Planning Toolkit on OneSource. Until such time as the *Disaster Relief Operations Planning Standards and Procedures* is updated, if there are any discrepancies between the two documents, this *Concept of Operations* contains the most up-to-date standards and procedures to be followed.

Transactional Financial Approval Authority Definition

Financial transaction approval authority, also listed in Section 7.1a of the Financial Manual of Policies and Procedures (FMPP), is the ability to authorize a disaster relief operation to make a particular expenditure or commitment. It is a requirement built into Red Cross purchasing systems for all individual purchases made on operations. Purchasing systems include:

- Coupa;

- Purchase-cards (P-cards) and Mass Care Procurement Cards (MCPC);
- Concur Invoice/Travel (post-transaction).

Financial approval authority levels sometimes vary based on the tools or system used. The sum of all transactions must stay within the approved field operations budget.

Operational Responsibility Definition

An individual who has been assigned operational responsibility develops and implements the Service Delivery Plan (or oversees its development) and ensures its alignment with the approved budget. This individual is responsible for efficient and effective delivery of services to clients and communities.

Individuals providing operational responsibility are responsible for ensuring the operation meets standards set within Disaster Services doctrine. Individuals with operational responsibility should communicate with program support to identify strategies when standards may not be met or to seek clarity on technical or programmatic guidance. Depending on the organizational level of the operation, the individual with operational responsibility is usually the:

- Disaster Action Team Supervisor;
- Disaster Action Team Duty Officer;
- Senior Disaster Program Manager;
- Disaster Program Manager or Specialist;
- Regional Disaster Officer; or
- DRO Director.

Programmatic Support Definition

Programmatic support involves a wide range of tasks performed by individuals and teams to assist the Red Cross disaster workforce with the application of Disaster Services doctrine. This includes applying analytical and evaluative techniques to issues or situations concerning the efficiency and effectiveness of program operations. Programmatic support staff recommends job tools and other resources, provides program strategies, and interprets program doctrine and standards. Depending on the size and scope of the operation, individuals or entities who can provide programmatic support include:

- Regional disaster functional support;
- Division disaster workforce;
- National headquarters program and activity leads.

Published doctrine articulates how Red Cross programs are implemented. If situations arise that are not addressed by published doctrine, disaster relief operation leadership contacts the national headquarters program leads for consultation and approval. National headquarters may issue doctrine bulletins to address gaps in doctrine or to articulate an approved adjustment to a program.

Oversight and Management Definition

An individual with oversight and management responsibility assumes overall authority for an operation and is responsible for the coordination of operational assets and for overseeing the operational strategy within guardrails articulated by Disaster Services doctrine. These individuals, including their designees, as appropriate, are accountable for ensuring operations under their authority meet standards set within Disaster Services doctrine. Depending on the size and scope of the operation, individuals designated to have oversight and management responsibility include the:

- Division Disaster Director;
- Division Disaster Executive;
- Red Cross Coordinating Officer;
- Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics;

The oversight and management official cannot also serve as the official with operational responsibility.

Table of Operational Authority and Responsibility

Table 2.1 summarizes accountability and the types of authority exercised at all organizational levels on every operation. The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics retains ongoing oversight and management at all levels of operation.

Table 2.1: Operational Authority and Responsibility

Operation Level	Regional Operations (Levels 1 & 2)	Divisional Level 3	National Level 4	National Operations (Levels 5-7)
Budgetary Authority	< $10K: RDO < $50K: RE	< $250K: DDE	< $2.5M: VP, Disaster Ops & Log[1]	≤ $10M: VP, Disaster Ops & Log ≤ $20M: President, Humanitarian Services[1] ≥ $20M: CEO[2]
Transactional Financial Authority	Per the existing regional approval chain[3]	< $25K: DDD < $250K: DDE/ RCCO	< $1M: VP, Disaster Ops & Log	≤ $5M: VP, Disaster Ops & Log < $10M: President, HS >$10M: CEO
Operational Responsibility	RDO or designee	DRO Director	DRO Director	DRO Director
Programmatic Support	Division Disaster Leadership Team or regional designees	National Headquarters Program Staff	National Headquarters Program Staff	National Headquarters Program Staff
Oversight and Management	DDE	DDE	VP, Disaster Ops & Log	VP, Disaster Ops & Log

[1] In these cases, the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics is accountable for ensuring day-to-day alignment between the approved budget and the Service Delivery Plan.
[2] No email approval is required from the CEO. CEO approval means the CEO is briefed on the budget plan and can provide direction verbally of approval or required adjustments.
[3] Level 1 and 2 DRO Transaction Authority is established in FMPP 1.1.

DDD: Division Disaster Director
DDE: Division Disaster Executive
RCCO: Red Cross Coordinating Officer
RE: Regional Executive
RDO: Regional Disaster Officer

Standard Transactions Not in Approved Budget

Any transaction that is not within the Service Delivery Plan (SDP) requires a revison to the Service Delivery Plan. The budget must then be updated to include the transaction and submitted for re-approval following the normal budgeting process.

Table 2.2: Transactions Outside Approved Budget

	< $25K	< $250K	< $1M	< $5M	< $10M	> $10M
Division-Led DROs	DDE/ RCCO	VP, Disaster Ops & Log		Pres, HS	N/A	N/A
National-Led DROs	Executive Director, Disaster Operations Management	VP, Disaster Ops & Log		Pres, HS	COO	CEO

Non-Standard Purchases, Service Agreements, Contracts

Approval is required to commit the Red Cross to provide goods, services, or otherwise make a financial agreement for over $25K. This includes any commitment (including verbal) to financially commit the Red Cross that is not documented on an existing contract or on a Red Cross standard contract template.

- A purchase order, contract, service agreement, and verbal agreement all apply in this context.
- Approval is required according to the rules related to *Table 2.2: Transactions Outside Approved Budget* prior to committing the Red Cross to the expense.
- The DRO Director, as defined by the *ConOps*, has the responsibility to alert the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics of any potential non-standard purchases/contracts. In turn, the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics is responsible for obtaining the required approvals and following the procedures consistent with this section.
- If initiated by national headquarters, the national Assistant Director Logistics has the responsibility to alert the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics who then has the responsibility of obtaining the required approvals and following procedures consistent with this section.
- Any significant non-standard purchase agreement or contingency contract must include the following items:
  - An exit clause to permit immediate termination of the agreement at the sole discretion of the Red Cross;

- Protective limits in the form of not-to-exceed quantities and/or dollar amounts;
- A request for frequent (i.e., weekly, bi-weekly, etc.) informational invoicing;
- A milestone date or dates at which the agreement will terminate unless explicitly re-authorized.

- Any non-standard purchases of more than $25,000, or those that entail high risk, should be executed with a contract and/or a purchase order in the Coupa system with the assistance of Supply Management**.**
  - Supply Management must provide on-call support to the DOCC.
  - Disaster Services provides a deadline to Supply Management for completion of the contract/purchase order and Supply Management enables Disaster Services to meet this deadline, even if it requires escalating the speed of steps in the process.
  - If extenuating circumstances arise, the individual with the transaction authority in the amount of the commitment is empowered to execute a short-term agreement.
    - Exceptions must be justified, and Supply Management must be engaged for the development of a longer-term contract.
  - In all cases, the individual in Disaster Services with budget approval authority on the operation has authority to override Supply Management and execute a contract/purchase order.

Temporary Disaster Employees: Authorities

A temporary disaster employee (TDE) is a worker hired to perform work that lasts for a finite period with no guarantee of ongoing or future employment at the end of the assignment. The following financial guidelines must be followed when hiring temporary disaster employees and apply to any temporary position hired and funded by disaster relief operations:

- Temporary disaster employees cannot be hired for a period of more than one year.
- Approval to hire or extend any TDE must be pre-authorized by the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics regardless of funding source.
- Human Resources is responsible for tracking all the temporary disaster employees on disaster relief operations, including number, name, status, and expense by DR#, as well as sending a weekly report to the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, and Disaster Services Finance.

The National Assistant Director Workforce is responsible for notifying Human Resources of the event and establishing a process to receive the information from Human Resources for dissemination of information as outlined in this section.

Disaster Relief Operation Training Funds

Funds to support training delivery are included in the Disaster Services core budget, including allocations for both readiness and GAP capacity building training. However, if there are specific unmet needs, the Vice President, Disaster

Operations & Logistics may designate an additional allocation from the DRO Training Fund.

- All training funds must be spent by the end of the fiscal year in which they are apportioned.
- Requests for training delivery funds should be directed to Disaster Workforce Readiness, who administers the funds and the budgets.

Incident Complexity and Levels of Disaster

Incident Complexity: Definition

The central principle of the *ConOps* is that incident complexity drives decisions about all aspects of incident management.

An incident's complexity is determined by many factors, including, but not limited to:

- Vulnerability and enhanced risk to those impacted;
- Nature of services and assistance needed to meet client needs;
- Community and responder safety;
- Service delivery strategy and tactics;
- Impacts to life, property, and the economy;
- Values at risk, especially the Red Cross Fundamental Principles;
- Political sensitivities, external influences, and media relations;
- Historical influences and local knowledge;
- Mass casualty incidents;
- Likelihood of cascading events;
- State of the infrastructure within the disaster-affected area;
- Availability of resources;
- Number of clients anticipated and the nature of client needs;
- Number of external organizations and partners engaged;
- Risk of adverse physical or psychological health effects of the workforce;
- Projected costs.

Some of these factors, like projected costs, are objective. Other factors, like political sensitivities, are subjective. Assessing incident complexity requires the application of knowledge and experience, and the exercise of sound judgment.

Initial and continuing assessments of incident complexity help disaster leadership to:

- Assign organizational management and oversight resources calibrated to respond most effectively under the circumstances;
- Plan and project resource requirements and costs.

Incident Complexity with Organizational Levels: Alignment

Disaster leadership uses the three organizational levels—regional, divisional, and national—to assign the organizational authorities and responsibilities commensurate with incident complexity.

These organizational levels are not necessarily aligned with resources. Higher-level operations may not require more people or material resources or cost more, but they do require engagement by appropriate senior leaders to manage the additional organizational risks presented by incidents of greater complexity.

Incident Complexity and Costs: Alignment

As noted above, projected operational costs are one factor in assessing incident complexity. This is because projected operational costs, as derived from a well-informed Service Delivery Plan, account for many (but not all) of an incident's complexity factors. Good operational planning and field budgeting are intertwined and inseparable. See Chapter 4 for more information on the operational planning process and Service Delivery Plans.

Based on the expected field operations budget, leadership assigns one of seven financial levels to each disaster relief operation:

Table 2.3: Financial Levels of Disaster Relief Operations

Expected Field Operations Budget	Financial Level
Less than $10,000	1
$10,000 or more but less than $50,000	2
$50,000 or more but less than $250,000	3
$250,000 or more but less than $2.5 million	4
$2.5 million or more but less than $5 million	5
$5 million or more but less than $10 million	6
More than $10 million	7

Note: The expected field operations budget generally represents only the costs that on-the-ground operational leadership can reasonably control. It does not include all the costs that make a disaster relief operation successful. Budget information may only be communicated externally with the authorization of the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, who coordinates with Disaster Finance, Disaster Fundraising, and Public Affairs to produce a complete public cost estimate.

Incident Complexity, Organization, and Costs: Summary

Summarizing the previous sections regarding complexity, organization, and cost drivers:

- Incident complexity consists of many factors, both objective and subjective.
- The assessment of incident complexity results in assigning specific operational authorities and responsibilities to officials at one of three specific organizational levels—the more complex the incident, the higher the organizational level.
- There are seven fixed financial levels among various operational cost brackets.

- Because cost is typically a good indicator of complexity, the organizational level often increases with the financial level.
- There may, however, be reasons to increase the organizational level without increasing the financial level.

The table below shows the relationship between projected costs, financial levels, and typical organizational levels:

Table 2.4: DRO Levels: Budget, Financial, and Organizational

Expected Field Operations Budget	Financial Level	Typical Organizational Level
Less than $10,000	1	Regional
$10,000 or more but less than $50,000	2	Regional
$50,000 or more but less than $250,000	3	Divisional
$250,000 or more but less than $2.5 million	4	National
$2.5 million or more but less than $5 million	5	National
$5 million or more but less than $10 million	6	National
$10 million or more	7	National

Here is a guide to articulating this relationship:

Financial Level (Number)	Organizational Level (Name)	Disaster Relief Operation (DRO)

For example, using the table above, if the incremental cost of an operation is projected to be $25,000, and if the incident complexity is not identified beyond that reflected in the budget, this is a:

Level 2	Regional	DRO

Or “Level 2 Regional DRO.”

Changing Organizational Levels

Notwithstanding an operation’s actual or projected financial level, Red Cross disaster leaders may elevate the organizational level based on incident complexity factors that may not be well-reflected in the budget as follows.

Table 2.5: Changing Organizational Levels

From	To	Decision-Maker
Regional Level	Division level	Division Disaster Executive
Regional or Division level	National Level	Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics

Changing the organizational level without changing the financial level makes it more important to use a clear disaster relief operation (DRO) description. For example, if the Regional Disaster Officer projects that the incremental cost of an operation will be $25,000, but the Division Disaster Executive identifies incident complexity

beyond that reflected in the budget, (warranting divisional-level leadership and oversight), then disaster leadership would establish a "Level 2 Divisional DRO." The financial level remains the same, but the organizational level changes.

When escalating or de-escalating the organizational level of a disaster, disaster leadership follows the transition procedures in the Process for Escalation including consultation among the leaders affected by the transition. See also the Triggers for Level Escalation.

Accounting for Increased Costs

Officials with budgetary and financial authority and oversight and management responsibility at the designated organizational level (see Table 2.1: Operational Authority and Responsibility):

- Continuously monitor and assess whether increasing, under-estimated, and/or unforeseen costs may be driving the budget projection above the upper cost threshold of the initial financial level, and if appropriate, update the Service Delivery Plan with accompanying *Statistical and Cost Report of Disaster Relief Operation (Form 2066)* if service delivery demands are significantly greater than expected;
- Increase the financial level consistent with those authorized for their organizational level (for example, a Regional Executive may elevate a Level 1 to a Level 2);
- Notify the officials with organizational authorities and responsibilities at the next organizational level if any updated field operations budget approaches within 5 percent of the upper cost threshold of the initial financial level (as when the updated projection for a financial Level 4 operation comes in at or above $2,375,000—that is $125,000, or 5 percent below the $2.5 million upper threshold for financial Level 4 operations).

The official with oversight and management authority at the next highest organizational level increases the organizational and financial levels in instances where such an increase is beyond that of the current officials with budgetary and financial authority.

Mass Casualty Incidents: Special Considerations

Mass casualty incidents can present great complexity and workforce hardship. These incidents are typically multi-agency, high-visibility events involving exposure to severe physical and emotional trauma by witnesses, survivors, victims' families and friends, first responders, relief workers, and the public. These events require immediate, sensitive, efficient, and effective response by the Red Cross and other agencies to mitigate negative consequences.

Any event defined by the government or jurisdictional authority as a mass casualty incident triggers the use of the Mass Casualty Incident Response Guide and associated doctrine and job tools. A mass casualty incident is any incident in which resources of the jurisdiction, such as personnel and equipment, are overwhelmed by the number and severity of casualties.

Mass casualty incidents often have the following characteristics:

- The response involves multiple agencies or entities.
- The response requires the expertise of specially screened and trained responders.
- The incident has a widespread impact on the public and the community.

Mass fatality incidents are one type of mass casualty incident in which most victims are deceased.

Mass casualty incidents include, but are not limited to the following:

- Transportation incidents*
- Active shooter incidents
- Civil disturbances with significant loss of life, injuries, or persons unaccounted for
- Natural disasters with significant loss of life, injuries, or persons unaccounted for
- Terrorist events

***** The Red Cross is the lead agency for Victim Support Task 3: Family Care and Mental Health for rail and aviation incidents under the statutory jurisdiction of the National Transportation Safety Board.

Detailed guidance for Mass Casualty Incidents is under review and may be found in the Mass Casualty Incident Response Toolkit and Transportation Disaster Response Toolkit.

Guiding Principles for All Disaster Relief Operations

Guiding Principles for Disaster: Summary

The guiding principles represent a broad philosophy that guides operational decision-making in all circumstances. These principles should be followed regardless of differences in incident complexity, location, or type of disaster. These principles are:

- Mission First
- Care and Safety of the Workforce
- Inclusive and Client-Centered Service Delivery
- Engaged Partners
- Good Hello / Good Goodbye
- Get to “Yes”

- Data-Driven Decision-Making
- Good Stewardship of Donor Dollars and Resources

Guiding Principles: Putting Them into Practice

These guiding principles recognize that disaster relief operations strive to meet the critical needs and expectations of a wide range of constituents – clients, workers, government and non-government partners, donors, and communities – in Red Cross operations. At times, Red Cross disaster leaders must balance the expectations of these groups by finding the balance between:

- Client needs and available resources;
- Delivering services and working collaboratively with partner agencies;
- Workforce safety and care;
- The quality of the volunteer experience;
- Cost management.

Red Cross disaster leaders apply the guiding principles to their decision-making process, both to achieve constituent interests and to ensure that their short-term and long-term operational decisions are in alignment with the Mission, Vision, and Fundamental Principles of the Red Cross.

The disaster workforce reflects the guiding principles in their conduct and performance. Further, if Red Cross doctrine or procedures seem unclear or not directly applicable, and if there is no time to seek guidance, these guiding principles, along with the mission, vision, and Fundamental Principles, can inform decision-making and problem solving.

Guiding Principle: Mission First

"Mission First" means the disaster workforce prioritizes the needs and safe care of disaster clients in all service delivery decisions. The focus of program development and service delivery is to:

- Meet the immediate needs of those impacted by disaster;
- Help clients identify their needs;
- Strive to provide them with the best possible experience under stressful circumstances.

As part of "Mission First," the Red Cross adheres to the concept of "Every Shelter, Every Day, Every Need." This means we prioritize and commit all resources necessary to ensure that all Red Cross-managed and partner-managed shelters have what they need, when they need it, where they need it to prevent and alleviate the human suffering of disaster-displaced populations. We do this through an integrated approach that ensures shelters receive the daily resources, communications, and other solutions they need to provide our clients with services that meet Red Cross standards that includes:

- Establishing and maintaining contact with 100 percent of all open Red Cross-managed, partner-managed, and staff shelters every day.
- Dispatching the Logistics Fulfillment activity to every shelter every day;
- Managing DRO-wide coordination through a daily planning process that results in an Incident Action Plan (IAP) that includes task assignments which meet the needs of the operation;
- Making our highest operational priority identifying and meeting the life-sustaining needs of shelter residents.

It is also important to measure client satisfaction levels in order to determine and continuously improve the quality of our operations and service delivery. Client satisfaction is a fundamental driver of building supportive and engaged communities.

Guiding Principle: Care and Safety of the Workforce

The workforce is our most important asset. In order to provide humanitarian services, we must support and care for those who care for others. At every level of the organization, disaster leadership must support volunteers and employees, and ensure they are trained and well equipped. This enables them to safely deliver quality services to clients while enjoying a meaningful and satisfying experience themselves.

Ensuring each worker has a safe and quality experience on every operation is the goal of many systems and policies, including those expressed in the Volunteer Handbook, Staff Health Standards and Procedures, the Employee Handbook, and the Supervising the Disaster Workforce Participant Guide. Every supervisor shares in the responsibility to care for the workforce and ensure its safety and wellbeing. This responsibility includes providing a quality work environment and ensuring that all personnel assigned to and supporting operations are treated with respect and fairness, and have:

- A job to do;
- The training they need;
- The technology they need to complete their job;
- A supervisor who communicates their responsibilities to them;
- The ability to communicate with their team;
- A place to sleep that is safe and clean;
- A safe method of getting to their respective work location.

Every worker bears some responsibility for their own satisfaction, as well.

Ensuring the commitment to “Every Shelter, Every Day, Every Need” (E3) requires making contact with every shelter, including staff shelters, every day, and meeting every resident’s need. We prioritize the resourcing of Red Cross staff shelters to ensure the safety, security, and well-being of our staff. For more information, see Planning and Operating a Staff Shelter and the Fulfillment Toolkit.

Disaster relief operations are inherently stressful, and it is important that volunteers and employees have a fulfilling humanitarian experience and take good care of each other. The greatest contribution of Red Cross volunteers and employees is the sharing of their time and talents with us. Toward this goal, our disaster leadership at every level seeks to provide a quality experience for our workforce.

Guiding Principle: Inclusive and Client-Centered Service Delivery

Disasters are not selective about the communities or the people they impact; however, many within the communities we serve suffer disproportionately due to pre-existing risk and vulnerabilities. Care for those we serve must be delivered in a way that is responsive to individual needs and values. This includes offering both cultural competence and responsiveness to diversity, and conveying the cultural humility to recognize the authority and self-determination for those we serve.

Disaster clients also include people with disabilities and others with access and functional needs who may experience a greater impact from disasters because of disruptions in their support systems and loss of equipment, supplies, transportation, and communication.

The Red Cross ensures that the access and functional needs and requirements of individuals with disabilities are considered and included in all aspects of service delivery and that the full spectrum of disaster relief operations practice diversity inclusion.

It is imperative that Red Cross services are accessible for clients with access or functional needs, including disabilities, in all disaster relief activities, and to provide sheltering and related services in an integrated setting with the general population whenever possible. For more information, refer to the Everyone is Welcome course.

Further, disaster clients may include individuals from many different backgrounds and across all races, ethnicities, genders, gender identities, sexual orientations, citizenships, socioeconomic status, ages, physical abilities, languages, religious beliefs, political beliefs, and other ideologies. Consistent with the Fundamental Principles, disaster relief activities embrace the aspects of diversity expressed by each individual client.

Guiding Principle: Engaged Partners

Partners engaged with our mission are a vital part of every Red Cross disaster relief operation. Our definition of readiness says, “In order to respond to disasters with the efficiency and effectiveness the American people expect, the Red Cross must build, sustain, and exercise the capacity and capability needed to accomplish our mission, which we do with our partners.”

A partner is any organization, group, or individual that takes part in collaborative activities with the Red Cross to meet the needs of clients across the disaster cycle.

Partners have varying degrees of relationship with the Red Cross; some participate in a single activity while others form long-term relationships. Partners that have formal or continuous relationships with the Red Cross often include local affiliates of national partners, national and state Volunteer Organizations Active in Disaster (VOAD) members, or federal, state, tribal, and local government agencies.

Engaged partnership means that leaders in all partner organizations help to assess the needs of the community, mobilize, develop shared goals, align capabilities, and communicate to the community before disasters strike, so no one is overwhelmed in times of crisis. With the planned, collaborative efforts of our partners and other community stakeholders, the Red Cross can assist many more clients, providing increased access to a variety of services and programs than could be provided through Red Cross efforts alone.

Successful mobilization of partners and resources occurs when volunteers and employees put into practice a collaborative mindset in which they see activities across the disaster cycle as opportunities for community engagement and participation. A collaborative mindset involves a deep awareness and understanding of the mission and capabilities of our partners. Knowing these missions and capabilities enables the Red Cross to find common ground around which to collaborate.

Although partners may have interests, missions, and capabilities that are different from the Red Cross, it is crucial to be respectful of these differences while also maintaining our Fundamental Principles and meeting the needs of our joint clients. In some circumstances, this may necessitate adapting our business practices to enable cooperation and collaboration.

The Red Cross needs to ensure that we treat our partners as equals, and together can stand shoulder to shoulder serving clients and communities in need.

Guiding Principle: Good Hello and Good Goodbye

While most people have been taught the importance of a first impression, last impressions are another key part of establishing a positive relationship. This essential element is often overlooked.

A *Good Hello* with a community helps to build the support essential to operational effectiveness, while a negative community impression often costs time and trust that can be hard to win back. The first 72 hours presents a window of opportunity for success. Clear communication, met expectations, and decisive decision-making set the stage for this success.

At the same time, a positive impression can only be maintained when the Red Cross winds down disaster relief operations thoughtfully and sensitively, placing value on the clients, the local community, and the Red Cross workforce, which remains in a

community beyond the period of operation. Clear communication about exit strategies, a coordinated transition from the operational team back to the affected region, and timely engagement in community recovery support and reinforce positive impressions made during well-executed operations. It is important to leave a region in a good position to continue its daily work and coalition building.

Guiding Principle: Get to Yes

"Get to yes" means that the workforce on every operation shares the goal of positively supporting every client, worker, government, and non-government partner, donor, and community. "Get to yes" does not mean everyone gets everything they want; it does mean helping our various constituencies get more of what they need by engaging the resources and compassion of the Red Cross, its partners, and its communities.

"Get to yes" means:

- Taking creative action to develop the right solutions to problems;
- Making operational decisions that align with our organizational values of being Compassionate, Collaborative, Creative, Credible, and Committed;
- Listening closely to the client, treating each other fairly and with respect, and jointly exploring options to meet the needs presented;
- Balancing client need, workforce satisfaction, and good stewardship of the donor dollar while staying true to Red Cross values;
- Ensuring that we balance timely responses to urgent needs with the need for administrative processes;
- Operating with relentless kindness in every situation.

Clients, partners, and donors are our external customers. Our internal customers include every member of the Red Cross workforce. Those who choose to be a part of a Red Cross disaster response commit to the same excellent customer service grounded in the principle of "get to yes" for ALL of our customers.

Guiding Principle: Data-Driven Decision-Making

The best decision making in all disaster relief operations occurs when data and data analytics are central to the planning and decision-making processes. Data provides insights to answer key operations questions (such as "Where are Red Cross services most needed?"). Red Cross disaster leaders turn those insights into decisions and actions to improve the delivery of services, enhance the experience of the workforce, and enable good stewardship of donor dollars and resources.

Disaster Services uses various business intelligence tools to make decisions based on quantitative analysis. In our readiness work, Disaster Services identifies areas with high disaster risk and social vulnerability to prioritize service delivery, ensuring the optimal use of donated dollars. During a response, Disaster Services tracks performance against planning assumptions derived from past events and integrates data into planning for more effective service delivery. During recovery, Disaster

Services uses quantitative analysis to help improve the whole community recovery strategy. After incidents, Disaster Services conducts operational reviews to document lessons learned.

Data visualization is a visual depiction of situational awareness in maps, charts, and other formats. Data visualization translates complex data into easy-to-understand informational graphics that facilitate good decision making and action. The Red Cross values the use of the applications, infrastructure and tools, and best practices that provide access to and analysis of information that improves and optimizes decisions and performance, especially RC View. Acquiring the knowledge, skills, and resources to develop and use data analytics, Geographic Information Systems (GIS) mapping, and visualization is a responsibility of all disaster leaders and a guiding principle for disaster relief operations. See the *Sync Training Module* on RC View for more information.

Guiding Principle: Good Stewards of Donor Dollars and Resources

Red Cross disaster relief operations depend on the generosity of donors. Without donor dollars and the resources these dollars generate, we cannot accomplish the mission. It is essential to be good stewards of the donor dollars and resources received. That includes supporting the efforts of Fundraising to ensure that donors experience high-quality interactions with the Red Cross. Good stewardship is achieved by:

- Ensuring efficient and effective operational management and budgeting;
- Complying with and enforcing financial controls to demonstrate fiscal accountability;
- Conveying ongoing appreciation of donor generosity;
- Prioritizing clients and the Red Cross mission.

Part of good stewardship is qualitative: Performing the mission and being able to tell the story in a way that confirms to the donor and the general public that their investment was sound illustrates that their financial support makes a difference. Another part of good stewardship is quantitative: budgets, financial information, and a financial control discipline that verifies the Red Cross is carrying out its fiduciary responsibility. As a guiding principle, disaster leaders and Red Cross staff should be good stewards of donor dollars and resources.

Communication on Disaster Relief Operations

Communicating Through Reporting Lines and Outside Reporting Lines

Open and clear communication is essential for successful disaster relief operations. Disasters are highly dynamic situations that require critical communication to ensure that information and situational awareness flow efficiently and effectively. There are two critical forms of communication: formal and informal.

Formal communication is maintained within the chain of command and direct-reporting relationships for OneSource of information involving assignments and resource requests. Formal communication allows operational leadership and other supervisors to manage more efficiently by reducing time spent communicating with people outside their direct authority. Formal communication should be used when:

- Authority or responsibility is transferred;
- The safety and well-being of clients or the workforce is affected;
- Work direction and assignments are given or received;
- Support or additional resources are requested;
- Progress on assigned tasks is reported;
- Workforce performance evaluations are conducted.

Informal communication is used when situations require OneSource of incident or event information only (not involving work assignments or requests for support or additional resources). Sharing relevant and timely information about an event should not be restricted to the formal communication lines, as this practice might inhibit decision making around service delivery. Informal communication should be used when:

- Providing or receiving recommendations on courses of action;
- Giving feedback on resource requests or status updates;
- Coordinating between groups and activities horizontally and vertically within the disaster relief operation structure.

Increasingly, forms of communication include the sharing of data and aligning the interpretation of that data. This information may be shared in the form of a visual depiction of situational awareness, and in maps and charts.

Communicating with National ADs

During national operations, National Program Leads provide oversight for field operations. National Program Leads are responsible for:

- Articulating guidance;
- Explaining new policies and procedures;
- Providing troubleshooting support for unique challenges that may arise specific to a disaster event;
- Reviewing and monitoring programs, activities, and doctrine implementation.

Using MS Teams for Disaster Relief Operations

Creating a DRO-Specific MS Teams Site

When a Level 3 or above operation is initiated:

- The Regional Disaster Officer or designee is responsible for establishing a MS Teams site for the DRO.
- The Assistant Director Information & Planning is responsible for supporting and maintaining the DRO Teams site.
- Refer to the DRO Template when creating the DRO-specific MS Teams site to see the standard set up of a site. (Due to Microsoft limitations not all content will copy.)
- Assistant Directors are owners of the DRO Teams site overall and of the private channel set up for their section. (So, the Assistant Director Operations is the owner of the private channel for the Operations section.)

Assistant Directors add members to the team and channels as necessary.

Continuity of Virtual Operations

To ensure continuity of virtual operations and to support the archiving of DRO sites, the AD Information & Planning for all Level 3 and above operations assigns the following individuals as additional owners on the DRO Teams Site: DOCC@redcross.org

Standard Teams Set-up

To ensure consistency across all DROs, all operations use a standard MS Teams format:

Channel Name	Owner	Notes
General	DRO Director / Deputy DRO Director	
External	AD External Relations	Private channel for members of the External Relations team and others as invited
Planning	AD Information & Planning	Private channel for members of the Information & Planning team and others as invited
Operations	AD Operations	Private channel for members of the Operations team and others as invited
Finance	AD Finance	Private channel for members of the Operations team and others as invited
Logistics	AD Logistics	Private channel for members of the Logistics team and others as invited

Workforce	AD Workforce	Private channel for members of the Workforce team and others as invited
District (X)	District Director / AD Operations	One for each district, as appropriate
Disaster Health Services	HQ DHS Manager	Private channel for DHS volunteers to file virtual client health records.

Access to MS Teams Meetings / Conference Lines

Once set up, members of the disaster relief operation workforce can access MS Teams meetings using the generic DRO email accounts assigned to each operation. All DRO workers have access to use Microsoft Teams through their assigned DRO email address with the level of functionality listed below:

- DRO Assistant Directors and above and District Directors can host MS Teams meetings with a dial-in option for up to 250 participants.
- DRO Headquarters and district management positions can host MS Teams meetings for up to 250 participants. No dial-in option included.
- All other DRO positions can participate in MS Teams meetings / calls and make 1:1 MS Teams calls.

CHAPTER 3 – OPERATIONAL STRUCTURES, LEVELS, AND ASSIGNMENTS

Chapter 3 Topics

- What is the Incident Command System?
- Disaster Relief Operation Structure
- Command Staff
- Section Leadership
- Operations Section
- Information & Planning Section
- Logistics Section
- Workforce Section
- External Relations Section
- Finance Section
- Long-Term Recovery Operation Structure

What is the Incident Command System?

Incident Command System: Definition

The Incident Command System (ICS) is a widely accepted and adaptable management system that enables effective and efficient incident management. It integrates human and material resources, facilities, procedures, and communications within a common organizational structure.

Incident Command System at Red Cross Disaster Services

This *Concept of Operations adapts* the core principles and features of the Incident Command System. The Red Cross applies the Incident Command System principles and features to disaster relief operations, regardless of type, size, location, scope, or complexity. Additional details, including a description for each of the Incident Command System features and principles as adapted by Disaster Services, may be found on the FEMA training website.

The Red Cross operational command structure is based on the Incident Command System in order to be interoperable with government partners, facilitate activities in all six major functional areas, and ensure a predictable and scalable organizational structure for all disaster relief operations. This operational command structure provides a framework for the coordination of all activities required for the provision of Red Cross service delivery.

The important steps in applying the Incident Command System principles to a disaster relief operation (DRO) are:

- Establishing and transferring command appropriately, so accountability, authority, and responsibilities are understood and assigned correctly;
- Delegating authority appropriately to make sure service delivery is efficient and aligned with individual and community need;
- Identifying and activating the organizational elements necessary to meet client need;
- Using common terminology to establish organizational elements, position titles, facilities, and resources so there is a common understanding of the operating picture for all members of the Red Cross workforce and its partners;
- Determining incident objectives and initiating the incident action planning process;
- Transitioning from oral plans to written Incident Action Plans (IAP) to make sure service delivery aligns with client need and the Red Cross mission.

Operational Command Structure at Red Cross

All Disaster Services operations must include:

- Command Staff

And the following six sections:

1. Operations
2. Information & Planning
3. Logistics
4. Workforce
5. Finance
6. External Relations

Disaster Relief Operation Structure

Modular Expansion as a Principle

Consistent with the Incident Command System model, our organizational structure for a response is modular, which means we can expand the structure to incorporate all elements necessary for the type, size, location, scope, and complexity of an incident. Building from the top down, responsibility and performance typically begin with the DRO Director for larger incidents and the DAT Supervisor/Manager for smaller incidents. When we shift to response, we deliberately move away from the matrix management model that Humanitarian Services uses in steady state.

If two responders and a duty officer can be responsible for all six major functional areas, as happens with most Disaster Action Team (DAT) responses, no further organization is required. If the initial responding leader (DAT Supervisor/Manager, Regional Leader On-Call or DRO Director) determines, however, that it is necessary to delegate functional management to maintain a manageable span of control, then this leader may assign specific operational functions to members of the workforce or establish one or more teams to perform those functions, like Client

Care, Shelter and Feeding teams Responsibility for tasks of an activity defaults to the next higher supervisory position until the supervisor delegates those responsibilities. DATs generally initiate responses and services and may transition to shelter teams or other resources for extended operations, or to a DRO structure as events scale up.

In larger operations, the DRO Director may delegate management authority by establishing districts and/or task groups. See Chapter 5 for detailed descriptions and duties for Assistant Directors and District Directors.

See the Group/Activity/Position Chart for a comprehensive chart of the scalable groups, activities, and positions filled by responders on all operations.

Disaster Relief Operation Levels and Assignment Titles

To establish a predictable and consistent command structure, a disaster relief operation is broken into levels and locations, each with its corresponding operational assignment title. Consistent assignment titles provide clarity for communication and supervisory lines across the entire operation. The distinction between titles ensures responders understand their reporting lines and location (like DRO Headquarters versus District Office).

Table 3.1: Operation Functional Levels and Assignment Titles

Levels	DRO Headquarters Assignment Titles	District Office Assignment Titles
Command *	DRO Director / RCCO / Chief of Staff / Deputy DRO Director	
Section *	Assistant Director / Deputy Assistant Director	District Director
Group **	HQ Chief	District Lead
Activity **	HQ Manager	District Coordinator
Unit **	HQ Coordinator	District Unit Supervisor
Site **	Liaison / Site Supervisor	Liaison / Site Supervisor

* *Command* and *Section* level positions may assign a Deputy if the scope and size of the disaster relief operation warrant the additional position (usually divisional and national operations).
** For positions at the *Group* level and below, an *Assistant* may be assigned for span of control breaks. *Admins* may be assigned for administrative support. Please see the Operational Tables of Organization and Position-Assignment Charts job tool for details.

Span of Control for Operations Functions

The recommended span of control for any management or supervisory position is 1:3, or as high as 1:7 for large-scale disaster relief operations. The type of incident, nature of the task, number of clients, and distances between personnel and resources all have an influence on span-of-control considerations.

When a reasonable span of control is exceeded, the Assistant Director Operations and other leaders set up functional levels and locations and allocate work between them. These considerations are described in detail in Chapter 6.

GAP and Operational Assignments: Difference

The Red Cross uses a qualification and training system for Red Cross disaster workers that assigns a group/activity/position (GAP) identifier to all members of the disaster workforce.

- A GAP specifies a worker's completion of required training and demonstrated competency through field experience within the assigned disaster relief operational function.
- GAPs are used to identify candidates with the capabilities needed to fulfill an assigned operational role on a disaster relief operation.
- A disaster relief operation position assignment may be filled by qualified workers with different GAP assignments.
- Responders may have multiple GAPs, which indicates they can fill multiple positions on a disaster relief operation.

Refer to the Response Operations *Group/Activity/Positions Chart* in the Disaster Workforce Engagement Toolkit on OneSource for a list of all available GAP assignments.

Depending on the level and complexity of the disaster relief operation, position assignments may be filled by workers with differing GAP assignments. For example:

- On a national operation, DRO Directors must have an Operations Management/Director (OM/DIR) GAP assignment.
- On divisional operations (Level 3), a DRO Director position may be filled by an individual with a GAP of Operations Management/Generalist/Manager (OM/GEN/MN).

There may be occasions when operational needs require that workers fulfill operational assignments other than the highest GAP they have earned. For instance, if client sheltering need exceeds local available resources, all workers assigned to the operation may be temporarily assigned to serve as Mass Care/Sheltering/Service Associates (MC/SH/SA) until an appropriate number of trained MC/SH/SA are available. The coordination of operational assignments is led by the Workforce section with direct assignments and oversight by the appropriate activity Manager and Chief.

In addition to GAP assignments, there are also a number of specialty tracks that identify responders with unique skills and qualifications. Please see the Disaster Services Qualifications/Specialty Tracks job tool for more information and the latest list of specialty tracks.

Command Staff

Command Staff

Command – typically called "operational leadership" or "operational management" in the Red Cross – is responsible for the overall management of the disaster relief operation, including workforce advocacy and care and attention to the strategic elements of the operation. The command staff is typically located at DRO Headquarters as appropriate, and may include the following positions:

- DRO Director
- Deputy DRO Director
- Chief of Staff

The Command function addresses the following:

- Defining operational priorities and operational period objectives;
- Identifying and prioritizing daily operational challenges;
- Developing specific strategic plans to meet priorities and objectives while overcoming daily challenges;
- Ensuring that all functional area activities understand the established strategies, priorities, and objectives to serve our clients and are directed toward their accomplishment;
- Ensuring the care and safety of the workforce;
- Managing relationships with elected officials and other government executives;
- Ensuring the appropriate engagement by the DRO of the community in all of its diversity, organizational partners, and governmental partners;
- Ensuring efficiency and financial controls are maintained.

Command OneSource Resources

Command resources are collected on the Operations Support Toolkit and Disaster Workforce Engagement Toolkit on OneSource.

Section Leadership

Section Leadership: District and ADs

Section leadership consists of the Assistant Directors of Operations, Information & Planning, Logistics, Workforce, Finance, External Relations, and District Directors, along with their deputies.

The DRO Director activates these section Assistant Directors and District Directors as needed. The section Assistant Directors and District Directors may assign deputies as necessary. The sections are discussed more fully below.

- Assistant Directors
- Deputy Assistant Directors
- District Directors
- Deputy District Directors

Section Leadership: General Responsibilities

Section leaders are responsible for the tactical and strategic direction of their section, including:

- Ensuring the overall direction and tone set by the operational command is executed;
- Ensuring the section supports timely and appropriate service delivery to meet client (internal or external) needs;
- Anticipating and ensuring the provision of human and material resource needs for their section;
- Participating in operational and financial planning;
- Effectively managing all resources in their section to ensure good stewardship of donor dollars;
- Ensuring the care and safety of the workforce;
- Ensuring the leaders in their section/district maintain accountability for their workforce;
- Collaborating with other section leaders to ensure effective coordination and common messaging to workforce and partners;
- Ensuring reporting requirements are met;
- Using geographic information systems (GIS), RC View, and business intelligence (BI) tools to visualize data, track service delivery, and obtain disaster information about the area affected;
- Managing the demobilization of their section, as appropriate;
- Supporting an appropriate transition of leadership.

Operations Section

Operations Section

The Operations section is responsible for directing the delivery of Red Cross services to fulfill the mission in alignment with Red Cross standards. Operations is responsible for:

- Using situational awareness to develop service delivery tactics in alignment with operational strategies;
- Evaluating and recommending updates to planning assumptions;

- Establishing resource quantities required to meet specified strategies and outcomes;
- Investigating, projecting, and planning for likely individual and community recovery needs;
- Employing internal and external resources to support direct services and district operations to achieve operational objectives;
- Ensuring cost efficiency and financial controls.

Operations has a wide range of Mass Care and Client Care subsections, as shown in the table below.

Table 3.2: Response and Client Care Subsections

Mass Care	Client Care
Sheltering	Disaster Casework
Feeding	Quality Control
Distribution of Emergency Supplies (DES)	Disaster Health Services (DHS)
Shelter Resident Transition (SRT)	Disaster Mental Health (DMH)
Reunification	Disaster Disability Integration
	Disaster Spiritual Care (DSC)

During large operations, the Deputy Assistant Director Operations manages those responsible for geography-specific service delivery: Zone Coordinators (when districts are not being used) or District Directors (when districts are being used). Also, during large operations, a HQ Community Recovery Manager is included, reporting to the AD Operations, to help manage the transition to a Long-Term Recovery Operation.

Operations OneSource Resources

Additional doctrine and resources are available on OneSource:

- Operations Support Toolkit
- Mass Care resources
- Client Care resources

Information & Planning Section

Information & Planning Section

The Information & Planning section collects, evaluates, and disseminates operational information pertaining to the operation. The Information & Planning section is responsible for:

- Maintaining information on the current and forecasted situation, including critical infrastructure resiliency and Essential Elements of Information, and reporting on any significant changes in incident status through flash reports;

- Maintaining incident files and data for legal, analytical, and historical purposes, including files and records developed as part of the incident action planning and planning process;
- Evaluating and processing situation and resources status information for use in developing plans;
- Supporting operational leadership with data and analysis to inform planning assumptions, which drive resource allocation;
- Coordinating the planning process and supervising the preparation of all planning products, including Incident Action Plans, Service Delivery Plans, Advance Operational Plans, and functional plans;
- Conducting and developing impact assessments, preliminary damage assessments, and detailed damage assessments;
- Analyzing service delivery reports, situational awareness, plans, and assessments;
- Creating and maintaining geographic information systems (GIS), and RC View and business intelligence (BI) tools to visualize data, track service delivery, and obtain disaster information about the impacted area;
- Disseminating information in the form of the Incident Action Plan, DRO Director's Executive Report, and service delivery statistics, including Disaster Operations Control (Form 5266) reporting and formal briefings, and through map and status board displays;
- Compiling and disseminating continuous improvement reporting from data gathered from submissions to lessons learned email and operational reviews, including hot washes and after-action reviews.

Planning has a range of subsections that provide the services above. These subsections operate across DRO Headquarters and District Offices:

Table 3.3: Planning Subsections and Locations

Planning Sub-section	Sub-section Operational Location
Disaster Assessment	DRO Headquarters
Situation Unit	DRO Headquarters
Financial & Statistical Information	DRO Headquarters and District Office
Documentation	DRO Headquarters and District Office
Planning Support	DRO Headquarters

Information & Planning OneSource Resources

Information & Planning resources are located on OneSource at the Information & Planning Toolkit.

Logistics Section

Logistics Section

The Logistics section is accountable for supporting disaster relief operations with the provision, integration, and sustainment of material resources, facility, transportation, and technology resources and services. The Logistics section is comprised of eight subsections, which correspond to the groups and activities under Logistics:

- Logistics
  - Facilities Management
  - In-Kind Donations
  - Fulfillment
  - Procurement & Sourcing
  - Supply
  - Transportation
  - Warehousing
  - Life Safety & Asset Protection
- Disaster Services Technology

Logistics acquires, coordinates, and safeguards resources for the achievement of the Service Delivery Plan, including vehicles and accessible facilities. While Information & Planning may track the location and status of resources, Logistics manages the resources assigned to an incident and provides support for demobilization and transition of resources back to the region.

The Logistics section does not establish operational requirements; instead, it leads the provision, integration, and sustainment of resources to meet operational requirements in alignment with Red Cross standards. Accordingly, **Logistics does not have the authority to deny or change a resource request without coordinating with the original requestor, DRO Director, and/or the Assistant Director Operations**.

Logistics OneSource Resources

Logistics resources are collected on the following pages on OneSource:

- Logistics category
- Disaster Services Technology Toolkit

Workforce Section

Workforce Section

The Workforce section is accountable for supporting disaster relief operations with the provision, integration, and sustainment of human resources.

The Workforce section includes the following groups:

- Staff Planning & Support
- Staff Relations
- Training
- Disaster Event-Based Volunteers
- Local Community Volunteers

The Workforce section ensures the care and support of the entire staff of the disaster relief operation, both volunteer and employee, from initial notification of deployment through the return home. This includes:

- Ensuring meaningful engagement;
- Supporting positive morale;
- Providing problem-solving for personnel matters;
- Ensuring ready access to clear job descriptions and clarity on reporting lines;
- Addressing training needs;
- Clarifying expectations;
- Providing timely and relevant information;
- Resourcing workforce needs, including meals, lodging, and staff shelter oversight, if needed;
- Overall care of the workforce.

Fundamentally, Workforce, in collaboration with DRO leadership, is responsible for supporting the implementation of policies and procedures to provide a quality work environment, and ensuring that all deployed personnel are treated with respect and fairness, and have:

- A job to do;
- The training they need;
- The technology they need to complete their job;
- A supervisor who is communicating their responsibilities to them;
- The ability to communicate with their team;
- A place to sleep that is safe and clean;
- A safe method of getting to their respective work location.

Neither the Assistant Director Workforce nor the Workforce section establish operational requirements; instead they lead the provision, integration, and sustainment of resources to meet operational requirements. Accordingly, **the Workforce section does not have the authority to deny or change a resource request without coordinating with the original requestor or DRO Director.**

Workforce OneSource Resources

Workforce resources are collected on the following pages on OneSource:

- Disaster Workforce Engagement Toolkit
- Deployment Toolkit

- Staff Services Toolkit
- Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Activity Toolkit

External Relations Section

External Relations Section

The External Relations section engages, informs, and collaborates with partners in community assessment, planning, coordination, and the delivery of disaster services before, during, and after disasters. Through partner collaboration, External Relations informs decision-making by delivering the right information to the right people at the right time. Through the External Relations activities, the team integrates into government, community, and public forums to ensure Red Cross operations are meeting the needs of clients and their communities, leveraging available resources where possible.

The External Relations team manages relationships and communication with:

- Emergency Management officials;
- Community partners, including faith-based and other non-governmental partners;
- Private sector partners/donors;
- Media partners;
- The public.

The External Relations team intersects with every function within the Red Cross on a disaster relief operation and frequently coordinates with national headquarters. In the External Relations section:

- Government Operations staffs, coordinates, and serves as liaison to all levels of government Emergency Operations Centers and supports Red Cross Coordinating Officer or other Red Cross representatives at the State Emergency Operations Center.
- Community Engagement & Partnerships supports the mobilization of the community to ensure diverse and at-risk communities can access the services they need. This is accomplished by engaging directly with those communities and with partners that may have greater access to those communities;
- Disaster Public Affairs:
    - Ensures consistency of Red Cross messaging, branding, and visibility to external stakeholders, including the public and the media;
    - Ensures media monitoring is taking place in order to provide actionable information to the disaster relief operation to respond to emerging issues in a timely manner;
- DRO Housing Liaisons identify housing resources to support the transition of residents out of shelters and to more sustainable housing solutions.

- Preparedness provides the general public, clients, and communities with appropriate disaster preparedness and safety information, aligned with local/state emergency management

In addition, External Relations:

- Coordinates with Fundraising to provide situational awareness of all aspects of Red Cross service delivery and connect donor opportunities as they arise.
- Coordinates with Government Relations to support governor relationships and congressional calls.
- Coordinates with Mass Care to convey the Red Cross mass care strategy, standards and needs to authorities and partners

External Relations OneSource Resources

External Relations resources can be found on OneSource on the following pages:

- Preparedness Programs category
- Government Operations Toolkit
- Community Mobilization & Partnerships Toolkit

Finance Section

Finance Section

Financial controls and wise spending are the responsibility of all leadership and staff on all operations. Finance primarily plays an advisory role in these areas and its assignment to an operation varies according to the disaster relief operation level and need.

The Finance section:

- Advises on adherence to financial controls that protect the Red Cross reputation/brand (thereby creating an environment that encourages donations);
- Assists with monitoring the operation's budget and spending to encourage cost efficiency to maximize the impact of funds toward serving clients;
- Ensures accuracy of budget projections and identifies the need for adjustments;
- Assists as necessary with the effectiveness of financial tools which allow Finance to monitor an operation virtually;
- Provides advice and applies business acumen to assist in the management and improvement of all other sections.

The role of the Finance section is separate and distinct from the Financial & Statistical Information (FSI) group, which reports to the Assistant Director Information & Planning. Finance is not responsible for completion of the *Disaster Relief Operations Control [Form 5266]* or maintaining the Client Assistance Card inventory.

Long-Term Recovery Operation Structure

When Resources Allow

Under certain circumstances identified as “When Resources Allow,” the long-term recovery service delivery plan may include additional financial assistance, partner and interagency support, and community preparedness and community assistance services. These services are delivered through programs that are scaled and adapted to the specific nature of the disaster, implemented efficiently, measured for their effectiveness, and reported regularly and transparently to the public and senior leadership.

In a “When Resources Allow” environment, Red Cross long-term recovery operations may continue for up to two years after response operations have ceased. Preparation and coordination for these efforts begin during the disaster relief operation response phase, and a separate structure to support long-term recovery-related service delivery is put into place. For more information, email longtermrecovery@redcross.org.

CHAPTER 4 - COMMON PLANNING SYSTEM

Chapter 4 Topics

- The Planning Process
- Planning Types
- Planning by Operational Phase
- Information Management - Data Collection, Analysis, Visualization

Information & Planning Program

Planning is fundamental for an organization's readiness and its ability to respond to disasters. At its most fundamental level, planning is a process to manage risk. The Information & Planning program provides a unified approach, process, and common set of terms for planning for and responding to threats and hazards, known as operational planning.

The Planning Process

Operational Planning Process: Six Steps

Adapted from FEMA's *Comprehensive Planning Guide 101* and similar to planning processes used by most state and local emergency management partners, operational planning informs efforts to address potential or actual incidents.

Operational planning follows a standard, six-step planning process to create two types of plans: deliberate plans and disaster relief operation (DRO) plans. These plans and their related materials communicate intent, inform decisions, describe objectives, assign tasks, allocate resources, and guide operations to accomplish a mission.

While all Red Cross operations follow the standard six-step process, actions taken in each step are dependent on the type of plan and the product being created. Please refer to the *DRO Planning and Reporting Standards and Procedures* and job tools for details about the process.

The six steps are:

Step 1: Form Collaborative Planning Team
Step 2: Understand the Situation
Step 3: Determine Goals and Objectives
Step 4: Develop Plan
Step 5: Prepare, Review, and Approve Plan
Step 6: Implement and Maintain Plan



Figure 4.1: The 6-Step Planning Process

Planning Types

Planning Type: Deliberate Planning

During steady-state, regions, divisions, and national headquarters work with government and non-government partners to determine the risks or threats to which the organization is most prone. Deliberate planning is accomplished under non-emergency conditions and designed to address potential risks or threats using a defined process. The goal of deliberate planning is to produce a document that can be used with as little modification as possible to guide response activities and decision-making when an actual incident or threat occurs. A well-designed, highly applicable, deliberate plan can provide the information that the workforce on an active operation needs to produce incident-specific plans when disaster strikes.

Planning Type: Disaster Relief Operations Planning

Disaster relief operations planning takes place in a time-limited environment and with the goal being to develop or adjust plans to address a specific approaching or ongoing event. At the beginning of an operation, plans are based on work conducted during deliberate planning. The primary purpose of deliberate planning is to inform and support operations, while the primary purpose of operations planning is to guide incident-specific priorities, objectives, strategies, and tactics. Five planning products are used by disaster relief operations:

1. **Initial Planning Tool (IPT)**: Contained in the Service Delivery Plan, estimates service delivery levels and expected costs for an operation prior to an approved Service Delivery Plan.
2. **Service Delivery Plan (SDP)**: A plan that describes the strategies, resources, and potential budget needed to support the activities across the entire life of a disaster relief operation. All Service Delivery Plans have a required submission, review, and approval chain based on the operation's anticipated financial level. A summary of Service Delivery plan submission deadlines can be found in table below.
3. **Advance Operational Plan (AOP)**: A written plan, covering multiple operational periods, that allocates resources to a disaster relief operation or a district based on anticipated service delivery activities.
4. **Incident Action Plan (IAP)**: A written or verbal plan that defines and communicates the priorities, objectives, and tactics necessary to meet the

operational objectives of a disaster relief operation for an operational period (often 24 hours).

5. **Functional Plan**: A plan to provide guidance and direction for a specific functional area during a disaster relief operation, such as a casework implementation plan, distribution of emergency supplies plan, or demobilization plan. Functional plans typically address the short-term and are used to define and communicate operational details needed to deliver specified service(s).

Figure 4.2 below shows the relationship of planning products on an operation. Please refer to the DRO Planning and Reporting Standards & Procedures and associated job tools (in development) for more information.

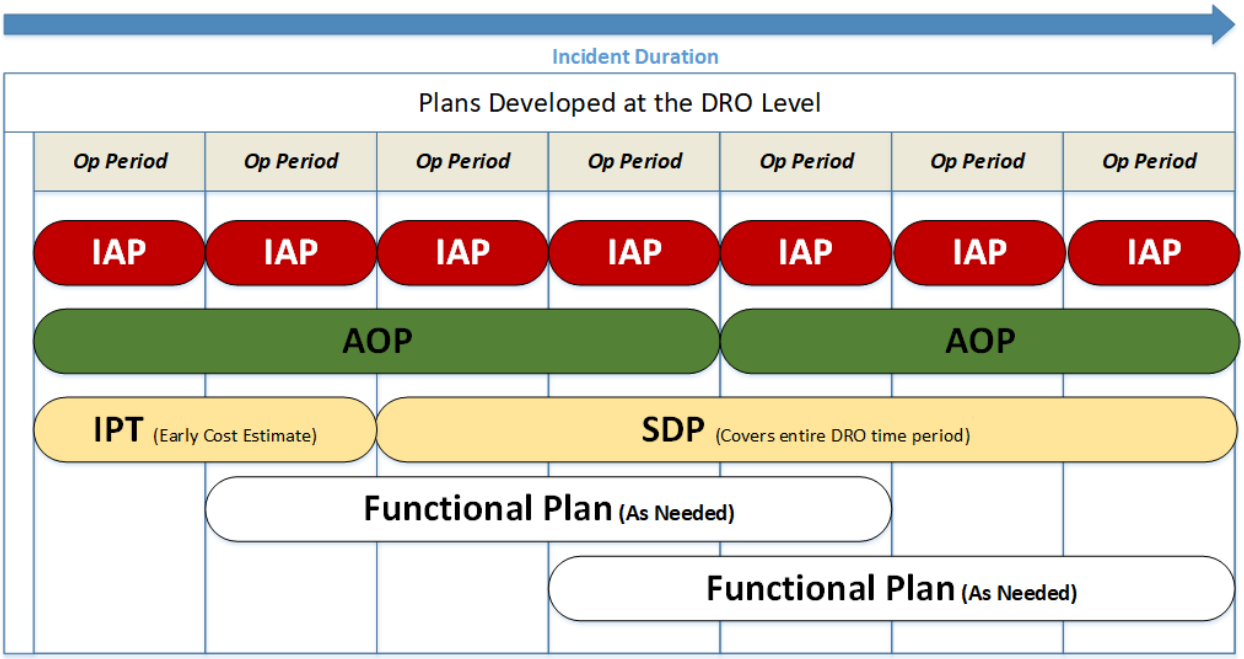


Figure 4.2: Operational Planning Products

IAP: Incident Action Plan
AOP: Advance Operational Plan
IPT: Initial Planning Tool
SDP: Service Delivery Plan

Service Delivery Planning Summary Table

The DRO Director for operations with an assigned DR number, in coordination with direct reports, is required to complete service delivery planning with consistent tools on a consistent operational timeline.

Those responsible for oversight and management may assign different timelines for hurricanes, notice events (like evacuations due to impending flooding), and operations projected to be at financial Level 6 or 7 or when presented with critical circumstances.

Initial Planning Tools (IPTs) and Service Delivery Plans (SDPs) for Level 4 and above operations are generated through the Incident Cost Estimation Management (ICEMAN) process led by the National Command & General Staff (NC&GS) collaborating the DRO leadership team. The NC&GS will usually convene an ICEMAN conference with the DRO in the first 24 hours after initiation to generate a preliminary SDP, and then re-convene within 72 hours (about 3 days) to finalize the SDP.

Detailed directions for Level 3 and below operations on submitting Service Delivery Plans for approval and additional details can be found in the DRO Planning and Reporting Standards & Procedures and associated job tools on OneSource.

Table 4.1: Service Delivery Planning Summary

	Objective	Tool	Notes
Second Operational Period	• Initial estimate of key service delivery expectations based on historical data of similar types/sizes of operation • First Field Operations Budget	Service Delivery Plan (Initial Planning Tool)	Limited information, use best available. Cost estimate shared with Fundraising at 72 hours.
By 6th Operational Period	• Account of detailed strategies, tactics, and resources • Reasonably reliable, cost-efficient field budget	Service Delivery Plan	Indicate confidence level, as prompted. Updated cost estimate shared with Fundraising every 7-14 days.
After 6th Operational Period	Account for significant, unplanned changes in strategies, tactics, and resources	Updated Service Delivery Plan	No revision required unless significant increase/decrease in needs or number of clients to be served

Service Delivery Reporting

Reporting on service delivery occurs each operational period and is collected and visualized in various ways to inform decisions. Additional details on reporting requirements for disaster relief operations can be found in the *DRO Planning and Reporting Standards & Procedures*.

Performance Management Against Plan

Performance Management

Performance Management Against Plan (PMAP) is the framework used by the Red Cross to evaluate the organization's effectiveness, efficiency, and alignment with the Service Delivery Plan (SDP). This structure enables the Red Cross to measure

Against Plan Definition

actual performance against set objectives, allowing for ongoing assessment and improvement of operations and service delivery quality.

Performance Against Plan in Red Cross Disaster Services

The Red Cross, as a learning organization, utilizes statistical analysis to evaluate and enhance disaster relief planning and execution. The Performance Management Against Plan (PMAP) assessment framework assesses large-scale (Levels 4-7) response operations. PMAP assessments, led by the Performance and Program Management Team at national headquarters, evaluate the financial performance and the quantitative service delivery results against the approved Service Delivery Plan and historical benchmarks. Significant deviations between the plan and results are highlighted for further examination during the after-action review process and generate interventions that improve future planning, resource allocation, and service delivery effectiveness.

Planning by Operational Phase

Operational Phases

The Information & Planning program recognizes four distinct periods of time during the life cycle of a disaster relief operation. Understanding which phase a disaster relief operation is operating in enables leadership to make informed resource management and allocation decisions for overall service delivery.
The four phases are:

1. **Initiating Phase**: Begins when a disaster or incident occurs or is expected to occur. This phase is marked by a rapid scaling up to meet projected needs.
2. **Stabilization Phase**: Begins when the disaster relief operation has sufficient human and material resources to provide the most essential services according to the Service Delivery Plan, and a command structure has been established to lead the response. During *Stabilization*, leadership begins to scale down the operation to meet the projected sustained needs of clients.
3. **Sustainment Phase**: Generally begins when the operation's capacity for the most essential service delivery activity has declined to 20 percent or less of the *Stabilization Phase* capacity, or plateaus at a low level. During this phase, leadership adjusts recurring resources to provide services to meet the commitments articulated in the SDP. Some operations may move directly to demobilization.
4. **Demobilization Phase**: Begins when the end of all service delivery has been scheduled, all districts have closed or are scheduled to close, and the recurring need for resourcing has ended. Demobilization ends when operational responsibility has transitioned to the region.

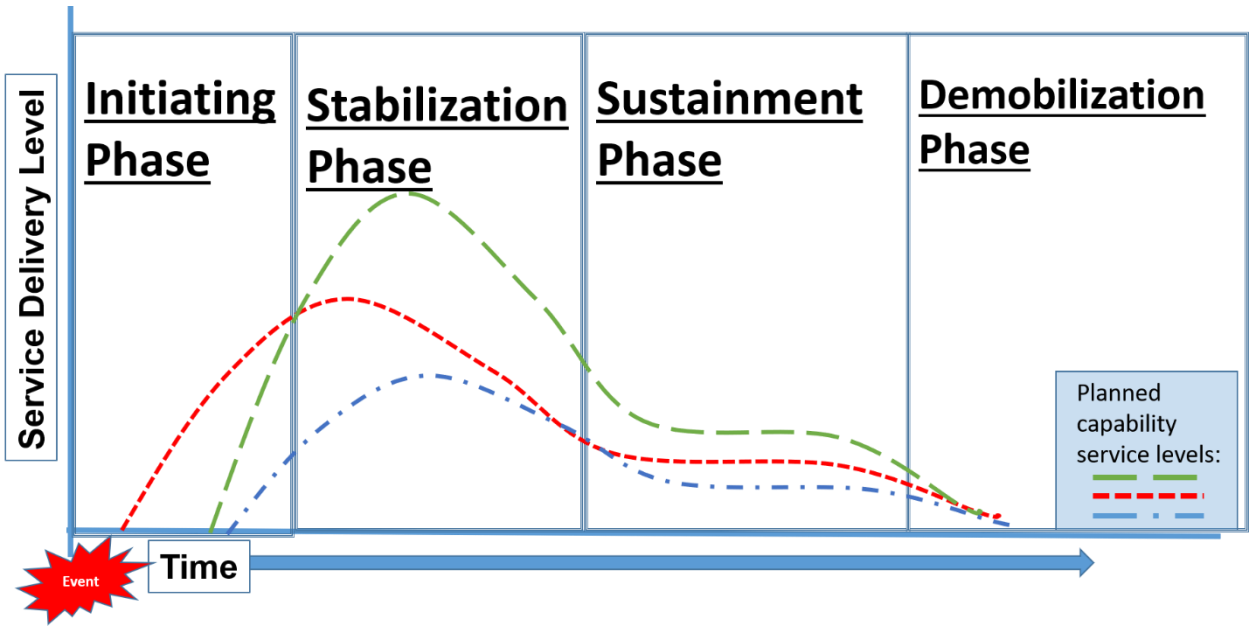


Figure 4.3: Operational Phases

NHQ-Led vs. DRO-Led Operations

Once established, national-level relief operations are led by national headquarters (NHQ) and executed by the disaster relief operation (DRO) This is typically during the Initiating Phase and may extend into the beginning of the Stabilization Phase. During this timeframe, National Assistant Directors at the DOCC coordinate with the Assistant Directors at DRO Headquarters to develop planning assumptions and determine needed resources. National headquarters documents the goals, planning assumptions, and resource allocations in the form of a national headquarters Advance Operational Plan. The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics may commit resources prior to the release of the national headquarters Advance Operation Plan. (These commitments are ultimately documented in the national headquarters Advance Operational Plan.) The DOCC mobilizes resources to the disaster relief operation following established planning assumptions and the national headquarters Advance Operational Plan.

When disaster relief operation leadership submits a Service Delivery Plan and receives approval from the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, management of the relief operation transitions to disaster relief operation (DRO)-led/national headquarters (NHQ)-supported. After this transition, the disaster relief operation requests resources aligned with approved plans through standard requisition processes. National Assistant Directors at the DOCC continue to provide technical support and guidance.

Information & Planning OneSource Resources

Details on how to produce operational plans as well as other Information & Planning reporting requirements and resources are located on OneSource in the Information & Planning Toolkit.

Information Management: Data Collection, Analysis, and Visualization

Information Management: Introduction

The Information Management program establishes a common understanding for how the Red Cross collects, analyzes, and shares information throughout the disaster cycle to create a system of information that enables all Red Cross workers, clients, community members, and partners to share and access changing data and information across the disaster cycle.

Supported by the Information & Planning section on a disaster relief operation, and the Situational Awareness & Decision Support unit (SADS) at national headquarters, the Information Management program guides all operational functions by standardizing the collection of data, its analysis to create business intelligence, and its visualization.

Business intelligence derives from a technology-driven process for collecting data, analyzing data, and presenting actionable information to help Red Cross disaster leaders and other users make more informed business – in this case, incident management – decisions.

Information Management Program

The Information Management program enables the Red Cross to observe and analyze complex information to facilitate timely and effective decision making across the disaster cycle. The Information Management program provides guidelines and tools for:

- Collecting data;
- Conducting information analysis;
- Visualizing and sharing information.

Data Collection

Data can be collected from internal sources, pre-existing data sources, current media sources, and partners and community sources.

Common forms of data collected by operations include:

- Impact assessments, preliminary damage assessments, and detailed damage assessments;
- Operationally relevant quantitative and qualitative data, including Essential Elements of Information, infrastructure, and other weather-related information;

- Call center volume and tracking to indicate where need might be greatest;
- Measurable data on daily service delivery.

Data Analysis

Information & Planning, along with disaster leadership, uses a wide array of tools, RC View applications, and business intelligence programs to analyze data. Business intelligence uses tables, graphs, charts, maps, infographics, and other tools to present that data. As appropriate, the Information & Planning section provides operational intelligence briefing summaries to establish a common operational picture, highlight critical mission impacts and provide context.

Data Visualization

Data visualization enables decision makers to identify trends in operations. Good data visualization can help leaders see and understand connections and gaps between client needs, community vulnerability, operating conditions, resources, and organization. The greater the incident complexity, the greater the need for maps, dashboards, and charts to organize data and detect trends.

Common Operating Picture

The Information & Planning section, especially on escalating operations, creates a Director's Brief in RC View to integrate assessments, situation reports, and incident notification into a common operating picture and provide a data collection and analysis tool to bring together many kinds and sources of data and imagery.

Using RC View in this way enables operational leadership at all levels to visualize the data, track service delivery, share information with partners, and obtain disaster information about the area affected.

All operations create and use maps and other data visualizations in RC View. Guidance for accessing and using RC View can be found on the RC View Enterprise Portal Mapping Toolkit.

CHAPTER 5 - RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

Chapter 5 Topics

- Resource Management and Readiness
- Types of Human Resources (Workforce)
- Types of Logistical Resources
  - Facility Resources
  - Material Resources
  - Service Resources
  - Technology Resources
  - Vehicle Resources
  - In-Kind Donations
- Types of Systems and Financial Instruments
- Resource Management Lifecycle

Resource Management and Readiness

Resource Management

In every operation, the Red Cross inventories, organizes, and tracks resources to facilitate their dispatch, deployment, and return. These processes are supported before, during, and after an incident – this is "resource management." Operational resource management is flexible and scalable to best support any incident and be adaptable to changes in a number of areas:

- The Workforce section leads the management of human resources on disaster relief operations.
- The Logistics section leads resource management for all facilities, material resources, service resources, technology, and vehicles on disaster relief operations.
- Systems and financial instruments comprise a third category of resources used on a disaster relief operation. Systems includes the programs and technical tools used to support the data needs of disaster relief operations, and financial instruments include the various tools available to acquire resources.

Command, as well as the Operations and Information & Planning sections, establish incident priorities, identify needs, and make requests for resources that the Workforce and Logistics sections acquire.

Readiness Model for Resourcing

Disaster Services uses a readiness model (see the National Readiness Target) for resource management that emphasizes speed to need and speed to scale:

- **Speed to need**: The speed by which we mobilize Red Cross resources in the initial response to an event to quickly meet emerging needs. For example,

speed to need applies to how fast the first Red Cross responders can open a shelter.

- **Speed to scale:** Measures how quickly the Red Cross can scale up resources to meet the size and scope of an event. For example, speed to scale speaks to the time it takes for the operation to scale up to meet the needs of the entire affected population.

In this resource management construct, regions are responsible for coordinating the initial response to disaster relief operations, especially the arrival of initial resources and delivery of service at the site of operations (speed to need) using all available Red Cross assets within their immediate control (and partner resources when available) by deploying:

- Local disaster workers (including event-based volunteers);
- Locally managed vehicles;
- Locally managed shelter supplies;
- Inventories drawn from local storage facilities using a relatively modest "just-in-time" inventory;
- Locally purchased inventory (using the financial instruments described below);
- Locally secured in-kind donations (IKD).

National headquarters and the divisions are responsible for escalating and replenishing growing operations and calibrating management, oversight, and resources based on incident complexity (speed to scale) by deploying:

- Trained, available workers from around the country;
- National emergency response vehicles (ERVs) from across the divisions;
- Material resources using a "just-in-case" inventory, distribution, and replenishment model from strategically located warehouses and through national, regional, and local partnerships;
- Regionally and nationally secured in-kind donations (IKD).

The National Readiness Target sets the standards and targets for readiness resources at every level of the organization.

Force Packages

To ensure speed to need and speed to scale, Disaster Services deploys standardized, predefined groupings of human and material resources known as force packages. Force packages may be deployed for Level 4 and above disaster relief operations. Standardized force packages are time-phased and based on program standards and advance operational planning. Force packages are deployed over time in distinct pushes known as waves.

The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics has the authority to deploy force packages based on actual or anticipated needs. Once approved, the Logistics Section at the DOCC coordinates force package deployment with the disaster relief operation.

National Warehouses

Disaster Services maintains inventory of commonly used standard disaster relief supplies in Disaster Field Supply Centers (DFSC) and regions. This inventory includes national-level supplies to support 500,000 shelter residents and enables the Red Cross to quickly and efficiently scale up large disaster relief operations.

Readiness Actions for Resourcing

For certain types of notice incidents, like hurricanes and forecasted floods, disaster leaders may anticipate resource needs in advance of impact to enable the development and execution of pre-incident deployment strategies, incorporating all elements of resource management, as shown in the table below.

Table 5.1: Readiness Strategies and Actions

Strategy	Action
Pre-incident assignment	Assign personnel and teams to specific tasks in anticipation of incident response.
Move-up or backfill	Move nearby resources into the incident area, with more distant resources filling the void by backfilling behind the deploying resources.
Pre-positioning of resources	Deploy resources in advance to designated areas near the forecasted impact locations for final preparation prior to mobilization and for recovery of resources during demobilization.

The Red Cross may employ these strategies at any time, including days, weeks, or months ahead forecasted impacts or anticipated service delivery.

Types of Human Resources (Workforce)

Human Resources: Volunteer and Employee Responder Types

In a disaster, Red Cross volunteers and employees compassionately dedicate their time, skills, and knowledge to the service of those affected. In regional-level operations, volunteers and employees from the local area respond to nearby disaster relief operations. In division and national-level operations, the Red Cross supplements responders from the local area by assigning and deploying workers from other Red Cross regions and divisions. Regardless of organizational level, remote Red Cross workers provide virtual support to most disaster relief operations, in functional areas that include call centers, casework, reunification, health and mental health services, disaster spiritual care, disability integration, shelter management support, National Shelter System (NSS) support, information management, and staff support.

Table 5.2: Types of Human Resources

Term	Definition
Disaster Responder	Red Cross disaster workforce volunteers and employees with a group/activity/position (GAP) assigned in Volunteer Connection, including partner volunteers.
Disaster Event-Based Volunteer (DEBV)	Individuals from communities who volunteer for a specific disaster operation and who have no previous affiliation with the Red Cross. Includes volunteers who offer support outside Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Portal activation. See the Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Activity Toolkit for more information.
Partner Volunteer	A partner volunteer can be a registered volunteer or an event-based volunteer. Partner volunteers may want to work together as a group and can come from non-governmental organizations or corporations.
Nationally Rostered Partner Volunteer	Partner volunteers who are deployed as a group for a specific assignment using the national roster process defined by Resource Mobilization & Support in collaboration with the national headquarters Community Engagement & Partnerships team.
Corporation for National and Community Service (CNCS) Corps	Provides workers and supports disaster relief operations through a variety of national service programs, including AmeriCorps, SeniorCorps, FEMA Corps, and Volunteers in Service to America (VISTA).
Employee	A person employed for wages or salary by the Red Cross.
Temporary Disaster Employee (TDE)	A worker hired to perform work that lasts for a finite period with no guarantee of ongoing or future employment at the end of the assignment. The Temporary Disaster Employee Standards and Procedures provides additional information about temporary disaster employees. (See Temporary Disaster Employees section for authorities.)
Temporary Agency Hire (Temp Hire)	An individual hired through a temp agency to perform specified tasks during a disaster relief operation. Often used for call center agents or administrative support.

Human Resources: Remote Workers and Teams

In disaster relief operations, remote workers can be an effective workforce for assisting clients, engaging a broader pool of volunteers, minimizing strain on the impacted community, and reducing travel and lodging costs.

While remote work can be cost-effective for disaster relief operations, it is not the best fit for all types of work. When deciding whether to utilize remote workers, disaster relief operation leadership should consider that remote work is most effective when there are:

- A large number of disaster-affected clients whose needs can be supported by a virtual team;
- Geographically dispersed clients;
- Local requirements or conditions that necessitate offsite support;
- Volunteers who are available and interested in doing remote work;
- Systems available to support remote work;
- Service delivery standards that can be met using remote workers.

Disaster programs have effectively used remote workers for the following services.

Table 5.3: Services Supported by Remote Workers

Line of Business	Services
Client Care	• Disaster Casework • Immediate financial assistance • Information and referrals • Quality assurance and fiscal reviews • Disaster Health Services • Disaster Mental Health • Disaster Spiritual Care • Disability Integration
Call Center/ Disaster Dispatch	• Shelter and fixed service-delivery information • Information and referrals • Requests for Red Cross assistance • Connecting partners to specific field leadership • Information support to Red Cross workers in the field • Casework registration • Crisis caller support • Referral to Red Cross subject-matter experts (as in health, mental health, spiritual care, reunification, or disability integration)
Staff Support/ Virtual Assignment Support Team	• Resource Mobilization & Support (RMS) volunteer teams • Virtual Lodging Team
Information & Planning	• Incident action planning • Strategic planning • Mapping • Essential elements of information

Mass Care	• Disaster action team (DAT) – Remote supervisors or a remote team may provide access to services when approved by the Regional Disaster Officer with division concurrence. • Reunification • Sheltering Support – National Shelter System (NSS) Field Remote Operations Support Team (FROST)
Community Engagement & Partnerships	• Connecting national partner local affiliate points of contact to field leadership • Identifying and connecting national partner resources with field leadership
Public Affairs	• Social media monitoring • Social Engagement Team • Advanced Public Affairs Team (APAT)

When choosing to use remote workers, disaster relief operation leaders consider the following factors to ensure successful management:

- Who manages the remote workers: national headquarters, division, region, disaster relief operation, other?
- Are people available to do the work?
- Is adequate training available?
- How to ensure worker satisfaction?
- How to ensure worker engagement?
- How to ensure worker retention after assignment completion?
- How to ensure worker physical and emotional safety and well-being?
- How to ensure effective information sharing between remote and in-person workers, particularly when they are supporting the same clients?
- How to anticipate and measure client satisfaction?
- Is technology/connectivity available?
- How to scale up and down, as required?

Detailed guidance on virtual work and remote disaster workers is available in the Virtual Assignments Standards and Procedures.

DST Support of Virtual DRO Workers

Disaster Services Technology (DST):

- Accommodates the need to deploy equipment and provide remote support to virtual workers on a disaster relief operation;
- Deploys equipment based on stated need and approved requests from the HQ DST Manager.
- Coordinates with Resource Mobilization & Support (RMS) to deploy DST equipment to virtual workers to facilitate expedited deployment of equipment;

Staff and volunteers who operate virtually during steady-state should continue to use their usual equipment, when available, insteAD ordering additional/different equipment from DST.

Human Resources: Appointed Workers

Leaders recruit some positions to fulfill operational needs by appointment, which is different from the standard recruitment and assignment process. These positions include, but are not limited to:

- Red Cross Coordinating Officer
- Chief of Staff
- Elected Official Liaisons
- AD Finance
- DRO Disaster Action Team Liaison
- DRO Community Adaptation Program Liaison

Force Packages: Workforce

Workforce force packages are a component of force packages and include a specified number of responders by GAP. Distinct waves may be deployed to disaster relief operations to maximize responders' time and appropriately support the operation and client needs. See *Force Packages* section above for more information.

Housing Workers

When sufficient rooms and funds are available, workers deployed to affected areas may be placed in hotels using single occupancy. When room capacity and/or revenue is limited, double occupancy in hotels, staff shelters or a combination of all three may be utilized.

Personnel Issues on a Disaster Operation

When supervisors experience issues with their direct reports that can't be resolved, Staff Relations or the appropriate department (Volunteer Services or Human Resources) provide assistance and coaching to address the issue as described in the Red Cross Employee Handbook ,the Volunteer Handbook, and the Volunteer Workforce Complaint Standards & Procedures.

Life Safety & Asset Protection (LSAP)

The mission of Life Safety & Asset Protection is to provide as safe and secure an operating environment as possible for employees, volunteers, clients, and visitors on disaster relief operations. Life Safety & Asset Protection responders also provide for the protection of the facilities, infrastructure, equipment, vehicles, supplies, and assets of the Red Cross.

Life Safety & Asset Protection responders are not intended to act in lieu of:

- Police or law enforcement services;

- Security guard or uniformed or plainclothes security officer services (like standing post, guarding doors, checking identification);
- Fire marshal, local health inspector, or building inspector;
- Armored car or security transport services for money or other negotiable instruments.

Life Safety & Asset Protection responders work with operational leadership to identify the need for and contract for services such as those listed above.

Types of Logistical Resources

Logistical Resource Categories

Logistics is responsible for managing and supporting material resources in the following categories:

- Facility resources
- Material resources
- Service resources
- Technology resources
- Vehicle resources
- In-Kind Donations

Each of these resource types is described more fully below.

Facility Resources

Facility Resources Overview

In disaster response, Disaster Services uses buildings on a temporary basis for service delivery, staff lodging, administration, and storage. With few exceptions, the Red Cross does not own these buildings. The processes for identifying, evaluating, acquiring, repairing, and closing facilities used in support of disaster relief operations can be found on the Facility Management Toolkit.

Planning for and managing these facilities is essential to optimize operations and service delivery to our clients and all disaster workers. The same facility may be used for one or more purposes. Common facility resources are listed in the table below.

Table 5.4: Facility Resources

Facility Utilization	Purpose
DRO Headquarters/ District Office	A temporary, central location for operations leadership of response and recovery efforts. Usually located as close to the impacted area as is safe and practical.

Facility Utilization	Purpose
Warehouse	Supports the disaster relief operation by providing the means for effective control and distribution of supplies.
Staff Shelters (if commercial lodging unavailable)	Houses the workers supporting disaster relief operations when adequate commercial lodging facilities are not available. (Staff Sheltering reports to Lodging in Staff Services.)
Shelters	An accessible facility set up to provide a temporary safe, secure, and sanitary location in which clients can stay and receive necessary services as they begin to plan and implement their disaster recovery.
Kitchens and Feeding Sites	Indoor or outdoor, fixed or mobile locations that are opened to prepare and provide meals for a large number of clients.
Service Delivery Sites	A location clients visit to access casework, health services, mental health services, and/or spiritual care.
Additional Sites (as needed)	A location clients visit to receive products and services, such as Distribution of Emergency Supplies sites.
Mobilization Centers	Centralized locations where disaster relief operations receive responders, provide support, and send them to their assignments.
Staging Areas	A location where material resources are stored before distribution for disaster relief operations.
Volunteer Intake Center (VIC)	A temporary location staffed by Red Cross workers to quickly and efficiently engage and process large numbers of disaster event-based volunteers (DEBVs).
Multi-Agency Resource Center (MARC)	A single location where public and private organizations come together to provide assistance to those affected by disaster.
Points of Presence	Temporary location where Red Cross provides specific services for a limited time, often in communities. Often used during responses to floods and tornadoes.

Material Resources

Material Resources Overview

Material resources come in many forms. This resource category refers to the emergency supplies distributed to clients (like food, comfort kits, and cleanup kits) and to items used by responders to support the execution of their respective missions (like office supplies, vests, and chairs). Some material resources are used by responders and clients (like cots or insect repellant).

The Red Cross holds the most commonly used material resources in the national warehouse system or makes them available for just-in-time purchase or donation. Material resources can be ordered at the individual product level or via a standard trailer configuration.

Trailered Inventory Packages: National and Regional

Disaster Services commonly deploys material resources in standard trailer configurations. The content lists for these trailers are pre-determined with standard inventories of the items most commonly needed to initiate specific lines of service based on expected client volume. (See the *DRO Trailer Configurations Job Tool* on the Procurement and Sourcing Toolkit for inventory lists.) Placing orders for these standard inventory packages, rather than having to recreate similar configurations for each disaster, allows the Red Cross to achieve resource management speed objectives.

In addition to national trailer packages, regions store ready supplies in fixed and mobile trailers to quickly meet the initial material resource requirements of disaster relief operations.

Table 5.5: National Trailer Packages

Inventory Package	Contents
Shelter Support Trailer (SST)	Shelter materials to open a shelter for 800 residents. Sample items include cots, blankets, comfort kits, and shelter signage kits. These trailers can be positioned at shelters or received by a disaster warehouse.
Shelter Auxiliary Trailer (SAT)	Material resources to meet additional access and functional needs, communication needs, shelter facility needs. Sample items include privacy walls, charging stations, and sensory kits. These trailers are designed to support 5,000 clients and are automatically pushed to a disaster in a ratio of 1 SAT: 5 SST. They are designed to be received by a disaster warehouse.
Kitchen Support Trailer (KST)	Materials to initiate feeding from one field kitchen – contains nonfood materials for 24,000 meals. Sample items include banquet packs, food Cambros, and coolers. These trailers are positioned at field kitchens.
Shelf-Stable Meal Trailer (SSM)	Shelf-stable meals to feed either 14,000 or 28,000 meals. The meals are either standard or kosher. These trailers come from vendor-held inventory and are designed to be received by a kitchen or disaster warehouse.
280/560 Push Pack (280/560)	Emergency supplies for 280 or 560 households. Sample items include cleanup kits, tarps, gloves, and shovels. 280s can be positioned at points of distribution while 560s are designed to be received by a disaster relief operation warehouse.

Wildfire Support Trailer (WST)	Material resources to serve 500 households affected by wildfires. Sample items include tarps, masks, and rakes. These trailers can be positioned at points of distribution or received by a disaster warehouse.
Cots, Comfort Kits, Blankets Trailer (CCB)	Essential shelter materials to support shelters with 1200 residents. Only includes cots, comfort kits and blankets (no other shelter supplies). These trailers can be positioned at shelters or received by a disaster warehouse.
Clean-Up Kit Trailer (CUK)	Trailer loaded exclusively with Red Cross Clean-Up Kits. Contains 2,500 kits with buckets, mops, brooms, brushes, sponges, gloves, and cleaning solution. These trailers are designed to be received by a disaster relief operation warehouse.

Service Resources

Service Resources Overview

Service resources come in many forms. This resource category refers to the common paid, contracted services needed to support mission execution and service delivery to clients. Common service resources include shower trailers, portable toilets, dumpsters and trash disposal, security services, and cleaning services. (Service resources are distinct from services provided by a partner organization, like feeding or health services.)

Table 5.6: Service Resources

Resource	Purpose
Portable Toilets	Portable restrooms temporarily positioned at client or responder facilities. The Red Cross executes short-term rentals when the facilities do not have enough to meet the demand or the restrooms are not operable.
Portable Showers	Portable showers temporarily positioned at client or responder facilities. Disaster relief operations order short-term rentals when the facilities do not have the number of working showers needed to meet demand.
Dumpster and Trash Disposal	Portable dumpsters with corresponding removal services to remove trash and recyclables on a recurring basis. This service is commonly used at kitchen, warehousing, and shelter sites.
Security	Temporary security personnel to provide enhanced life, safety, and asset protection at high-risk facilities.
Gray Water Disposal	Professional removal of wastewater from kitchen sites.

Technology Resources

Technology Resources Overview

Disaster Services uses a nationally managed suite of disaster technology equipment and services to provide a variety of communications and productivity support resources to Red Cross disaster workers delivering services in the field. This set of Disaster Services Technology (DST) resources includes items like laptops, tablets, cell phones, printers, radios, satellite phones, and satellite terminals.

The Disaster Services Technology Logistics and Fulfillment Center in Douglasville, Georgia, maintains and deploys technology resources and uses FedEx overnight shipping to enable rapid deployment capability to support operations. Disaster Services Technology Operations Management manages steady-state and operational support from the DOCC.

Disaster Services Technology Responsibilities

Disaster Services Technology (DST) is responsible for

- Provisioning, allocating, and distributing the technology and equipment needed for optimal service delivery during all phases and at all work locations on a disaster relief operation.
- Tracking the location of all equipment and for tracking its return into inventory.

On any disaster relief operation where Disaster Services Technology (DST) provides equipment, responders using that equipment

- Are responsible for returning this equipment to DST at the end of their assignment / deployment.
- May be supported by Staff Services during responder out-processing.

All DRO supervisors may be asked to support this effort for direct reports who request support or event-based volunteers or virtual workers who receive resources.

DST Laptops Provisioned with MS Teams

- Via the generic DRO email account assigned to each operation, all disaster relief operation workers have access to Microsoft Teams and Microsoft Office 365 with the levels of functionality noted above.
- Disaster Services Technology (DST) responders assigned to the operation prioritize the provision of laptops, cellphones, and printers within 24 hours to all shelter sites.

Disaster Services Technology Partnerships

Disaster Services Technology manages and/or coordinates several other internal and external partnerships used to support disaster response activities. Disaster Services Technology incorporates these internal and external partnerships into

response operations to provide expanded productivity and communications capabilities to disaster response activities.

Disaster Services Technology Internal Partners

Table 5.8: Disaster Services Technology Internal Partners

Internal Partner	Points of DST Collaboration / Coordination
Red Cross IT: Telecom Services (Telecom)	Disaster Services Technology (DST) works with Telecom in multiple ways: • Telecom provides specialized services for Disaster Services, as needed (as for international deployments that require nonstandard equipment or calling plans). • Telecom is a gateway for Disaster Services Technology to vendors for things such as in-kind equipment or service donations, establishing a fiber circuit in an operational facility, or otherwise increasing a facility's bandwidth. • When operations are housed at Red Cross facilities, Disaster Services Technology collaborates with Telecom and End-User Services (EUS) regarding Telecom systems and bandwidth.
Red Cross IT: End-User Services (EUS)	Disaster Services Technology works with IT End-User Services when an operation is housed at a Red Cross facility: • Disaster Services Technology collaborates with IT End-User Services and Telecom regarding Telecom systems and bandwidth. • When Disaster Services Technology is co-located with IT End-User Services staff, Disaster Services Technology consults and interacts with them on a case-by-case basis to provide operational support.
Humanitarian Services Business Systems Integration and Red Cross IT	Support the systems that support disaster relief operations (examples: RC View, RC Care, Disaster Services Automated Reporting System, Volunteer Connection) to: • Monitor the systems' performance • Manage any system upgrades or other changes to minimize the operational impact
Data Warehouse	Disaster IT Readiness and Reporting serves as a liaison between the Data Warehouse team and the Disaster Services Response and Client Care team
IT System Owners	Disaster IT Readiness and Reporting serves as a liaison with the IT owners of systems that support disaster relief operations (like RC View, RC Care, and Disaster Services Automated Reporting System) in order to: • Monitor the systems' performance • Manage any system upgrades or other changes to minimize the operational impact

Table 5.9: Disaster Services Technology External Partners

Disaster Services Technology External Partners

External Partner	Points of Collaboration / Coordination
Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)	• Operates and maintains two communications vehicles (called the **M**obile **O**utreach **VE**hicles or MOVE Truck 1 & 2) that can be deployed within continental United States to Red Cross disaster relief operations facilities to provide a communications platform for Red Cross clients or workers as needed. • IEEE MOVE truck operators are cross-trained with both IEEE and Disaster Services Technology training and augment DST workforce as needed.
American Radio Relay League (ARRL)	Deploys licensed amateur radio operators to augment communications on Red Cross disaster relief operations as needed.
Konica Minolta	Provides temporary donation and delivery of large capacity multifunction copier machines for use in large/busy disaster response operations sites.
Verizon	• Operates and maintains a fleet of communications vehicles that can be deployed to Red Cross disaster relief operations facilities to provide communications platforms for Red Cross clients or workers as needed. • Works with Disaster Services Technology on resolving wireless coverage issues or providing enhanced or additional wireless coverage/ communications options to Red Cross operations in impacted areas where existing infrastructure may be insufficient or damaged.
AT&T/FirstNet	• Operates and maintains a fleet of communications vehicles that can be deployed to Red Cross disaster relief operations facilities to provide communications platforms for Red Cross clients or workers as needed. • Works with Disaster Services Technology on resolving wireless coverage issues or providing enhanced or additional wireless coverage/communications options to Red Cross operations in impacted areas where existing infrastructure may be insufficient or damaged.

Vehicle Resources

Vehicle Resources Overview

Disaster relief operations require vehicles to move personnel, equipment, and supplies, and to provide service delivery to clients. More information about these vehicles can be found on the Transportation Management Toolkit.

Emergency Response Vehicles

Disaster Services utilizes a nationally managed fleet of disaster emergency response vehicles (ERVs) and multiuse emergency response vehicles (MERVs) to provide a variety of mobile, scalable, and easily identifiable support services to individuals affected by disaster. This fleet of vehicles provides services to clients using several standard vehicle types. Disaster Services has prepositioned these vehicles around the nation to enable rapid deployment capability to support disaster relief operations locally or across the country. The fleet supports mobile and fixed feeding, and distribution of emergency supplies.

Historically, the average number of ERVs assigned to a disaster relief operation by level is as noted in the table below.

Table 5.10: Number of ERVs by Organizational Level

Organizational Level	Average Number of ERVs Assigned at Peak
1	0
2	2
3	4
4	10
5	32
6	61
7	83

When not deployed in support of divisional and national-level operations, host regions use the fleet to support local operations. Common local uses include Disaster Action Team response operations, canteening services, client casework, fixed and mobile feeding, visible public presence, and distribution of supplies.

Vehicles: Types Other than ERVs

In addition to the emergency response vehicles described above, Disaster Services utilizes and oversees a number of other types of specialty vehicles to support disaster response activities. Disaster Services incorporates these vehicles, along with those from other lines of service (like Biomedical Services) into disaster relief operations. Disaster Services also leases vehicles based on mission needs and utilization. The Red Cross uses pre-established national accounts as the first option for leasing and establishes accounts with a local vendor if necessary. Other vehicles can include those listed in the table below.

Table 5.11: Types of Vehicles

Vehicle Type	Potential Uses
Box Trucks	• Movement and distribution of emergency supplies • Mobile feeding using shelf-stable meals

	• Collection and delivery of unsolicited donations of goods • Raising awareness of Red Cross presence and availability of services (using magnetic signs and/or truck wraps) • As emergency aid stations
Semi-Trailers	• Movement of large quantities of resources • Mobile distribution sites • Temporary field storage for kitchen/shelter sites
Tow-Behind Trailers	• Movement and storage of shelter supplies • Movement and distribution of emergency supplies • Advance positioning of response materials
Cars and Vans	• Transporting disaster workers to and from work sites • Performing mobile damage assessment • Disaster Action Team responses (chapter vehicles)
Personally Owned Vehicles (POVs)	• Disaster responders may use their own vehicles to travel to and from responses only when pre-approved by Resource Mobilization & Support (RMS).

Rental Cars

Disaster responders with a supervisory or leadership role are responsible for all rental vehicles assigned to their function.

- They are responsible for ensuring the number of rental cars corresponds to the number of staff assigned to their function and their activities role in service delivery.
- All rental cars must be registered with Logistics Transportation, which keeps functional leads advised as to the number of rental cars assigned to that function.
- Any unnecessary cars should be returned to Logistics Transportation for re-assignment or return to vendor.
- Cars may not be transferred from driver to driver without notifying Logistics Transportation of the change to ensure an accurate accounting and location of each car on the disaster relief operation.

National Disaster Logistics Center (DLC) sets a cap for rental vehicles on all Level 5 and above disaster relief operations based on historical data on the number of responders. In the stabilization phase of the disaster relief operation, the cap converts to a ratio of vehicles to staff on the ground of 1:2.5. This cap can only be increased by request of the DRO Director to the Vice-President, Disaster Operations & Logistics.

In-Kind Donations

In-Kind Donation Types

In-kind donations (IKD) are another way to resource required goods, services, and vehicles. Managing in-kind donations can involve many different people across the Red Cross and its partner organizations, so the In-Kind Donations sub-function requires focused coordination and collaboration, especially during more complex incidents. The In-Kind Donations team focuses first on items that the disaster relief operation would have purchased, even if they had not been available as in-kind.

Most in-kind donations fall into one of three general categories:

- **Identified by the disaster relief operation for local sourcing**: In-kind resources identified and acquired by the disaster relief operation (or region for regional-level operations).
- **Corporate-level/national-level offers**: Typically, corporate- and national-level donors and/or partners offer in-kind donations through their corporate Relationship Manager, who coordinates with the Assistant Direct of External Relations to determine if the offer should be accepted or declined. The Red Cross also maintains several major, standing in-kind donations accounts to support recurring needs for transportation, shipping, and "big-box" store supplies. For more information about these especially useful resources, see the *Using Major In-Kind Donations Accounts Job Tool* on the Corporate In-Kind Donations page.
- **Unsolicited donations:** After a major disaster, community members are often inspired to support a disaster response with donations of items such as clothing and shoes, which are sometimes used. Unsolicited Donations Management is the responsibility of Mass Care under Distribution of Emergency Supplies (DES). See the Unsolicited Donations Management doctrine found on the Distribution of Emergency Supplies (DES) Toolkit for more information.

In-Kind Donations on a DRO

During regional-level operations, regional Development staff in coordination with the Regional Disaster Officer normally handle In-Kind Donations. On established disaster relief operations, In-Kind Donations is a part of the Logistics section and the team coordinates closely with the Assistant Director External Relations, who is responsible for donor relationship management. In all operations, the In-Kind Donations team:

- Manages, records, and tracks all offers of products and/or services;
- Ideally, determines if the Red Cross should accept or decline the offer. In some cases, in-kind donations arrive before the disaster relief operation has accepted or declined the offer;
- Ensures the proper acknowledgement of donors;
- Ensures the accounting of accepted offers within Red Cross standard financial processes.

In complex or large-scale operations, national headquarters may establish an Offers Desk within the DOCC aimed at receiving, managing, tracking, coordinating, accepting, declining, referring, and acknowledging a wide range of in-kind

donations and services, particularly among potential donors who do not have steady-state Red Cross relationship managers. National headquarters issues disaster-specific guidance when establishing an Offers Desk. See the Offers Desk Standards and Procedures for more information.

Types of Systems and Financial Instruments

Systems

The Red Cross uses some or all of the following systems on every disaster relief operation. Click the system name for detailed information and guidance.

Table 5.12: Red Cross Systems

System	Use
RC View / National Shelter System (NSS)	Used pre-disaster to record potential shelter facilities, and during an operation to track shelters and populations.
DOCC Portal	Reporting portal for active disaster relief operations (DROs) to submit Incident Action Plans and Executive Summaries and see a list of all active DROs
RC Care	Recording services provided to clients by Disaster Action Team responders, caseworkers, health services, mental health services, and disaster spiritual care services.
RC View Mapping	Used to record and display service delivery, damage, demographic data, and geographic information system (GIS) data provided and referenced by all functions.
RC Respond	Used to record requests for service from fire departments and clients and activates Disaster Action Team responders and/or DRO services.
Shelter Client Information Application (SCIA)	Used to collect client information at Red Cross shelters to support dormitory registration, Shelter Resident Transition triage, and C-MIST data.
Survey123	Part of the RC View situational awareness suite of tools. Survey123 enables the workforce to collect and transmit data using cellular devices, like detailed damage assessment.
OneSource	Intranet website for Red Cross doctrine, tools, and resources
Volunteer Connection	Used to record volunteer and employee deployments, hours served, GAP assignments, and volunteer service history.
EDGE	The system of record for training. EDGE also records volunteer and employee training history.

Disaster Current Operations Report	Power BI application that displays aggregated statistical information about incidents and DROs starting FY22. Updated nightly.
Disaster Services Automated Reporting System (DSARS)	Records service delivery and financial information for all operations at or above a Level 2.
Coupa	Used for placing, tracking, receiving, and verifying all goods and services purchased from networked suppliers at negotiated rates.
Concur Expense	Used to record expenses and reimbursements for travel cards.
Concur Invoice	Used to submit non-purchase order invoices (vouchers) for approval and payment processing, allowing employees to create, submit, review, approve, and audit payment requests online. Disaster relief operation invoices must be entered through the disaster policy to ensure the correct approval flow.

Financial Instruments

Disaster responders commonly use the Red Cross financial instruments summarized in the table below. Additional information is available on OneSource (specific documents indicated below).

Table 5.13: Red Cross Financial Instruments

Instrument	Purpose
Mission Card See *Mission Card Standards and Procedures* and *Mission Card Cardholder Instructions*.	A prepaid card used for a maximum daily allowance (MDA), including meals and transportation, by authorized volunteer disaster responders when assigned to an operation. Regions may also use Mission Cards to support mileage/ fuel reimbursement for Disaster Action Teams.
Mass Care Procurement Card (MCPC) See the Staff Services Toolkit for job tools.	A stored-value debit card that disaster responders use for critical, initial purchases necessary to establish mass care services. Used when a P-card and Logistics Procurement are not available.
Travel Card (T-Card) See Section 5.2 of the Financial Manual of Policy and Procedures for the distinction between T-cards and P-cards.	An official Red Cross travel card used by some staff for permissible travel-related expenses on an operation with a DR number (in lieu of a Mission Card). Follow the guidance in the Using a T-Card on a DRO job tool.

Instrument	Purpose
Procurement Card (P-Card) See *P-Card Use on Disaster Relief Operations* on the Procurement and Sourcing Toolkit. See Section 5.2 of the Financial Manual of Policy and Procedures for the distinction between T-cards and P-cards. See Section 7.1a of the Financial Manual of Policy and Procedures for more information on utilizing P-cards on Level 3+ events.	A payment card that Red Cross workers use to meet service delivery needs. Disaster responders use P-cards to purchase authorized goods and services, typically from merchants and vendors in or near the impacted area. The intent of using a P-card is to eliminate the use of personal funds for business-related purposes. Generally, cards are issued to Red Cross responders who regularly make purchases to support disaster relief operations (not usually assigned on an operation-by-operation basis).
Client Assistance Card (CAC)	A pre-paid card clients can use at most retail locations that accept a MasterCard. Disaster Action Teams and disaster caseworkers, including health, mental health, spiritual care, and shelter resident transition workers issue client assistance cards to provide financial assistance.
Electronic Funds Transfer	The Red Cross uses electronic transfers to provide financial assistance to clients who qualify for Immediate Financial Assistance and other financial assistance (like health, mental health, and spiritual care).

Resource Management Lifecycle

Resource Process: Five Steps

Disaster relief operation activities require carefully managed resources (workers, facilities, material resources, service resources, technology, and vehicles) to meet operational needs. To provide these resources, every operation follows a five-step process throughout its duration, including scaling up and scaling down:

1. Identify the resources needed to support service delivery.
2. Requisition resources using appropriate method and gain approval.
3. Acquire resources.
4. Validate resources and allocate them as necessary.
5. Determine appropriate disposition of resources when they are no longer needed.

Scaling Up a Disaster Relief Operation

Scaling up an operation means to adjust its size and scope appropriately to the disaster-affected needs of a community. Scaling up is the process of adding human, material, and financial resources to a disaster relief operation – the bigger the scope, the higher the cost. It is important to accurately assess present and future needs, and with this information, adjust the scope of the disaster relief operation.

During regional-level operations, responses are initiated by a Disaster Action Team and most of the resources are addressed (in this order):

- Locally within the region;
- Within the division;
- Sometimes through established arrangements with partners and/or In-Kind Donations (IKD).

As operations grow in size or complexity, national headquarters may mobilize resources from across the country, through:

- National-level partnerships;
- Donor relationships;
- Arrangements with the federal government;
- In some cases, from other Red Cross/Red Crescent national societies.

In scaling up, disaster leaders must ensure a sufficient support system is in place to integrate additional resources. Established relationships, with local Red Cross employee and volunteer knowledge, are critically important. Local knowledge informs the scaling up process in the following areas:

- Affected population;
- Geography;
- Shelters;
- Partners;
- Vendor agreements;
- Sources for vehicles;
- Potential facilities and distribution sites.

It is also important for leadership to ensure that the latest Initial Planning Tool or Service Delivery Plan are reasonably in sync with the scale-up. For example, if disaster leadership requests 100 workers, but the latest Service Delivery Plan states a need for 50, this discrepancy must be corrected on the request and/or the Service Delivery Plan.

For national-level operations, disaster leadership may deploy an advanced wave of Logistics and Staffing support to establish a staging area or Mobilization Center to handle the immediate and rapid intake and integration of staff and material resources. Additionally, to enhance speed to need, Disaster Services has time-

phased force packages of human and material resources, to be deployed quickly and sequentially for specific types and sizes of disasters. Once the disaster relief operation has more information, leadership will tailor subsequent phases of deployment to meet specific needs. During larger disasters, the interest from local Disaster Event-Based Volunteers (DEBVs) is usually highest during the initiation and scale-up phase. Regional Volunteer Services Officers work collaboratively with their Regional Disaster Officer counterpart to ensure that there is a plan to receive DEBVs and put them to work, most effectively through shift-based assignments.

If there is competition for critical resources across multiple jurisdictions or operations, depending on the organizational level of the operation, the Division Disaster Executive and/or the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, in coordination with the DRO Director, prioritizes and coordinates resource allocation and distribution according to resource availability, the needs of other operations, and other considerations.

Winding Down a Disaster Relief Operation

As emergency needs are met, the disaster relief operation winds down in size and scope while service delivery continues until no longer needed by the affected community. Disaster leadership uses these elements in winding down disaster relief operations:

Table 5.14: Terms – Winding Down a Disaster Relief Operation

Term	Definition
Scaling Down	Scaling down means to adjust the size and scope of an operation proportionally as the needs of the affected community change. Scaling down is the process of releasing human and material resources, but there may be a need to scale back up. Activities may scale down at different times during the lifecycle of an operation.
Demobilization	Demobilization takes place at the conclusion of an activity for that disaster relief operation. (No scaling back up.)
Transition to Region	When there are residual services related to a disaster relief operation that the region has the desire and resources to support, those activities transition to regional support.
Retrograde	The focus of retrograde operations is to restore disaster readiness in a region or across the organization. (See *Retrograde Operations* section below for more detail.)

Departing Workforce: Services

When the workforce ends its service on an operation, the following table includes the responsibilities of disaster supervisors and the home regions of the returning workers:

Table 5.15: Services for the Departing Workforce

Service	Responsible Party
DRO Work Performance Evaluation	Provided by each worker's supervisor on the disaster. The worker's home region reviews these evaluations.
Disaster Mental Health Support	Provided by the worker's home region when necessary. May be supplemented by national headquarters in: • Large national disasters • Mass casualty incidents • Unusual circumstances

Retrograde Operations

Retrograde operations involve substantial movement of resources to restore enterprise-wide disaster readiness following complex, concurrent, consecutive, or large-scale operations. When initiating retrograde operations, the Red Cross re-establishes, monitors, and manages operational readiness by:

- Executing the demobilization and replenishment of Red Cross disaster resources; *while*
- Continuing to support disaster relief operations; *and (when appropriate)*
- Preparing to initiate intermediate and/or long-term recovery operations.

By deliberately establishing, monitoring, and managing retrograde and readiness benchmarks, disaster leaders assess the extent to which readiness may have been degraded by ongoing operations. This knowledge enables better decisions about deployment and replenishment and allows the Red Cross to align expectations and articulate unmet needs with partners, clients, and donors.

As resources become unnecessary on an operation, the retrograde operation focuses on returning human resources and returning, replacing, repairing, and/or disposing of material resources to support enterprise-wide readiness. Retrograde operational priorities include:

- Ensuring the well-being and readiness of the Red Cross disaster workforce;
- Maintaining situational awareness (often in RC View) enabling leaders to make data-driven management decisions;
- Returning previously deployed resources and systems while executing all services and support for ongoing disaster and recovery operations;
- Tracking and updating the progress of retrograde operations to meet leadership intent.

Resource Management OneSource Resources

More information available on OneSource:

- For doctrine on the overall Deploy Process, see the Logistics category.
- For more information about the mobilization and deployment of human resources, see the DRO Workforce category.
- For information about acquiring, mobilizing, and deploying material resources, including in-kind donations, warehouses, and facilities, see the Logistics category.
- To find out more about deploying technology resources, visit the Disaster Services Technology Toolkit.

CHAPTER 6 – EXECUTING DISASTER RELIEF OPERATIONS

Chapter 6 Topics

- Initial Incident Action and Reporting
- Regional Level Operations
- Division level Operations
- National Level Operations
- Organizing Service Delivery on Large Operations
- Large Disaster Relief Operation Support Mechanisms
- Responsibilities: NHQ, DRO HQ, and Districts in Large Operations
- Demobilization
- Summary Tables

Initial Incident Action and Reporting

Initial Incident Action

When an emergency or disaster occurs, the region where the event occurs takes immediate action to notify the management chain and initiate service delivery, often by a Disaster Action Team, to the extent it is able and in accordance with existing plan(s).

The region conducts an assessment, usually through a Disaster Action Team response, in consultation with the division, and acts to assume the lead role for the response (with the division assuming a support role, providing oversight, guidance, and additional resources as required) or have the division assume the lead role.

Likewise, national headquarters conducts an assessment, in consultation with the division, and acts to assume the lead role for the response or assume a support role, providing oversight, guidance, and additional resources to the division and/or the region, as required.

For all operations Level 2 and above, the responsible organizational level (region, division, or national) is required to create an incident in the Disaster Services Automated Reporting System (DSARS). Once an incident is created in DSARS, there is an incident number, which can be promoted to a disaster relief (DR) number, if needed. (See Issuing Level 2 DR Numbers Job Tool.)

Initial Incident Reporting (IIR)

Incident reporting enables Disaster Services staff to capture notification of an incident and provide reporting throughout the incident's entirety in a timely, structured, and complete manner.

Disaster Services incident reporting begins with the Initial Incident Report (IIR), which is submitted once. The Initial Incident Report captures:

- Immediate information known about an incident to alert appropriate members of the workforce;
- Critical information for reporting, audit, and situational awareness.

Because it was designed to communicate many incident complexity factors, the Initial Incident Report is particularly important to the decision-making about whether to escalate operations from one organizational level to the next. Typically, the Disaster Action Team assesses the situation on scene and reports to the DAT Duty Officer (or other responsible party) who may generate the Initial Incident Report. (When in doubt, complete an Initial Incident Report.)

The DRO Planning and Reporting Standards & Procedures provides details on incident reporting, including the triggers.

Regional Level Operations

Regional Level: Introduction

Disaster Action Teams execute most regional-level operations at financial Level 1. Larger regional-level operations, at financial Level 2, occur about 120 times each year.

Regional Level Operation Profile

Table 6.1: Regional Level Operation Profile

Estimated Field Budget	• Financial Level 1: Less than $10,000 • Financial Level 2: Between $10,000 - $49,999
Management Chain	• Existing steady-state management chain • Regional Executive is overall accountable official. No shift in authorities.
Geographic Scope	• Local operations contained within a single region.
Command & Section Responsibilities	• Command: DAT Supervisor/DAT Manager, Disaster Program Specialist (DPS), Disaster Program Manager (DPM), Senior Disaster Program Manager (SDPM), or Regional Disaster Officer (RDO) • Remaining sections: assigned to DAT or other responders.
Source of Responders	• Regional and local volunteers/staff and occasionally disaster event-based volunteers
Refresh of Responders Anticipated	• Not typically
Source of Material Resources	• Existing chapter/regional inventory
Source of Vehicles	• Existing chapter/regional inventory and/or personally owned vehicles.
Facilities Required	• Use existing chapter/regional facilities • Shelter(s) if other client lodging unavailable or not cost efficient

Regional Level: Defining Characteristics

The defining characteristic of regional-level operations is that they are contained and resourced from within a single region. This includes day-to-day Disaster Action Team operations as well as larger events within regional readiness standards.

Regional level operations traditionally begin one of the following ways:

- An activated Disaster Action Team arrives on scene, assesses the incident, and notifies the DAT Duty Officer and/or regional staff of the scope of the event and the need to escalate the level of the operation.

- Local government or non-government partners directly notify regional staff of an incident or need for services.
- Regional staff become aware of an incident through media reporting and/or social media monitoring.

Regional level operations undertake all tasks, including direct services like sheltering, feeding, casework, health and mental health, disability integration, spiritual care, and support services like logistics, planning (including damage assessment), finance, and external relations.

Regional Level: Indicators of Operational Level

The Red Cross typically associates the following conditions with regional-level operations:

- Single-family home fire;
- Multiple-family home fire or hotel/motel fires; (Over half of all regional Level 2 operations are multi-family fires.)
- Providing canteen services for local search and rescue and other first-responder support;
- Incidents with fewer than 100 homes with major damage or destruction;
- Mass casualty incident with 10 or fewer fatalities and/or injuries.

When elevating to a Level 2 operation or when initial data suggest a variance, the Regional Disaster Officer notifies the Division Disaster Executive to discuss whether to elevate the response. Large metropolitan regions may have complex events above financial Level 2 that remain within regional capacity. In such cases and with the division's concurrence, these responses can remain at the regional level.

Regional Level Authorities

Table 6.2: Regional Authorities for Levels 1-2

Budgetary Authority	< $10K: Regional Disaster Officer < $50K: Regional Executive
Transactional Financial Authority	Per the existing regional approval chain[1]
Operational Responsibility	Regional Disaster Officer or designee
Programmatic Support	Division Disaster Leadership Team / regional designees
Oversight and Management	Division Disaster Executive

[1] Level 1 and 2 DRO Transaction Authority is established in FMPP 1.1.

Disaster Actions Teams

Regional level operations often begin with Disaster Action Teams (DATs). Disaster Action Teams function as small, cohesive units, typically consisting of two to four responders, including a DAT Supervisor or Manager. These teams operate within the

steady-state structure of the region, usually under the supervision of a DAT Coordinator reporting to a Senior Disaster Program Manager, Disaster Program Manager, or Disaster Program Specialist.

While Disaster Action Team operations are routine, they are the foundation of our regional operating structure, and Red Cross depends on Disaster Action Teams for daily service delivery, prompt reporting, and situational awareness that enables speed to scale when an incident requires larger scale operations.

Usually, DAT Duty Officers mobilize Disaster Action Teams to provide 24-hour emergency response to local disasters, particularly house fires, ensuring that those affected have access to resources for basic necessities.

Responders in Disaster Action Team roles may transition into more formal operational roles once a disaster relief operation is established. For example, a qualified DAT Manager may become the DRO Director or Assistant Director, while trained Disaster Action Team responders may fill other roles.

Regional Level Organization

Regional level operations range from the short-term Disaster Action Team responses described above to more formal, if often partial, ICS organizations in place to support the duration of a relief operation.

In larger regional-level operations, under the authority of the Regional Disaster Officer, the regional leadership team and on-scene leaders may decide to establish a Red Cross operational organization with a table of organization in which some sections (usually Operations) expand. This decision is based on the complexity and need of the event. Other sections may be distributed among one or more responders or be performed by regional staff performing their day-to-day role (like Public Affairs or Community Engagement & Partnerships). See the Operational Tables of Organization and Position-Assignment Charts job tool for a sample table of organization for a Disaster Action Team response.

If a regional-level operation scales up, necessitating an influx of workers from outside the region to fill operational roles, the most qualified individual at the disaster relief operation in each role assumes leadership. This choice is determined by divisional leadership in consultation with regional leadership.

Short-term staffing of local emergency operations centers may be required.

Resource Flow: No Districts

The figure below depicts a simplified resource flow to be followed on operations without districts:



Figure 6.1: Resource Flow – Without Districts

The same process is followed to request staff or material resources:

- *Disaster Requisition Form (F6409)* is used for material resources and is submitted to the AD Logistics for fulfillment.
- *Staff Request Form* is used for staffing needs and is submitted to the AD Workforce for fulfillment.

Escalating to Division level: Triggers

If the region observes the following objective data, the Regional Disaster Officer notifies the Division Disaster Executive to discuss whether to elevate the response. Note: These are objective data points only. They do not take into consideration the experience and subjective judgment disaster leaders exercise when assessing the factors of incident complexity.

- Preliminary projection of more than 100 homes destroyed or with major damage;
- Preliminary projection of need to open more than 100 cases;
- Projection that more than 250 disaster-affected people may require concurrent shelter overnight stays for more than 3 days;
- Any form of evacuation affecting more than 1,000 people;
- Any significant need for resources outside the region, including additional responders, equipment, or expertise;
- Any evacuation or other substantial readiness activity for a major hurricane;
- A confirmed report of an EF-3 or higher tornado touching down in a populated area;
- Mass casualty incident* with 10 or more fatalities and/or injuries;
- A Stafford Act declaration with Individual Assistance Program (see this document for regulatory thresholds) is likely.

* For mass casualty incidents with more than 10 fatalities, serious injuries, or persons unaccounted for, the Division Disaster Executive initiates a discussion with Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics to determine the operational level. (These events often require considerable Disaster Mental Health and Disaster Spiritual Care support.)

Escalating to Division level: Process

Table 6.3: Process for Escalating to Division level

Step	Action
1	Regional Disaster Officer (RDO) notifies Division Disaster Executive (DDE) of circumstances and potential need for escalation.
2	DDE evaluates and works with RDO to decide to move the operation from regional level to division level and notifies the DOCC of a shift to division level. The DOCC issues a Disaster Notice establishing the effective date and outlining changes in roles, responsibilities, and authorities.
3	DDE notifies Division Vice President (DVP). RDO notifies Regional Executive (RE). Budget authority/Service Delivery Plan (SDP) approval shifts from RE to DDE / DVP, as appropriate.
4	DDE contacts VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics to coordinate resource and briefing requirements and to preview any anticipated unmet needs.
5	DDE designates a DRO Director and directs the establishment of a full Incident Command System (ICS) structure.
6	DRO Director assigns Assistant Directors for all functions. Leadership team initiates operations and resourcing.
7	DRO Director is responsible for ensuring the execution of Sheltering, Feeding, Emergency Operations Center staffing, reporting, Public Affairs/Fundraising, and caring for the workforce until the Red Cross operational command structure is fully operational.

Level 2 Differences

When a DAT response is elevated to a Regional Level 2 operation, there are some expected changes and challenges:

- Staffing of the Red Cross operational command structure with multiple leaders with more specialized roles;
- The assignment of more staff, some of whom may come from outside the region;
- Increased reporting requirements due to the increase in complexity;
- Longer duration operation (1-2 weeks), which can present challenges for staffing operational and steady-state responsibilities;
- Regional Executive and Executive Director may become involved in External Relations and managing relationships with community leaders and key stakeholders.

Division Level Operations

Division Level: Introduction

Division level operations are more complex incidents and responses typically last for 4-6 weeks.

Table 6.4: Division Level Operation Profile

Division Level Operational Profile

Estimated Field Budget	Financial Level 3: $50,000 - $249,999
Management Chain	Shifts from Regional Executive to Division Disaster Executive
Geographic Scope	Typically remain within the geography of a single division, but cross regional boundaries and/or are beyond the scope of a single region.
Command & Section Responsibilities	• Full Red Cross operational command structure • DDE appoints DRO Director and is accountable for ensuring all leadership roles are filled with qualified individuals.
Source of Responders	• Resource first from within the division—if needed, division may request out-of-division resources through national headquarters. • Staffing force packages may be deployed. • Activation of disaster event-based volunteer plan.
Source of Material Resources	• Resource first from within the division—if needed, division may request out-of-division resources through national headquarters. • Activate in-kind donations proxy accounts with big-box stores. • Leverage major in-kind donations accounts for shipping.
Source of Vehicles	• Resource first from within the division. If needed, division may request out-of-division vehicles through national headquarters. • Leverage major in-kind donations accounts for rental vehicles and transportation.
Facilities Required	DRO Headquarters, warehouse, and staff lodging required; all other facilities as needed.
Estimated Number of Partners Engaged	5-25+ organizations

Division Level: Defining Characteristics

The Regional Executive assumes a facilitative leadership role and supports the disaster relief operation. Division level operations may begin:

- As a result of conversations with a Regional Disaster Officer, Regional Executive, and division disaster team to determine the need for additional support and management;
- When a large incident is predicted or occurs that is above the readiness capacity of a given region;
- With a notification from state or local government partners; and/or
- When divisional and/or regional staff become of aware of an incident through media reporting and/or social media monitoring and then initiate a divisional-level operation.

Division Level Authorities

Table 6.5: Division Level 3 Authorities

Budgetary Financial Authority	< $250K: Division Disaster Executive
Transactional Financial Authority	< $25K: Division Disaster Director < $250K: Division Disaster Executive / Red Cross Coordinating Officer
Operational Responsibility	DRO Director
Programmatic Support	National Headquarters Program Staff
Oversight and Management	Division Disaster Executive

Division Level: Organization

As the volume of operational resources grows, the major distinguishing features of divisional-level operations are as follows.

Table 6.7: Features of Division Level Operations

Feature	Rationale/Purpose
Fully Staffed Red Cross Operational Command Structure	The table of organization expands within Command and the sections to ensure manageable spans of control and provide effective and efficient service delivery – includes Deputy Assistant Directors of Operations.
Red Cross Coordinating Officer	Provides meta-leadership in large and growing operations and senior engagement with federal, state, and county emergency management leaders.
Elected Officials Liaison Network	Establishes relationships and maintains consistent, reliable, and timely contact with assigned elected officials and other

	government executives to mitigate the risk of unmet needs and ensure continuous information flow.

Sample tables of organization are available in the Operational Tables of Organization / Position-Assignment Charts job tool.

Determining Method of Financial Assistance

The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, in consultation with Client Care Operations, selects the method (and if necessary, the level) for providing Immediate Financial Assistance based on the following triggers:

- Once disaster assessment is 85% complete or the disaster relief operation has validated and has high confidence in the accuracy of comprehensive partner damage assessment; AND/OR
- Whenever there are concurrent and/or adjacent operations of varying size/scope.

Divisional Operations: Communication with National ADs

While the **strategic** direction of a disaster relief operation is set by the DRO Director and the section Assistant Directors, ensuring consistent application of **programmatic** guidance is critical to successful service delivery. National Assistant Directors are the subject-matter experts for technical and programmatic. When the DOCC is activated, disaster relief operation Assistant Directors should contact the corresponding National AD at the DOCC. Follow the communication path in the table below to maintain consistent application of Red Cross programmatic guidance and ensure effective communications within the disaster relief operation.

Table 6.8: Programmatic Resources

Questions from:	Answers
Assistant Directors at DRO Headquarters	• DRO Director provides guidance. • If the DRO Director does not know the answer, contact the National AD identified in the DOCC Table of Organization.
Group and activity Chiefs/ Managers at the DRO	• Section Assistant Director or Deputy Assistant Director provides guidance. • If the section Assistant Director / Deputy Assistant Director does not know the answer, group and activity Chiefs/ Managers contact the National AD at the DOCC.

Escalating to National Level: Triggers

The following data often indicates that disaster leadership should consider escalating to a national-level operation. Note: These are objective data points only. They do not take into consideration the experience and subjective judgment Red

Cross disaster leaders exercise when fully assessing the factors of incident complexity.

- More than 1,000 homes projected to be destroyed or have major damage;
- Requirement to shelter 1,000 or more people for 7 days or more;
- Any form of evacuation affecting more than 5,000 people;
- Any significant need for resources outside the division, including additional responders, equipment, or expertise;
- Anytime the National Transportation Safety Board is activated for a legislated transportation incident; (See the Mass Casualty Incident Response Toolkit for more information.)
- Any incident with significant national-level media attention and/or high volume, sustained social media activity;
- Any incident (including terrorism) involving chemical, biological, radiological, or nuclear agents requiring protective measures;
- Any Category 3 or higher hurricane approaching U.S. interests and any Category 2 or higher hurricane forecast to make landfall in U.S. interests;
- Any situation in which the President has issued an Emergency or Major Disaster Declaration under the Stafford Act.

Table 6.9: Process for Escalating to National-Level Operations

Escalating to National-Level: Process

Step	Action
1	DDE notifies VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics of circumstances and potential need for escalation; or VP notifies DDE of national-level interest and intent to elevate.
2	VP evaluates and works with DDE to escalate the operation from division level to national level and ensures prompt action by the DOCC to make appropriate notifications. The DOCC issues a Disaster Notice establishing the effective date and outlining changes in roles, responsibilities, and authorities.
3	DDE notifies DVP and affected REs. VP notifies national headquarters leadership. Budget authority/SDP approval/transactional authority shifts from DVP to VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics.
4	VP consults with DVP and DDE and designates a Red Cross Coordinating Officer (typically the DDE for the affected division) and DRO Director.
5	Red Cross Coordinating Officer (RCCO) engages with State Director of Emergency Management, the Federal Coordinating Officer if appointed or pre-designated, and appropriate country/parish officials.
6	RCCO arranges for transition call between the region and incoming DRO using the *DRO Transition Checklist*.
7	NAD ER directs the establishment and resourcing of the EOLN.

8	VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics determines whether to activate the DOCC. VP and DOCC conduct initial sync call with the disaster relief operation to: • Assess anticipated unmet needs; • Confirm operational priorities; • Establish strategic priorities; • Determines National Incident Command Team deployment or other Operations Management staffing strategy; and • Set daily routine/order of business, including publishing an Incident Operation Summary (IOS) to all national operations.
9	DRO Director is responsible for ensuring the execution of sheltering, feeding, Emergency Operations Center staffing, reporting (Financial & Statistical Information and Disaster Assessment), and Public Affairs/Fundraising until Red Cross operational command structure is fully operational.
10	VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics: • Directs dedicated media monitoring and messaging to partners and the public in conjunction with Government Operations, Community Engagement & Partnerships, and Disaster Public Affairs at the DOCC; • Directs assignment of Chief of Staff.

Division Level Differences

Division-level operations indicate a significant increase in incident complexity. The sections that follow describe some factors that distinguish divisional-level operations from regional-level operations.

Workforce Differences: Division level

The size and duration of divisional operations usually require an increase and often a refresh of staff, which may mean:

- Disaster leadership establishes an orientation and training program;
- RCCO and Chief of Staff positions may be assigned;
- Communications with the full team may require multiple approaches including videos, email, and text messaging;
- An increase in disaster event-based volunteers and corporate partners may require:
  - The integration of Volunteer Services within the disaster relief operation in the Staff Services/DEBV or Staff Relations activities;
  - Coordination with the Community Engagement & Partnerships team to corporate partners;
  - Regional volunteers and employees partner with division staff to define the region's role;
- The disaster relief operation must coordinate with the region to maintain the capability to meet steady-state activities.

The DRO Director leads the operation, and Regional Executives and Regional Disaster Officers who are engaged in service delivery are critical partners to the DRO Director.

Operations & Logistics Differences: Division level

- Multiple warehouses may be established to support wide-scale service delivery.
- Disaster relief operations use major in-kind donations accounts.
- Disaster leadership sets up social media monitoring through Disaster Public Affairs.
- Donations of unsolicited goods may significantly increase.
- There may be difficulties getting some clients to transition to sustainable housing solutions.
- When there is a significant pet population at Red Cross shelter(s), the AD Operations coordinates with the National AD Operations to deploy a DRO Pet Liaison, who serves as the subject-matter expert for pets and coordinates with animal welfare organizations to support pets at Red Cross shelters.
- Disaster leaders must ensure coverage of ongoing Disaster Action Team activities when assigning DAT members to a disaster relief operation. When a DRO or related event impacts capacity to provide local DAT services, a DRO Disaster Action Team (DAT) Liaison may be appointed at the request of the division to support continuation of this critical service. For more details see DRO Disaster Action Team Liaison.
- For Level 3 and above disaster responses, disaster leadership share the Lessons Learned email (lessonslearned@redcross.org) to solicit feedback from responders.
    - Continuous Improvement at national headquarters monitors the inbox and shares submissions with those best suited to address the issue or solution.
    - Comments with immediate concerns are shared with disaster relief operation leadership.
    - During national or multiple division responses, Continuous Improvement provides a summary of feedback to support analysis and action.

Shelter Resident Transition:

- To help support shelter residents transition from a shelter to more sustainable living solutions, Shelter Resident Transition assistance is approved for Level 4 and above operations.
    - Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics may approve Shelter Resident Transition assistance on a Level 3 DRO.
- Shelter Resident Transition also supports shelter residents by providing situational awareness to the DRO about shelter resident roadblocks and transition needs to inform operational priorities, allocation of resources, and the engagement of governmental and community organizations.
- See Doctrine Bulletin: Shelter Resident Transition and Housing for more information.

Planning Differences: Division level	• The disaster relief operation assists in developing the DRO Director's Brief in RC View. • There may be a need to activate a DRO Call Center Liaison: ○ Trigger: The National Response Call Center is activated. ○ This position is required for Level 4 and above operations. • There is greater coordination with the DOCC and Disaster Finance leads. • The operations may need advance operational planning when districts are in place. • Disaster Assessment may be inefficient and may cause delays in other service lines, especially Client Care and Long-Term Recovery. • DRO Headquarters supports disaster assessment, including detailed damage assessment (DDA). • DRO Headquarters adjudicates resources for detailed damage assessment based on areas of impact, service delivery planning, and accessibility. • The workforce may need support with the increased use of technology (Power BI, ARC GIS, RC View). • Request for Survey123 surveys in anticipation of a Level 3 operation.
External Relations Differences: Division level	State, tribal, and county involvement may grow during divisional-level operations necessitating: • Sustained 24x7 staffing of one or more Emergency Operations Centers; • Collaboration with government and key non-governmental partners (as with Feeding); • Possible need to coordinate with Division Communication Director to deploy Advance Public Affairs Team (APAT), photographers, and videographers who report to Public Affairs at national headquarters as an extension of the National Communications Office; • Possible need to engage Fundraising to support increased activity; • Increased coordination with partners (national and local).
Client Care Differences: Division level	• Convening and engaging with other organizations is key to recovery and adds to an increase in activity for both Client Care, Long-Term Recovery, and External Relations. • May require deployed disaster caseworkers to provide wide-scale client disaster casework. • May use remote disaster casework.
Finance Differences: Division level	• Finance may deploy an Assistant Director Finance and Finance Managers to the disaster relief operation.

- National headquarters closely monitors costs and revenue.
- Requirements grow for internal controls involving all forms of financial assistance.

National Level Operations

National Level Operations: Introduction

National-level operations can remain in active response mode for months and often transition to long-term recovery operations, which can last for more than a year.

National Level Operation Profile

Table 6.10: National Level Operation Profile

Estimated Field Budget	Financial Level 4: $250,000 - $2.5 million Financial Level 5: $2.5-5 million Financial Level 6: $5-10 million Financial Level 7: Over $10 million
Management Chain	Shifts from Division Disaster Executive to Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics
Geographic Scope	Often affects multiple regions and/or divisions
Command and Section Structure	• Fully staffed Red Cross operational command structure • Potentially multiple disaster relief operations • Multiple districts (when approved)
Source of Responders	• Resource first from within the region, then division, and then nationally. • Depending on other disaster activity nationwide, may employ a variety of staffing strategies, like fencing some divisions or attempting to resource from adjacent or lower-activity divisions. • May activate and deploy the National Incident Command Team, National Response Management Team (NRMT) members, multiple Division Response Management Teams, and/or other approved teams to staffparticular sections. • May reallocate human resources between disaster relief operations. • Virtual teams conduct remote work in multiple functions.
Source of Material Resources	• Resource first from within the region, then division—then resource nationally, including partners at all levels. • Activate and leverage all appropriate major in-kind donations accounts. • May re-allocate resources between disaster relief operations.

Source of Vehicles	• Resource first from within the division—if needed, the division may request out-of-division resources through national headquarters. • Leverage major in-kind donations accounts for rental vehicles and transportation. • May re-allocate vehicles between disaster relief operations.
Facilities Required	DRO Headquarters, District Office, warehouse, and staff lodging required; all other facilities, as needed.

The Red Cross may establish national-level operations for incidents following these criteria:

- Affect multiple regions and/or divisions;
- Require the deployment of significant human and material resources from outside the affected division(s);
- Create national impact and/or risk for the organization.

During national-level operations, the Division Vice Presidents and Regional Executives in the affected jurisdictions assume facilitative leadership roles and support the operation per Chapter 7.

National level operations often begin with:

- Media reports of a no-notice event;
- Notification from government partners, including about notice events;
- Standard initial incident reporting procedures; or
- Regional or divisional-level operations that escalate when information reveals increased cost/complexity.

National Level: Indicators of Operational Complexity

The following conditions are typically associated with national-level operations:

- Major flooding—most national-level operations are flood responses;
- Any Category 3 or higher hurricane approaching U.S. interests and any Category 2 or higher hurricane forecast to make landfall in U.S. territories;
- Any form of evacuation affecting more than 5,000 people;
- Large wildfires;
- Any incident with more than 1,000 homes projected destroyed or with major damage;
- Requirement to shelter 1,000 or more people for 7 days or more;
- Mass casualty incidents, including transportation accidents and active shooter incidents;
- Any incident (including terrorism) involving chemical, biological, radiological, or nuclear agents requiring protective measures;
- Any situation in which the President of the United States has issued an Emergency or Major Disaster Declaration under the Stafford Act;

- Major notice-event readiness operations, including National Special Security Events and other large, public events requiring substantial commitment of Red Cross resources;
- Activation of the National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) for a legislated transportation incident;
- Any significant need for resources outside the division, including additional responders, equipment, or expertise.

National-Level Authorities

Table 6.11: National-Level Authorities

Budgetary Financial Authority	< $2.5M: Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics ≤ $10M: Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics ≤ $20M: President, Humanitarian Services[1] ≥$20M: CEO[2]
Transactional Financial Authority	< $1M: Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics ≤ $5M: Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics < $10M: President, Humanitarian Services > $10M: CEO
Operational Responsibility	DRO Director
Programmatic Support	National Headquarters Program Staff
Oversight and Management	Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics

[1] In these cases, the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics is accountable for ensuring day-to-day alignment between the approved budget and the Service Delivery Plan.
[2] No email approval is required from the CEO. CEO approval means the CEO is briefed on the budget plan and can provide direction verbally of approval or required adjustments.

National Level Organization & Features

All of the organizational elements applicable to divisional-level operations apply to national-level operations. National level operations have the following additional organizational features:

Table 6.12: Features of National Level Operations

Feature	Rationale/Purpose
Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics and the Red Cross Coordinating Officer	• For national level operations, the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, consults with the DVP and DDE to appoint an RCCO. • RCCO reports to the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, who is accountable for the operation and assumes oversight and management responsibility from RE or DVP if incident was established at a lower level.

	• RCCO supports the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics in overseeing and managing the DRO.
Region to DRO Transition Process	• All L4+ operations conduct a Region-to-DRO transition meeting as soon as the National DRO Director assumes command. The purpose of the Region-to-DRO transition is to ensure a complete and orderly transition to National operations. • The RCCO convenes the transition call and uses the DRO Transition Checklist to manage the call. In addition to the RCCO, the following positions participate in the call: Division Disaster Executive (if not the RCCO), Regional Executive(s), Regional Disaster Officer(s), DRO Director, DRO Chief of Staff (if assigned), National Assistant Director for Operations, National Assistant Director for External Relations, and the Division Vice President (optional).
DOCC Activation	• DOCC may transition to a *Level 1* activation to support active disaster relief operation(s). (See the DOCC Activation page on OneSource.) • National headquarters program staff exercises significant oversight over program execution and supports disaster relief operations with expertise, communicating with stakeholders, and providing doctrine updates.
National Sync Calls and Increased Use of Business Intelligence	The DOCC typically conducts regular DRO sync calls with disaster relief operations leadership to: • Review business intelligence for all major service and support lines • Assess performance against planning; • Align and adjust efforts; • Set strategic operational priorities.
Advance Operational Planning	The DOCC assigns a National Planner to conduct large-scale advance operational planning and to support planners at the disaster relief operation.
Advanced deployment of Logistics and Staffing Services	The VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics may phase deployment of Logistics and Staff Services responders in advance of other human and material resources to receive, organize, and track arriving human and material resources.
Activation of National Incident Command Team (NICT), and/or the National Response Management Team (NRMT)	The VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics may activate and deploy the NICT and/or NRMT members to: • Assume leadership positions on the disaster relief operation (including District Directors and site managers for mega-shelters/other large-scale service delivery); • Augment the leadership in place; • Refresh leadership teams; • Serve as special mission teams.
Organize Service Delivery on Large Operations	The DRO Director typically uses Zone Coordinators, districts, or a hybrid model to ensure appropriate service delivery across the theater of operations.

	Districts, temporary tactical units established to focus on service delivery in specified geographic boundaries, may be implemented when approved by VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics. See Organizing Service Delivery on Large Operations.
National Partner Coordination Calls and Operational Updates	National headquarters Community Engagement & Partnerships convenes national coordination calls and issues written operational updates to national-level partners.
Disaster Assessment	• National headquarters Situational Awareness and Decisions Support (SADS) supports strategic planning for disaster assessment (DA). • DRO Headquarters leads operational planning for damage assessment. • Districts manage the tactical implementation and logistics and utilize local knowledge to inform Disaster Assessment teams working within their geography.

See the *Differences at the National Level* sections below for section-specific ways in which a national-level operation is different from regional and divisional operations.

See the Operational Tables of Organization / Position-Assignment Charts job tool for sample tables of organization for divisional and national operations.

Escalating to Higher Financial Levels: Triggers

Sync calls, business intelligence, mapping, and analytics are critical for national-level operations. The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics and Senior Director, Disaster Finance carefully monitor and require updated Service Delivery Plans, monitor performance against plans, and project costs to determine whether and when to escalate the financial level of these operations.

Changes in the financial level of national-level operations are managed in the DOCC and do not typically drive changes in operational structure. Operational requirements drive operational structure, which in turn drive the costs that lead to escalating financial levels.

National Level Differences

National level operations indicate a significant increase in incident size and complexity and require a much greater commitment of resources. The sections below describe some areas that are unique to national-level operations.

Workforce Differences: National Level

- The operation may require multiple staff shelters if sufficient hotels are not available.
- For Operations Management (OM) positions for Assistant Directors and above, staff assignments are adjudicated by the Adjudication Team, a part of the National Incident Command Team (NICT) at national headquarters to ensure appropriate distribution of human resources.
- National-level operations may involve long deployments and potentially higher levels of stress, requiring disaster relief operation leaders to:
  - Increase support for staff well-being; and
  - Provide increased resources to support the work of the Workforce section.
- Disaster leadership may establish one or more Volunteer Intake Processing Centers to manage an influx of disaster event-based volunteers (see the Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Activity Toolkit).
- Disaster leadership often uses more remote workers and virtual teams.
- Disaster Mental Health, Disaster Health Services, and Disaster Spiritual Care may activate Direct Deployment to meet staffing requirements.

Operations Differences: National Level

- Event usually impacts multiple counties and/or states, often with widespread damage;
- Isolated pockets of damage may cut clients off from services for days; service delivery may be impacted by drive distances and impacts to infrastructure.
- Unsolicited donations management may become challenging (see Distribution of Emergency Supplies (DES) Toolkit for guidance).
- Due to the large influx of responders, DRO leaders may choose to use a Mobilization Center to support incoming responders and help direct them to their first work assignments.

Feeding Differences: National Level

- When warranted, national headquarters may activate Southern Baptist Disaster Relief and other national feeding partners when preparing for a disaster at this level.
- Disaster relief operations should expect that field kitchens strive to reach initial production no later than 72 hours after request and scale up to peak production (if needed) several days later.

Sheltering Differences: National Level

- Large-scale shelters may open and remain active for weeks.

- Government partners may want shelters to close before clients have made adequate transition plans. Effective use of the Elected Official Liaison Network (EOLN) may mitigate this. See Doctrine Bulletin: Elected Official Liaison Network for guidance.
- Adjacent communities may have radically different views and approaches to opening and closing shelters.
- It may be challenging to clearly establish the Red Cross role in a shelter and determine appropriate communication links with state and county Emergency Operations Centers for reporting purposes.

Shelter Counts:
Operations must establish clear direction to all shelter leadership about timing, methodology, and daily reporting of shelter population counts to achieve consistency across all reports, including those of the:

- FROST;
- National headquarters;
- FEMA;
- State and local government Emergency Operations Centers.
- For more information see Disaster Operations Order 012-21: Reporting Systems and Procedures for Shelter Opening, Closing, and Counting.

Shelter Management Transfers:

- Formally plan for and document management transfers and communicate about them to DRO Headquarters and government partners. See the Sheltering Standards and Procedures and Shelter Management Transfer Plan Template for guidance.

Logistics Differences: National Level

- Initial supplies of material resources may be sent proactively to the disaster relief operation or to a staging area based on initial impact projections (See Resource Management chapter).
- In multi-state operations, disaster leadership may establish a Logistics staging area in or near the affected area.
- The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics may activate the Offers Desk to coordinate mission-driven, in-kind donations.
- When closing shelters, Logistics pays particular attention to financial liabilities incurred during large-scale sheltering. See the Shelter Management Transfer Plan Template for guidance.
- National headquarters Disaster Logistics Center (DLC) sets a cap for rental vehicles on all Level 5 and above disaster relief operations based on historical data on the number of responders.
    - In the Stabilization phase of the disaster relief operation, the cap converts to a ratio of vehicles to responders on the ground of 1:2.5.

- The DRO Director may request approval to change this cap from the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics.

Information & Planning Differences: National Level

- If invited, the Red Cross must participate in FEMA and state emergency management agency planning task forces.
- Greater federal and state involvement may bring substantial resources to the incident and require sustained high-level, and often personal, engagement by national headquarters senior leaders, the Division Vice President, the Regional Executive, and/or the Red Cross Coordinating Officer.
- When establishing a national-level disaster relief operation, the National Assistant Director Operations & Planning assisted by the National Planner executes advance operational planning at the DOCC. Advance operational planning transfers to the Assistant Director Information & Planning on the disaster relief operation, assisted by the Advance Planner, when the operation transitions to disaster relief operation-led/national headquarters-supported.

External Relations Differences: National Level

- The Elected Officials Liaison Network works with disaster relief operation leadership to determine the extent of support impacted executives need in managing their elected official relationships.
- Staffing and/or establishing direct communication with all Emergency Operations Centers at all levels of government is a priority.
- Disaster Public Affairs establishes and ensures the integration of social and traditional media monitoring directly into the disaster relief operation; see Doctrine Bulletin: Social Engagement and Resolution During a Disaster Response.
- On-site Disaster Public Affairs support, including the Advanced Public Affairs Team (APAT), photographers, and videographers, is essential to effective public affairs at this level.
- Increased media attention generates donor and partner interest, making Disaster Fundraising and Community Engagement & Partnerships critical parts of day-to-day operations at this level.
- A disaster relief operation connects with a larger number (50+) of national and local partners across different areas.
- Latino Engagement Teams are deployed as part of the Community Engagement & Partnerships function to better support impacted Latino communities.

Client Care Differences: National Level

- Level 5 is the first organizational level when providing Immediate Financial Assistance (except disaster health, mental health, and

spiritual care services) requires a decision from the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics.

- Disaster intake and casework must begin during the initiating phase of the disaster relief operation.
- Depending on the generosity of the American public and the cost of the response, Long-Term Recovery may be authorized. Long-Term Recovery operations often continue well after Response operations have concluded.
- When authorized, the Red Cross may provide any of the following services in close coordination with state, federal, and local governments and nonprofit partners that have expertise in recovery services:
  - Financial assistance for households in need of long-term recovery;
  - Support for community-based long-term recovery efforts through grants to nonprofits;
  - Support for organizations providing behavioral health services across the affected counties;
  - Funding to other long-term recovery services such as long-term recovery committees, financial counseling, and programs that assist people with disabilities, the elderly, and underserved communities.

Finance Difference: National Level

- Finance deploys an Assistant Director Finance and managers for all national-level operations.

Organizing Service Delivery on Large Operations

Organizing Service Delivery: Considerations

The DRO Director has a number of capabilities and options for organizing the disaster relief operation structure throughout the lifecycle of a large operation. In most cases, the DRO Director task-organizes to provide service delivery. The major variable in choosing which structure to use is the level of capability required and available to meet client needs.

At some point, when there are hundreds of clients, responders have neither the time nor the resources to do anything other than operate. As a general rule, when these responders are fully engaged in delivering service directly to clients, they cannot also be expected to assume responsibility for the full range of operational functions.

Likewise, the DRO Director and Assistant Directors must be free to concentrate on operational-level tasks:

- Planning for, resourcing, and overseeing the disaster relief operation;

- Establishing relationships and coordinating internally with government and non-government partners for mission accomplishment; and
- Caring for and fully supporting a large, dynamic workforce.

Collectively, these considerations inform how a DRO Director chooses to organize service delivery for large operations.

Organizing Service Delivery: Options

As large operations expand and contract, the DRO Director may choose among several options for organizing service delivery.

While these options are available to meet service delivery needs, the VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics must approve the establishment of districts on all operations and determines the operational model of all national-level operations.

Table 6.13: Options for Organizing Service Delivery on Large DROs

Option	Description
Service Delivery by DRO HQ	• Used routinely for regional and smaller divisional-level operations. • Assistant Director Operations directly executes service delivery by planning for, establishing, resourcing, and operating service delivery sites throughout the operation. • Other operational functions provide direct support to Operations. • When delivering multiple lines of service across an expansive area, span of control alone can make this option unmanageable. • As response operations begin to wind down, however, this model may become more appropriate
Zone Coordinators	• Used when service delivery is too complex for handling day-to-day operations and forward planning from DRO Headquarters. • Zone Coordinators are responsible for supporting day-to-day operations within their defined service area or geography. • All Zone Coordinators activities align with the priorities and objectives set by DRO Headquarters. • **Zone Coordinators are used in place of (not in addition to) districts.**
Districts	• DRO establishes districts that are structured and resourced to separate operational responsibilities from most support responsibilities. • See the Districts: When to Establish section below for potential indicators.

	• All district activities align with the priorities and objectives set by DRO Headquarters. • **For geographies where districts are established, the DRO does not use Zone Coordinators.**
Hybrid Approach	• DRO establishes districts where operationally intensive service delivery is occurring, while undertaking direct service delivery under the immediate control of the Assistant Director Operations in other, less service-intense locations. • May be useful in operations with a combination of heavily and lightly impacted communities and in the later phases of an operation when services may be winding down in some locations but not in others.

Zone Coordinators and Districts

Zone Coordinators and districts are methods of dividing the geography of a large DRO to ensure consistent service delivery based on the needs of local communities. The table below summarizes considerations for choosing between the two; this information is meant to be a guide but each situation should be considered wholistically when choosing. These methods are distinct and separate and are NOT used simultaneously.

Table 6.14: Zone Coordinators and Districts

	Zone Coordinators	Districts
Generally used for	Level 4+	Level 5+
Approval for use	AD Operations in consultation with DRO Director	Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics must approve the establishment of districts.
Definition	Defined geographic area within the service delivery area of a DRO supported by a Zone Coordinator.	Defined geographic area within the service delivery area of a DRO supported by a local and structured tactical team.
Overview	Zone Coordinators (formerly IDADs): • Leaders who provide oversight and coordination within geographical boundaries defined by the AD Operations. • Ensure tactical service delivery is occurring as proscribed. • Act as eyes and ears of the Operations section / report back when: ○ Services are lacking with in their assigned geography or	• Districts are structured and resourced to separate operational responsibilities from most support responsibilities. • Districts are not mini-disaster relief operations: ○ Districts deliver services locally and inform DRO Headquarters of local conditions, needs, and requirements.

	Zone Coordinators	Districts
	○ The tactics outlined in the IAP are not being achieved to Red Cross standards. • Act as point of contact for chapter Executive Directors for reported concerns or problems with service delivery.	○ DRO Headquarters provides districts with only the functions and resources necessary to deliver direct services.
Responsibility for Tactical Service Delivery	• DRO Headquarters remains responsible for tactical service delivery.	• The district is responsible for tactical service delivery in its limited geographic area.
Management of relationships and reporting	DRO Headquarters	District
Support functions / technical guidance	Information & Planning, Logistics, Workforce, External Relations, Finance at DRO Headquarters provide support and technical guidance to District Directors and Zone Coordinators.	
Office/ Headquarters	Operate out of DRO Headquarters and itinerate in their defined geography (no separate location).	Operate from a District Office and are located as close to the affected clients as is safe and practical. Serves as the coordination point for delivering services.
Leadership Reporting	District Directors and Zone Coordinators report to the Assistant Director Operations at DRO Headquarters.	
When to Use	• Used when there are no districts supporting service delivery but additional support is needed for one or more geographical areas. • Potential triggers include: ○ Enough complexity that DRO Headquarters is unable to provide daily direct oversight but can maintain tactical control; ○ The number of service delivery sites; ○ The geographic spreAD service delivery.	• Used when there are no Zone Coordinators and when the complexity of an operation drives a need for a localized operational structure. • Potential triggers include: ○ Unsurmountable communication barriers; ○ Transportation barriers.

When to Use Zone Coordinators / Districts	A Zone Coordinator operates within geographical boundaries defined by the AD Operations to oversee service delivery. A district, on the other hand, is geography with its own temporary tactical operational structure generally operating from a District Office that serves as the coordination point for

delivering services. A district is responsible for service delivery in its limited geographic area.

The following may influence the decision to use Zone Coordinators or districts:

- Type of incident;
- Duration;
- Complexity factors;
- Hazards and safety factors;
- Resources available;
- Distances between personnel and resources.

The guiding principle in organizing geographic service delivery is span of control. There are at least three models to consider when determining geographies:

1. Divide an area according to existing jurisdictional boundaries, like counties, tribal reservations, parishes, municipalities, and Red Cross chapter boundaries.
2. Divide an area using natural terrain or other prominent geographical features, such as rivers.
3. Align with government-established Incident Command System divisions and/or branches.

Disaster relief operations can adjust geographical service delivery boundaries to meet the needs of clients and affected communities or to align with government district operations, provided the size of the geography corresponds to appropriate span-of-control guidelines.

Appointing Zone Coordinators

Zone Coordinators (formerly Itinerating Deputy Assistant Directors/IDADs) are used when the size of an operation indicates that additional support is needed for one or more specified geographical areas. Potential triggers include:

- The number of service delivery sites;
- The geographic spreAD service delivery;
- When there are no districts supporting service delivery areas.

Each Zone Coordinator is assigned to a defined area for which they are responsible. DRO Directors are responsible for ensuring that each Zone Coordinator has the financial tools and authority to meet immediate needs of that area by accessing and purchasing resources close to the location of need. These tools may include a P-Card or other financial tool.

See Chapter 7 for more Zone Coordinator responsibilities.

Zone Coordinators do not have authority to reassign or change work assignments -- that authority is vested in DRO Headquarters activity leads. However, for particularly large or complicated operations, Zone Coordinators may be assigned a small team of Mass Care and/or Client Care supervisors as subject-matter experts. This team:

- Is intended to support and coordinate service delivery with the DRO Headquarters activity leads;
- Is based out of DRO Headquarters;
- Does not directly manage the activities in their zone.

Establishing Districts

The DRO Director and Red Cross Coordinating Officer make a recommendation on the DRO Headquarters/District construct for approval by the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics.

Disaster leadership establishes districts by dividing an incident into physical or geographical areas of operation. When establishing districts, the DRO Director is responsible for ensuring:

- The workforce is notified about the timing and other details of transition;
- The workforce is informed of any changes to operational roles and responsibilities.

District Offices: Where Are They Located?

District Offices are located in the communities they serve, so the disaster relief operation locates each District Office as close to the affected clients as is safe and practical. Disaster relief operation leadership strives to locate their DRO Headquarters and District Offices in different locations to ensure separation of duties and focus.

District Office / DRO HQ Relationship

When established, districts and DRO Headquarters have different and complementary roles and responsibilities.

In general, DRO Headquarters consists of all Red Cross sections on the operation, including Command, Operations, Workforce, Logistics, Information & Planning, Finance, and External Relations.

To ensure districts can accomplish established priorities and objectives, DRO Headquarters:

- Focuses on priorities, objectives, and strategies; and
- Provides technical guidance and coordinating resources and support.

A district is an Operations element that focuses on tactical service delivery. District structure is oriented toward Response and Client Care operations.

The Deputy District Director serves as the liaison to the Assistant Director for External Relations and the Elected Officials Liaison Network to ensure timely flow of critical communications and decisive action to resolve operational issues in the district as identified by partners and other sources.

DRO Headquarter Chiefs, Managers, and Coordinators provide technical guidance to their counterparts in the districts. They:

- Establish regular communication between DRO Headquarters and District Offices;
- Ensure there is a unified understanding of operational and strategic initiatives and there are adequate resources to meet them.
- For example, DRO Headquarters Chiefs, Managers, and Coordinators convene regular (generally daily) conference calls with their counterparts in the District Offices to review planning assumptions, resource requirements, emergent needs, and any concerns or barriers. The Daily call DRO Headquarters Chiefs, Managers, and Coordinators, and their counterparts in the District, should be a scheduled part of the daily activity and inserted into the meeting schedule for the DRO.

The disaster relief operation structure establishes formal lines of communication to expedite problem solving, issue resolution, and clarification of programs and doctrine. DRO Headquarters Chiefs, Managers, and Coordinators are the communicators to the DOCC and the national headquarters workforce. When possible, channel all disaster relief operation-related communications through the DRO Headquarter Chiefs, Managers, and Coordinators, including communications from district leadership.

See the DOCC Activation page for additional information.

Service Delivery Sites

- At service delivery sites (like shelters or multi-agency resource centers), all positions assigned to the site have a direct reporting line relationship at the site and receive technical guidance through their function.
- The Site Supervisor coordinates all activities at the site. (For instance, at a shelter, all Disaster Health Services and Disaster Mental Health responders assigned to that site report to the Site Supervisor, regardless of their function.)
- Based on the group, activity, or unit that has the principal activity at the site, the following factors are responsible for determining the Site Supervisor.

Table 6.15: Determining the Site Supervisor

Site	Decision-Maker
DRO Headquarters-led sites	Appropriate Assistant Director
District Office-led sites	Deputy District Director

EOC Reporting

Emergency Operations Centers (EOC): When multiple functional activities report to an Emergency Operations Center, one is appointed as Site Director. This appointee is typically the primary relationship holder with the emergency management agency. This is not a separate role but is assumed in standard Emergency Operations Centers responsibilities.

Districts: What They Do

A district focuses on developing the tactics to provide direct services to individuals, families, and the communities in their jurisdiction consistent with the operational priorities set by the DRO Director.

When coordinating operations from a district office, districts:

- Determine the needs of their jurisdiction;
- Execute timely service delivery within their jurisdiction as outlined in the Incident Action Plan (IAP) or Advance Operational Plan (AOP);
- Build and sustain relationships in their jurisdiction consistent with priorities and objectives of the disaster relief operation;
- Communicate and report service delivery activity and resource needs/shortfalls to DRO Headquarters;
- Communicate and report relationship management, media issues, and resource needs/shortfalls to DRO Headquarters;
- Serve as the coordination point for the assigned district workforce to arrive, check-in, and receive assignments;
- Care for the workforce (including event-based volunteers) by providing meaningful assignments and defined supervisory structure;
- Identify and communicate business intelligence needs for district-level tactical planning to DRO Headquarters.

Districts: What They DO NOT Do

Districts are not mini-disaster relief operations. Districts deliver services locally and keep DRO Headquarters informed on local conditions, needs, and requirements. DRO Headquarters provides districts with only those non-operations functions and resources necessary to deliver direct services.

Districts: Day-to-Day Mission

Districts are task-organized using the Red Cross command structure to provide services as close to the clients as possible. The District Director leads a daily process outlined in the table below.

Table 6.16: Day-to-Day Mission of Districts

Step	Action
1	Ensure regular communications between the District Office and the DRO Headquarters to verify alignment with strategies and priorities.

Table 6.16: Day-to-Day Mission of Districts

Step	Action
2	Receive and employ resources provided by the disaster relief operation to deliver services with our partners consistent with the established priorities and objectives of the DRO for the current operational period.
3	Inform the Assistant Director Operations of proposed service delivery requirements and tactics for the next operational period.
4	Oversee and assess each service delivery site in the district to ensure the quality and consistency of services and determine whether and when to scale up or scale down each site.
5	Follow the Incident Action Plan and provide the disaster relief operation with situational awareness, updated planning assumptions, and reports on performance to support the overall planning process.

District Organization

Under all circumstances:

- District Directors report directly to the Assistant Director Operations at DRO Headquarters. This provides District Directors with a single point of contact to facilitate coordination between the DRO Headquarters and the district.
- Leaders of operations functions in districts (Response and Client Care) report directly to the District Director.
- Leaders of support functions in districts (Logistics, Workforce, Information & Planning, External Relations, and Finance) report directly to their respective DRO Headquarters AD or Chief with a dotted line to the District Director or Deputy District Director.
    - For example, the District Logistics Lead reports directly to the DRO Logistics Chief of Logistics and has a dotted reporting line to the District Director recognizing this principal coordination relationship.
    - External Relations does not have a District Lead. District Government Operations and Community, Engagement & Partnerships Coordinators report directly to their DRO Headquarters Chief with a dotted reporting line to the Deputy District Director.
- All subordinate coordinators and supervisors in districts report through their district direct management line whether in support or operations functions with dotted line relationships to their commensurate leaders at the DRO Headquarters.
    - For example, the District Facilities Coordinator reports directly to District Logistics Lead with a dotted line to the DRO Headquarters Facilities Manager.
    - As another example, Local Emergency Operations Centers Liaisons report directly to their District Government Operations Coordinator

with a dotted line to the DRO Headquarters Government Operations Manager.

- Dotted-line relationships between district and DRO Headquarters responders represent the importance of these support relationships where DRO Headquarters supervisors provide technical guidance and subject matter expertise to their district counterparts.
- DRO Headquarters Activity Managers are encouraged to convene regularly scheduled calls with District Coordinators to provide a forum for information sharing such as successes in overcoming specific operation-specific barriers.
- Districts do not operate autonomously. All functional activities in a district must align with the corresponding group within the disaster relief operation's structure. For example, a district cannot stand up a casework activity without the oversite and support of a Client Care group at DRO Headquarters.
- 70 percent of assigned district staff engage in direct service delivery.

See Operational Tables of Organization /Position-Assignment Charts for a depiction of the relationships between DRO Headquarters and the districts.

Districts: Resourcing

Districts are resourced in the quantities necessary to meet the service delivery level planning assumptions outlined in the Advance Operational Plan (AOP). District Directors shift available resources within the district to meet geographic fluctuations in service delivery. If the Assistant Director Operations and the District Director agree that service delivery level planning assumptions have changed, then the district's resources are adjusted to meet those service delivery assumptions.

District Directors aggregate and submit to DRO Headquarters all resource requests from service sites and other direct services end users in their districts using the standard processes. The Assistant Director Operations adjudicates and approves, adjusts, or disapproves all resource requests from all districts. The Assistant Director Operations coordinates with the Assistant Director Logistics and the Assistant Director Workforce to ensure the fulfillment of material and human resource requests and reports any known issues that could affect resourcing. Thereafter, the Assistant Directors of Logistics and Workforce fulfill the requests and coordinate with the district leads on assignments, transportation, and delivery.

The example feedback flow chart below illustrates the requirements for the communication of status updates regarding active human and/or material resource requests.

The figure below shows a simplified resource flow for material and human resources for the provision of direct services in a district in a divisional- or national-level operation where districts are established.



Figure 6.2: District Resource Flow

The same process is followed to request staff or material resources:

- *Disaster Requisition Form (F6409)* used for material resources and submitted to the AD Logistics.
- *Staff Request Form* are used for staffing needs and submitted to the AD Workforce.

For a detailed process flow, please see the Appendix.

Requests for resources that are not in support of direct services and that cannot be filled within the district must be approved by the District Director and submitted to the respective DRO Headquarters section Chief for concurrence.

A District Director exercises purchase authority in the following circumstances:

- At the beginning of a response when the event has not stabilized;
- When there is a sudden change in the disaster, like a dam failure or tornado;
- When there is loss of connectivity between the district and the DRO Headquarters; or
- In instances where normal resource request processes could impede timely service delivery. For example:
  - A temporary wheelchair ramp to allow access to a shelter;
  - A baby changing station for a newly opened shelter;
  - More meals because a dam fails, causing a spike in shelter population.

District purchases may include expendable items, such as meals, diapers, bug spray, or basic office supplies, and/or non-expendable items, such as grab bars for restroom accessibility or baby changing stations. Purchases should align with the priorities and objectives set forth in the disaster relief operation's Service Delivery Plan (SDP).

When operating within their home region, personnel acting as District Directors may spend amounts up to their normal purchase limits if it is necessary to address critical operational needs that cannot be met through normal resource request processes. When operating outside their home region, District Directors adhere to the following limits:

District Director Expense Limits

Table 6.17: Expense Limits for District Directors

Financial Level	Expense Limits
4-7*	Up to $1,000 on expendable items per operational period; Up to $1,000 on non-expendable items per operational period unless there is an extraordinary disaster-caused circumstance requiring more.

*The DRO Director may increase District Director daily expense limits within the guidelines provided in the Financial Manual of Policies and Procedures (FMPP). DRO Directors must submit a written copy of this authorization to the Assistant Director Finance for the operation.

This guidance is consistent with and does not supersede the *Financial Manual of Policies and Procedures*.

District Directors notify the Assistant Director Operations and the Assistant Director Logistics prior to or at the earliest opportunity following such purchases. District Directors must follow normal procurement procedures when making these purchases, including forwarding receipts and a Disaster Requisition Form (F6409) to DRO Headquarters at the earliest opportunity.

Districts: Consolidating / Demobilizing

Districts are temporary and rarely remain established for the duration of an operation. Planning to scale down, consolidate, and demobilize district operations begins with an assessment of a district's progress against the Service Delivery Plan, as well as a determination of approximately when a district will complete its direct services.

When planning to demobilize or consolidate, the District Director, Assistant Director Operations, and DRO Director establish internal milestones including the following:

- Direct service delivery (such as sheltering, feeding, and distribution of emergency supplies) ends in a district but casework is ongoing and can be supported remotely.
- Service delivery and disaster casework are complete. Client Care coordination is required, but physical presence is not.

- A district relocates or consolidates with another district due to the displacement/evacuation of clients or safety concerns.
- Scarcity of resources requires a consolidation of personnel and/or material assets.

The district demobilization plan may include:

- The time at which:
  DRO Headquarters has sufficient span of control to assume direct control of any remaining service delivery in the district;
  Sheltering and feeding services are no longer needed;
  All clients have received follow-up disaster casework , and cases are set to close or be reviewed;
  Facilities are consolidated or closed;
  Equipment and supplies can be made ready for shipment;
  An appropriate internal and external announcement of intentions is prepared and released.
- The status of the deployed workforce and potential need for a refresh of assignments;
- Consideration for the notice and assessment of impact on government and service delivery partners.

Disaster relief operation leadership works in close cooperation with the leadership of the district(s) and region(s) to plan for scaling down and reverting district operations to DRO Headquarters or the region.

Large Disaster Relief Operation Support Mechanisms

DRO Call Center	At the request of the DRO Director or at the direction of the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics a DRO Call Center may be activated to ensure timely and effective communication with the public. The DRO Call Center may add remote teams to support operations in the areas of Immediate Financial Assistance client registration, health and mental health services, disability integration support, and reunification. Once authorized, the DRO Call Center scales to meet client call volume. The DRO Call Center gathers metrics to inform disaster relief operation and DOCC leadership of call trends, such as number of calls received within geographic areas and expressed needs.
Command / Companion Structure	To efficiently assign and use staff in an area with significant, ongoing, and multiple operations, national headquarters may implement a command/ companion structure. In this structure the Command DRO is used to support and track all

staffing within a geography. Additional DROs become “companions” to account for service delivery and material resource costs associated to specific incidents or hazards.

Table 6.18: Command / Companion Structure

DRO Type	Command DRO	Companion DRO
Description	NHQ designates one DRO as the **Command DRO**. Command DROs are used to support and track all staffing within a geography for multiple DROs	One or more **Companions DROs** are assigned to the Command DRO established by National headquarters Companion DROs may be active for one incident or for multiple incidents disasters depending on time, geography, and complexity of service delivery.
Reporting	• Submit IAPs covering Command DRO and all related Companion DROs. • IPT, SDP, and 5266 for Command DRO only based on the schedule established by NHQ Operations and using the business rules above; and	IPT, SDP, and 5266 based on the schedule established by NHQ Operations and using the business rules above; and
Cost Accounting	All costs related to workforce (regardless of incident) including travel, lodging, rental vehicles, Mission Cards, Cost incurred for major infrastructure (like warehouses or leased DRO Headquarters space). In specific circumstances, NHQ Operations may direct that all service delivery costs associated with a specific incident be accounted to the Command DRO, as well.	Specific service delivery and material resource costs arising from one or more incident as designated by NHQ Operations. Workforce and related costs are never assigned to Companion DROs—these costs remain with the Command DRO for the duration of the Area Command.

Mobilization Center: Definition and Triggers

A Mobilization Center may be established when there is a significant influx of workforce for a large division or national operation. A Mobilization Center:

- Can be used on any operation, regardless of other DRO structure and organization.
- Is predominantly used in Level 5 and above operations during the Initiation phase
- Triggers include:

  - Significant influx of workforce;
  - The use of multiple airports impact across multiple counties;
  - Workforce has long driving distance to work sites.
- Closes when the influx of workforce slows.
- May be co-located at a DRO Headquarters for a small DRO or may be located in a separate location that can better support a large influx of workers.

Mobilization Center: Staffing and Deployment

A Mobilization Center is led by a Mobilization Center Supervisor. The Site Supervisor has a GAP of OM/GEN/MN or above and reports to the Deputy Assistant Director Operations and is responsible for:

- Ensuring workers receive appropriate information, care, and support until their work location is identified.
- Ensuring responders receive their task assignments as directed by Activity Leads. (Assignments include supervisor name.)

The Mobilization Center also contains staff appropriate to ensuring arriving workers and those awaiting an assignment are healthy and accounted for, remain well-informed, and receive care during their wait. Mobilization Center staff includes workers from the following activities:

- Staff Planning & Support
- Lodging
- Transportation
- Staff Health
- Training
- Disaster Services Technology

When a Mobilization Center is in place, national headquarters determines the quantities of staff being deployed to the Center. These numbers will be reflected in the NHQ Advance Operational Plan (AOP). It is not necessary to issue a Staff Request when a Mobilization Center is in place.

- Level 1-3: Issue Staff Request as normal.
- Level 4+: If there is no NHQ Advance Operational Plan, issue a Staff Request as normal.
- Level 5+: If there is a NHQ Advance Operational Plan, do not submit a staff request during the Initiation Phase. Your staff is coming.
  - Once an SDP is in place, use a staff request to request more staff.

When workers are assigned to their work site, responsibility for the worker shifts from the Mobilization Center to their work assignment supervisor.

All staff reporting to the Mobilization Center are assigned to the DRO. Multiple arrival locations can feed a single Center, and as long as the site is open, workers being reassigned may return to the Center to await new assignments.

Responsibilities: NHQ, DRO Headquarters, Districts in Large Operations

Tiers of Command: Overview

This section focuses on the functions, responsibilities, and capabilities of the three tiers of command found in national and large divisional Red Cross operations:

1. National Headquarters
2. DRO Headquarters
3. District Office

Building on the characteristics common to all operations, this section distinguishes the roles of each tier of command and describes how these units operate together as a structured, unified team. All tiers work collaboratively to accomplish one set of goals: to meet client needs, to care for the workforce, and to support and strengthen community and partner relationships.

Please see the Operational Tables of Organization / Position-Assignment Charts for a sample organization for a national-level operation, including all tiers of command.

National Headquarters Disaster Services

National headquarters Disaster Services is a permanent corporate structure led by the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics and the Vice President, Disaster Programs. It operates across the continuum of disaster relief operations and across all organizational and financial levels. National headquarters encompasses and is accountable for overseeing all Disaster Services programs and operations.

National headquarters Disaster Services provides programmatic leadership, direction, oversight, and support as appropriate to divisions, regions, and disaster relief operations at all times, including during national-level operations.

Disaster Operations Coordination Center (DOCC)

The Disaster Operations Coordination Center (DOCC) at national headquarters is a permanent virtual coordination structure that operates across the continuum of disaster relief operations and across all organizational and financial levels.

In national-level operations, the DOCC serves as the senior tier of operational command led by the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics. The DOCC:

- Ensures that leaders at all levels prioritize the health and safety of the workforce at all times;
- Establishes strategic priorities for and across disaster relief operations with input from Red Cross Coordinating Officers and DRO Directors;
- Resources operations and adjudicates resources among multiple disaster relief operations based on need, availability, and risk;
- Coordinates and facilitates coordination among and between active disaster relief operations;
- Coordinates and collaborates with national-level partners, including the federal government, Emergency Support Function (ESF) partners, national businesses or donors, and non-government organizations;
- Conducts strategic planning, including advance operational planning, and supports disaster relief operation planning efforts, as needed;
- Manages and delivers national-level messaging and communications;
- Determines the availability of and allocates financial resources for response and Client Care, supports the disaster relief operation in deriving the operational budget from the Service Delivery Plan, assists with monitoring progress against the plan, and oversees the financial management of disaster relief operations;
- Provides programmatic direction, oversight, and support to disaster relief operations;
- Communicates with fundraisers and donors at the national level;
- Keeps senior leadership informed and ensures operational performance consistent with senior leadership expectations;
- At the discretion of the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, activates to provide 24-hour support to disaster relief operations;
    - During activation, identifies program support leads responsible for providing technical and program guidance by establishing and distributing an Incident Operating Summary (IOS);
- Schedules calls for DRO leaders to meet with program leads to discuss new doctrine and updated guidance at the start of a national-level disaster relief operation.
- The DOCC oversees the management of multiple incidents and/or large incidents that cross jurisdictional boundaries. These incidents may share an RCCO or Deputy RCCOs, but the Red Cross does not establish a separate Area Command.

DRO Headquarters

DRO Headquarters is a temporary structure responsible for providing direction, guidance, and coordination of resources. It supports all responders assigned to the operation and all districts (if established) to accomplish operational priorities and objectives established by the DRO Director.

In operations at all organizational levels where a DRO Headquarters is established, its primary focus is to:

- Establish operational priorities and objectives for the disaster relief operation;
- Care for the safety and well-being of the disaster relief operation workforce;
- Execute and oversee service delivery to clients in accordance with the approved Service Delivery Plan;
- Operate within the approved field operations budget, which is derived from the Service Delivery Plan;
- Coordinate directly with divisional and/or national disaster leadership at the DOCC;
- Conduct operational planning in support of strategic plans set by national headquarters including advance operational planning for the disaster relief operation;
- Report to the DOCC on plans, operational information, operational performance, unmet needs, and accomplishments;
- Provide clarity to the workforce about processes and procedures;
- Manage the request, adjudication, and allocation of human and material resources, facilities, and infrastructure within the disaster relief operation;
- Coordinate internal and external relationships (specifically for the Elected Officials Liaison Network and national partners), including developing appropriate messaging to partners and the public in conjunction with Government Operations, Community Engagement & Partnerships, and Disaster Public Affairs at the DOCC;
- Implement “Every Shelter, Every Day, Every Need” making contact with every shelter, every day, and meeting every need throughout all shelter operations on the disaster relief operation;
- Establish and consolidate districts, as needed;
- Direct strategy and planning to engage the full range of partners and mobilize the community in support of the response and Client Care operations;
- Support districts in their community engagement.;
- Develop and implement tactical damage assessment plans, including the request, adjudication, and allocation of resources to districts.

District Office

A district office is a temporary, tactical organization whose primary focus is to:

- Serve clients directly in alignment with priorities and objectives established by DRO Headquarters;
- Build and sustain government and partner relationships in their assigned jurisdiction consistent with priorities and objectives of the disaster relief operation;

- Communicate and report service delivery activity and resource shortfalls/surplus to DRO Headquarters through the District Director;
- Care for the workforce (including disaster event-based volunteers) assigned to the district by providing meaningful assignments and defined supervisory structure.

Demobilization

Demobilization: Definition

Once the operation reaches a sustainment phase, it is important for leadership to plan for the demobilization phase.

The demobilization phase:

- Begins when the end of all Response service delivery has been scheduled or when all districts have closed or are scheduled to close, and the recurring need for resourcing has ended;
- Ends when disaster relief operation responsibility has been transitioned to the region.

At some point a national/divisional-level operation transitions to the region, and the region resumes its normal duties and becomes responsible for the remaining work left by the disaster relief operation. It is equally important to plan for speed-to-scale when escalating a disaster relief operation and demobilization with the intentional transition to regional operations as an operation winds down.

The DRO Director, in consultation with the Red Cross Coordinating Officer, the DOCC, and the affected region(s), develops a demobilization plan and timeline based on a template provided by the DOCC.

Demobilizing: Preparation

Before demobilizing, the DRO Director evaluates a variety factors, some of which are:

- Assess the affected area and determine if critical infrastructure and other community factors allow for Red Cross demobilization;
- Consult with elected officials at the state and local levels and their offices of emergency management and offices responsible for mass care services, including health and mental health, to assess their ongoing needs and our ability to meet those needs through the region;
- Consult with FEMA, Housing and Urban Development (HUD), Health and Human Services (HHS), and other federal partners actively involved in the response and/or recovery;
- Coordinate with partners and the range of ongoing supporting relationships

- Assess the degree to which immediate disaster-caused needs have been addressed;
- Consult with the Regional Executive to determine the readiness of the host region to resume control of operations, including the need for supplemental support;
- Consider the number of open Client Care cases, including financial control work such as fiscal review, and determine if the region has the capacity for the transition;
- Assess the long-term recovery program (if authorized) and ensure the region has adequate resources to maintain the program;
- Assess the extent to which affected clients have long-term recovery plans and available resources for long-term recovery.

Demobilization: Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics

The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics is responsible for:

- Approving all phases of demobilization from a national-level operation;
- Ensuring a coordinated and integrated approach that prevents a disruption in service delivery when the operation ends and supports the plan for community recovery;
- Working with Government Relations to ensure jurisdictional leadership is timely and appropriately briefed and consulted on Red Cross plans and intentions;
- Working with the Red Cross Coordinating Officer, Division Vice President, and Regional Executive to ensure the host division and region have the necessary resources to conclude and sustain an effective transition and are operationally ready to resume normal operations.

Demobilization: Red Cross Coordinating Officer

The Red Cross Coordinating Officer is responsible for:

- Approving all phases of demobilization from any division-level operation;
- Ensuring a coordinated and integrated approach that prevents a disruption in service delivery when the operation ends and supports the plan for community recovery;
- Developing and presenting demobilization plans to the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics for review and approval;
- Working in close cooperation with the leadership of the district(s), region(s), and division(s) to plan for transitioning operations to the region;
- Collaborating with divisional leadership and Regional Executives on the readiness, resource needs, details, timing, and engagement to transition and demobilize;
- Actively engaging the various federal, state, local, and non-governmental constituency groups in planning for the withdrawal of human and material resources from a district;

- Coordinating public messaging with the DRO Director, Assistant Director External Relations, regional/ divisional communicators, and national headquarters Disaster Public Affairs;
- Communicating any unmet needs or potential resource shortfalls to the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics;
- Ensuring continuity of new and existing relationships in collaboration with the Assistant Director External Relations, Community Engagement & Partnerships Chief, and Government Liaison Chief.

Demobilization: DRO Director

The DRO Director is responsible for:

- Coordinating with disaster relief operation leadership on the development of the demobilization plan;
- Overseeing and ensuring the reclamation and return of all resources to a ready state in accordance with the Logistics doctrine;
- Ensuring completion of all required worker, client, and partner surveys;
- Ensuring disaster responders have received an evaluation;
- Completing evaluations for all direct reports;
- Supporting the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, Red Cross Coordinating Officer, Division Vice President, Division Disaster Executive, and Regional Executive in the transition process;
- Supporting the after-action review process (if applicable).

Demobilization: Assistant Directors

All Assistant Directors are responsible for providing input into the demobilization plan and completing their actions as outlined in the plan.

Summary Table: Operational Profiles

	Regional	Divisional	National
Estimated Field Budget	• Financial Level 1: Less than $10,000 • Financial Level 2: Between $10,000 - $49,999	• Financial Level 3: $50,000 - $249,999	• Financial Level 4: $250,000 - $2.5 million • Financial Level 5: $2.5-5 million • Financial Level 6: $5-10 million • Financial Level 7: Over $10 million
Management Chain	• Existing steady-state management chain • Regional Executive is overall accountable official. No shift in authorities.	• Shifts from Regional Executive to Division Disaster Executive	• Shifts from Division Disaster Executive to Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics
Geographic Scope	• Local operations contained within a single region.	• Typically remain within the geography of a single division, but cross regional boundaries and/or are beyond the scope of a single region.	• Often affects multiple regions and/or divisions
Command & Section Responsibilities	• Command: DAT Supervisor/DAT Manager, Disaster Program Specialist (DPS), Disaster Program Manager (DPM), Senior Disaster Program Manager (SDPM), or Regional Disaster Officer (RDO) • Remaining sections: assigned to DAT or other responders.	• Full Red Cross operational command structure • DDE appoints DRO Director and is accountable for ensuring all leadership roles are filled with qualified individuals.	• Fully staffed Red Cross operational command structure • Potentially multiple disaster relief operations • Multiple districts (when approved)

	Regional	Divisional	National
Source of Responders	• Regional and local volunteers/staff and occasionally disaster event-based volunteers	• Resource first from within the division—if needed, division may request out-of-division resources through national headquarters. • Staffing force packages may be deployed. • Activation of disaster event-based volunteer plan.	• Resource first from within the region, then division, and then nationally. • Depending on other disaster activity nationwide, may employ a variety of staffing strategies, like fencing some divisions or attempting to resource from adjacent or lower-activity divisions. • May activate and deploy the National Incident Command Team, National Response Management Team (NRMT) members, multiple Division Response Management Teams, and/or other approved teams to staffparticular sections. • May reallocate human resources between disaster relief operations. • Virtual teams conduct remote work in multiple functions.
Source of Material Resources	• Existing chapter/regional inventory	• Resource first from within the division—if needed, division may request out-of-division resources through national headquarters. • Activate in-kind donations proxy accounts with big-box stores. • Leverage major in-kind donations accounts for shipping.	• Resource first from within the region, then division—then resource nationally, including partners at all levels. • Activate and leverage all appropriate major in-kind donations accounts. • May re-allocate resources between disaster relief operations.

	Regional	Divisional	National
Source of Vehicles	• Existing chapter/regional inventory and/or personally owned vehicles.	• Resource first from within the division. If needed, division may request out-of-division vehicles through national headquarters. • Leverage major in-kind donations accounts for rental vehicles and transportation.	• Resource first from within the division—if needed, the division may request out-of-division resources through national headquarters. • Leverage major in-kind donations accounts for rental vehicles and transportation. • May re-allocate vehicles between disaster relief operations.
Facilities Required	• Use existing chapter/regional facilities • Shelter(s) if other client lodging unavailable or not cost efficient	• DRO Headquarters, warehouse, and staff lodging required; all other facilities as needed.	• DRO Headquarters, District Office, warehouse, and staff lodging required; all other facilities, as needed.

Summary Table: Triggers for Level Escalation

Regional to Divisional	Divisional to National	National to Higher Level
If the region observes the following objective data, the Regional Disaster Officer notifies the Division Disaster Executive to discuss whether to elevate the response. Note: These are objective data points only. They do not take into consideration the experience and subjective judgment disaster leaders exercise when assessing the factors of incident complexity. • Preliminary projection of more than 100 homes destroyed or with major damage; • Preliminary projection of need to open more than 100 cases; • Projection that more than 250 disaster-affected people may require concurrent shelter overnight stays for more than 3 days; • Any form of evacuation affecting more than 1,000 people; • Any significant need for resources outside the region, including additional responders, equipment, or expertise; • Any evacuation or other substantial readiness activity for a major hurricane; • A confirmed report of an EF-3 or higher tornado touching down in a populated area; • Mass casualty incident* with 10 or more fatalities and/or injuries; • A Stafford Act declaration with Individual Assistance Program (see this document for regulatory thresholds) is likely.	The following data often indicates that disaster leadership should consider escalating to a national-level operation. Note: These are objective data points only. They do not take into consideration the experience and subjective judgment Red Cross disaster leaders exercise when fully assessing the factors of incident complexity. • More than 1,000 homes projected to be destroyed or have major damage; • Requirement to shelter 1,000 or more people for 7 days or more; • Any form of evacuation affecting more than 5,000 people; • Any significant need for resources outside the division, including additional responders, equipment, or expertise; • Anytime the National Transportation Safety Board is activated for a legislated transportation incident; (See the Mass Casualty Incident Response Toolkit for more information.) • Any incident with significant national-level media attention and/or high volume, sustained social media activity; • Any incident (including terrorism) involving chemical, biological,	Sync calls, business intelligence, mapping, and analytics are critical for national-level operations. The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics and Senior Director, Disaster Finance carefully monitor and require updated Service Delivery Plans, monitor performance against plans, and project costs to determine whether and when to escalate the financial level of these operations. Changes in the financial level of national-level operations are managed in the DOCC and do not typically drive changes in operational structure. Operational requirements drive operational structure, which in turn drive the costs that lead to escalating financial levels.

Regional to Divisional	Divisional to National	National to Higher Level
* For mass casualty incidents with more than 10 fatalities, serious injuries, or persons unaccounted for, the Division Disaster Executive initiates a discussion with Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics to determine the operational level.	radiological, or nuclear agents requiring protective measures; • Any Category 3 or higher hurricane approaching U.S. interests and any Category 2 or higher hurricane forecast to make landfall in U.S. interests; Any situation in which the President has issued an Emergency or Major Disaster Declaration under the Stafford Act.	

Summary Table: Process for Level Escalation

	Regional to Divisional	Divisional to National
1	Regional Disaster Officer (RDO) notifies Division Disaster Executive (DDE) of circumstances and potential need for escalation.	DDE notifies VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics of circumstances and potential need for escalation; or VP notifies DDE of national-level interest and intent to elevate.
2	DDE evaluates and works with RDO to decide to move the operation from regional level to division level and notifies the DOCC of a shift to division level. The DOCC issues a Disaster Notice establishing the effective date and outlining changes in roles, responsibilities, and authorities.	VP evaluates and works with DDE to escalate the operation from division level to national level and ensures prompt action by the DOCC to make appropriate notifications. The DOCC issues a Disaster Notice establishing the effective date and outlining changes in roles, responsibilities, and authorities.
3	DDE notifies Division Vice President (DVP). RDO notifies Regional Executive (RE). Budget authority/Service Delivery Plan (SDP) approval shifts from RE to DDE / DVP, as appropriate.	DDE notifies DVP and affected REs. VP notifies national headquarters leadership. Budget authority/SDP approval/transactional authority shifts from DVP to VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics.
4	DDE contacts VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics to coordinate resource and briefing requirements and to preview any anticipated unmet needs.	VP consults with DVP and DDE and designates a Red Cross Coordinating Officer (typically the DDE for the affected division) and DRO Director.
5	DDE designates a DRO Director and directs the establishment of a full Incident Command System (ICS) structure.	Red Cross Coordinating Officer (RCCO) engages with State Director of Emergency Management, the Federal Coordinating Officer if appointed or pre-designated, and appropriate country/parish officials.
6	DRO Director assigns Assistant Directors for all functions. Leadership team initiates operations and resourcing.	RCCO arranges for transition call between the region and incoming DRO using the *DRO Transition Checklist*.
7	DRO Director is responsible for ensuring the execution of Sheltering, Feeding, Emergency Operations Center staffing, reporting, Public Affairs/Fundraising, and caring for the workforce until the Red Cross operational command structure is fully operational.	NAD ER directs the establishment and resourcing of the EOLN.
8		VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics determines whether to activate the DOCC. VP and DOCC conduct initial sync call with the disaster relief operation to: • Assess anticipated unmet needs; • Confirm operational priorities; • Establish strategic priorities;

	Regional to Divisional	Divisional to National
		• Determines National Incident Command Team deployment or other Operations Management staffing strategy; and • Set daily routine/order of business, including publishing an Incident Operation Summary (IOS) to all national operations.
9		DRO Director is responsible for ensuring the execution of sheltering, feeding, Emergency Operations Center staffing, reporting (Financial & Statistical Information and Disaster Assessment), and Public Affairs/Fundraising until Red Cross operational command structure is fully operational.
10		VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics: • Directs dedicated media monitoring and messaging to partners and the public in conjunction with Government Operations, Community Engagement & Partnerships, and Disaster Public Affairs at the DOCC; • Directs assignment of Chief of Staff.

CHAPTER 7 – ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Chapter 7 Topics

- Responsibilities of All Leaders in a Disaster Relief Operations
- National Headquarters Leadership Positions
- Divisional and Regional Disaster Leadership Positions
- Disaster Relief Operation Positions
- Task Groups
- Elected Officials Liaison Network
- Biomedical Services in Disaster
- Services to the Armed Forces in Disaster
- Dual Roles of Division Vice Presidents, Regional Executives, and Executive Directors in Disaster Relief Operations

Responsibilities of All Leaders on a Disaster Relief Operation

Leadership, Oversight, and Execution

The positions responsible for leading, overseeing, and executing disaster relief operations are outlined in this chapter, including their responsibilities and accountabilities.

Across all of these positions, there are also shared expectations:

- **Deployment expectations**: Disaster Services full-time equivalent exempt employees at every level of the organization are expected to be qualified and available for deployment to divisional- and national-level operations. This may include virtual or remote support of operations.
- **Care and safety of the workforce**: Leadership positions are charged with preparing their workforce for operations, deployments, transition, and demobilization. Most importantly, each of these positions leads and models the guiding principle of Care and Safety for the Workforce.
- **Good stewardship**: Another guiding principle particularly applicable leadership positions is Good Stewards of Donor Dollars and Resources, which includes adherence to financial controls.

Responsibilities: All Leaders in Disaster Response Operations

Anyone tasked with supervising responders on a disaster relief operation is considered a disaster leader. All leaders on a disaster relief operation are responsible for providing a quality work environment to the workforce and ensuring that all deployed personnel are treated with respect and fairness, and have the seven following resources:

1. A job to do;
2. The training they need;
3. The technology they need to complete their job;

4. A supervisor who is communicating their responsibilities to them
5. The ability to communicate with their team
6. A place to sleep that is safe and clean;
7. A safe method of getting to their respective work location.

The general responsibilities of disaster leaders also include:

- Ensuring all members of the workforce receive access to timely and relevant information (e.g., orientation, Incident Action Plan);
- Ensuring all members of their team receive timely job performance feedback and an evaluation before leaving;
- Determining resource needs and requesting as appropriate;
- Assigning duties to and supervising staff in alignment with operational priorities;
- Maintaining visibility of and accountability for assigned personnel with regard to exact location(s), personal safety, and welfare;
- Maintaining appropriate records and logs;
- Encouraging the use of the Lessons Learned email and capturing lessons learned and best practices for continuous improvement.
- Providing shift change or transition briefs.

National Headquarters Leadership Positions

Vice Presidents, Disaster Services

With regard to active disaster response activities, the Vice Presidents, Disaster Services are accountable for:

- Overarching responsibility and oversight of all Disaster Services activities;
- Creating and maintaining the nationwide programs of Disaster Services;
- Executing preparedness, response, and recovery initiatives that are beyond the capabilities of regional or divisional units;
- Providing technical expertise and leadership in risk assessment;
- Coordinating with Division Vice Presidents and other senior Red Cross officials on the management of relationships important to the execution of Disaster Services missions;
- Keeping national disaster expenditures within budgets and policies set by the Chief Financial Officer and keeping the Chief Executive Officer, Chief Operations Officer, Regional Executives, and the President, Humanitarian Services apprised of Disaster Services quality and efficiency;
- Maintaining relationships with key government and non-governmental organizations at the national level.

Vice President, Disaster

The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics:

Operations & Logistics

- Oversees day-to-day disaster relief operations at all levels nationwide, coordinating across multiple regions and divisions;
- Oversees and leads the operation of the Disaster Relief Operations Coordination Center (DOCC) through the National Command & General Staff (NC&GS);
- Ensures cost-efficient operations, coordinating support to regions and divisions for the delivery of disaster services, and oversight and coordination of human and material resource mobilization for disaster response and recovery services;
- Sets the tone and expectations with operational leadership regarding the critical nature of the safety and care of the workforce;
- Supports the implementation of preparedness, response, and recovery programs;
- Is accountable for overseeing, achieving and sustaining the National Readiness Target;
- Is accountable for the leadership, coordination, and execution of service delivery for national-level operations, which includes:
    - Setting and attaining overall national strategy, objectives, and priorities;
    - Ensuring operations are properly organized with sufficient resources allocated from across the enterprise to conduct disaster relief operations;
    - Ensuring operations are properly led and managed;
- Adjudicates resources to ensure effective and efficient service delivery when there are concurrent disaster relief operations while ensuring national readiness;
- Ensures effective information sharing and coordination with federal partners at the national level with respect to ongoing disaster relief operations and operational readiness;
- Coordinates domestic support for international operations through International Services.

Disaster Services National Command & General Staff

During national-level operations and in the exercise of national oversight, National Assistant Directors (NADs) and the National Incident Command Team (NICT) members support the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics to ensure effective and efficient program execution by the disaster relief operations, division, and region. These teams form the National Command & General Staff.

National Assistant Directors provide operational and program oversight and management support to the DRO Director and Assistant Directors assigned to lead their respective section on disaster relief operations.

The National Incident Command Team:

- Adjudicates leadership assignments in complex disaster scenarios;
- Manages the Operations Management cadre;
- Manages after-action reviews (AAR) and DRO assessment;

- Manages the National Response Management Team (NRMT).

National Red Cross Lines of Business Staff Embedded with the DOCC

Many national Red Cross business units outside Disaster Services embed or assign liaison staff to the Disaster Relief Operations Coordination Center (DOCC) in steady state and during national and large divisional-level operations. Like the Disaster Services senior staff, these professionals provide oversight of their respective programs and lines of business and serve as a valuable resource to both national headquarters Disaster Services and the field at all times. The table below aligns DOCC embeds/liaisons with their respective sections and the assignment of liaisons to these roles is managed through the DOCC Activation page.

Table 7.2: DOCC Liaisons by Section

Section	DOCC Embed/Liaison
Logistics	In-Kind Donations Supply Management Disaster Services Technology
Workforce	Volunteer Services
External Relations	Public Affairs Fundraising Government Relations
Finance	Finance
Command	International Services Biomedical Services Service to the Armed Forces

DOCC Table of Organization

The DOCC provides a table of organization and contact information for DOCC watch officers who are responsible for providing technical and program guidance to the operation when requested by disaster relief operation Command and section leaders. See the DOCC Activation page on OneSource.

Situational Awareness & Decision Support

The national Situation Awareness & Decision Support (SADS) unit is responsible for collecting, analyzing, and distributing situational awareness and business intelligence products for use by all functions throughout Disaster Services. This team also supports Disaster Assessment and Call Center operations.

Resource Mobilization &

The Resource Mobilization & Support (RMS) unit is made up of Resource Mobilization & Support Managers aligned with divisions and reporting to the Director of Resource Mobilization & Support, under the umbrella of Disaster

Support Unit (RMS)

Operations & Logistics. The unit's primary function is to meet the human resource needs of regional, divisional, and national disaster responses by mobilizing paid and volunteer responders.

The Resource Mobilization & Support unit is a primary user of the Disaster Management section of the Volunteer Connection System (VCN) and works with Volunteer Services, the owner of the Volunteer Connection system, to ensure accurate records, availability of pre-established data reports, and the implementation of system updates. The unit also supplies audiences at the national, divisional, and regional level with information to meet specific Volunteer Connection-related data needs.

Once a DR number is issued, the unit works with divisions, regions, and disaster relief operations to support human resource needs by:

- Identifying, deploying, and supporting qualified disaster responders, including accounting for disaster relief operations and adding all relevant information in the Volunteer Connection system;
- Assisting regions with transportation;
- Assigning leadership responders;
- Activating and loading Mission Cards and Mass Care Procurement Cards, when appropriate, for deployed responders;
- Assisting deployed responders with travel issues or needs until they arrive on the disaster relief operation;
- Facilitating requests for TDEs and temporary agency hires when approved.

The Resource Mobilization & Support unit also works closely with Community Engagement & Partnerships to manage nationally rostered partner deployments.

Division and Regional Disaster Leadership Positions

Division Vice President

Division Vice Presidents are accountable for:

- Division-wide readiness to conduct disaster relief operations;
- Achievement of disaster goals established by Disaster Services;
- Regional and divisional response efforts in accordance with the Dual Roles of Division Vice Presidents, Regional Executives, and Executive Directors in Disaster Relief Operations section;
- Ensuring that the transition to the next operational level occurs at appropriate triggers;
- Managing the coordination of resources, service delivery, and communication.

Division Disaster Executive

In addition to serving as Red Cross Coordinating Officers, Division Disaster Executives are:

- Responsible for division-wide disaster relief operations;
- Accountable for achievement of the National Readiness Target allocated to their respective divisions and disaster goals established by Disaster Services;
- Accountable for leading, managing, and training the divisional and regional teams responsible for implementing disaster programs within the division, and ensuring readiness levels are attained and sustained and that services are delivered in a rapid and accessible manner to meet the needs of Red Cross clients;
- Accountable for alignment and relationships with assigned FEMA regions and state governments within their divisions;
- Responsible for identifying multi-regional response demands within their divisions and ensuring coordination of resources, service delivery, and internal and external communication of services, needs, and gaps;
- Responsible for developing a division-level support network (such as Division Capability Workgroups, Logistics Advisor, Disaster Health Services Advisor);
- Responsible for maintaining and deploying Division Disaster Leadership Teams and Division Response Management Teams;
- Responsible for overseeing and executing disaster relief operations in accordance with this *Concept of Operations*.

Division Disaster Director

Division Disaster Directors are:

- Responsible for coordinating statewide plans and the implementation of Disaster Services programs, and may assume leadership roles in divisional and national operations;
- Responsible for regions achieving disaster goals established by Disaster Services;
- Accountable for capacity building and volunteer leadership development;
- Responsible for supporting the region's attainment of the Regional Readiness Target;
- Responsible for overseeing and executing disaster relief operations in accordance with this *Concept of Operations*.

Division Disaster State Relations Director

Division Disaster State Relations Directors are:

- Responsible for ensuring there is a primary Red Cross interface with government entities (federal, state, local, and tribal), non-government organizations, and other leadership entities in the field of emergency services, disaster policy and operations, and community resilience;
- Responsible for regions achieving disaster goals established by Disaster Services;
- Accountable for capacity building and volunteer leadership development;

- Responsible for supporting the region's attainment of Regional Readiness Target.

Division Disaster State Relations Directors may be assigned specific relationships within Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) regions. They ensure coordinated planning at the state level and with FEMA regions.

Regional Executive

Regional Executives are accountable for:

- Ensuring Disaster Services programs are performed, readiness levels are attained, goals are achieved, and performance targets are met within their regions;
- Managing relationships with key community partners and designated elected and appointed federal, state, and local officials, and for providing whole cycle disaster-related information;
- Fundraising against assigned disaster relief operation targets;
- Directing regional operations on how to connect to the disaster relief operation to obtain and share operational information, such as local client/community needs.

During national-level operations, Regional Executives typically support the External Relations function to ensure consistent messaging, strategy, and engagement. Note Dual Roles: DVPs REs and EDs in Disaster Relief Operations.

Executive Director

Executive Directors are responsible for:

- Supporting Disaster Services programs and operations in their assigned jurisdictions in accordance with the Regional Executive's direction;
- Managing relationships with local key community partners and designated elected and appointed state and local officials, and for providing whole cycle disaster-related information;
- Engaging the local board in disaster information and fundraising.

During national-level operations, Executive Directors typically support the External Relations function to ensure consistent messaging, strategy, and engagement. Note Dual Roles: DVPs REs and EDs in Disaster Relief Operations.

Regional Disaster Officer

Regional Disaster Officers are responsible for:

- Leading the team that implements Disaster Services programs throughout the region;
- Overseeing and executing disaster relief operations in accordance with this *Concept of Operations*;
- Achieving and sustaining the National Readiness Target for their region;

- Ensuring the implementation of the Disaster Services volunteer engagement process in the region and ensuring that an adequate deployment support system exists to prepare workers prior to deployment.

Disaster Program Manager / Specialist

Disaster Program Managers/Specialists (DPx) are responsible for ensuring:

- Effective, positive, and sustained relationship management with key government and non-government partners within their assigned geographic territory;
- Delivery of preparedness, response, and recovery programs in their assigned geographic territory by developing and deploying volunteer leaders and volunteer workers;
- Community mobilization occurs to support delivery of Disaster Services;
- Effective management of Disaster Action Team program in assigned territory;
- Support in achievement and sustainment of the National Readiness Target.

Disaster Workforce Engagement

Members of Disaster Workforce Engagement teams are responsible for:

- Supporting the delivery of disaster programs in their region by onboarding and developing volunteer leaders and volunteer workers;
- Providing support in achieving and sustaining the National Readiness Target;
- Initiating Staff Services on all disaster response operations until additional Staff Services personnel are assigned;
- Actively recruiting, assigning, and deploying responders to disaster relief operations, both inside and beyond the region.

National Response Management Team (NRMT)

The National Response Management Team is a pool of multidisciplinary leaders who deploy to lead national-level operations. They are deployed at the direction of the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics. For more information, see the Response Management Teams Standards and Procedures on OneSource.

Disaster Relief Operation Positions

Red Cross Coordinating Officer

The Red Cross Coordinating Officer is a temporary position within the structure of a division or national disaster relief operation. The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics selects and appoints Red Cross Coordinating Officers when required. In most instances, the Red Cross Coordinating Officer is the Division Disaster Executive from the impacted division.

The Red Cross Coordinating Officer reports to the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics.

The primary functions of the RCCO are:

- Establishing and managing the Red Cross executive relationship with the State Director of Emergency Management and State Coordinating Officer (SCO) (and other senior state officials who may be responsible for ESF-6 mission delivery)
- Establishing and managing the Red Cross executive relationship with the Federal Coordinating Officer (FCO)
- Establishing and managing the relationship between the DRO and the Division Vice President, Division Fundraising Vice President, and the affected Regional Executive
- At this initiation of major response operations, to be physically present at the operational decision-making center of gravity, which is typically the State Emergency Operations Center
- Once executive-level operational relationships are fully stabilized, visiting and inspecting DRO headquarters and service sites while concurrently maintaining strong relationships with the FCO and SCO
- Advising the DRO Director, as necessary

To execute their primary functions, RCCOs must be able to make operational commitments to the SCO and FCO on behalf of the DRO. While preferable for RCCOs to coordinate such commitments in advance with the DRO Director, doing so may not always be possible. Consequently, DRO Directors are expected to honor all commitments made by the RCCO. Any unresolved disagreements between the RCCO and DRO Director shall be brought to the National Director of Relief Operations for prompt resolution.

Red Cross Coordinating Officers are responsible for:

- Identifying multi-regional response demands and providing guidance as needed to coordinate resources, service delivery, and internal and external communication of services, needs, and gaps;
- Identifying significant issues, especially those presenting substantial organizational risk, and disaster relief operation leadership teams to ensure appropriate solutioning and resolution;
- Providing strategic advice to the DRO Director for alignment of service delivery in regions and districts in response to large events;
- Positioning themselves in or near the disaster-affected area where they can best see, influence, and assess the performance of the overall disaster relief operation. This includes traveling to various service and support sites;
- Empowering disaster relief operation leadership to teach, coach, mentor, encourage, and provide guidance to the operation workforce;

- Ensuring the DRO Director cultivates an environment conducive to developing DRO Directors, Assistant DRO Directors, and District Directors for positions with increased responsibilities;
- Ensuring effective information sharing and coordination between the FEMA Federal Coordinating Officer, state emergency operation centers, and key partners;

Deputy Red Cross Coordinating Officer

The Deputy RCCO must meet the same qualifications as a RCCO. The RCCO, in coordination with the VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics, selects and appoints the Deputy RCCO when:

- There are concurrent, large-scale division- or national-led operations within their jurisdiction; and /or
- The complexity of a DRO warrants both a RCCO and Deputy RCCO to better support the operation.

Responsibilities of the Deputy RCCO are assigned by the RCCO and may include:

- Managing relationships with a state or federal partner to coordinate the Red Cross strategic approach to service delivery;
- Investigating and reporting on strategic issues that may impact service delivery;
- Overseeing strategic alignment of operational priorities with organizational intent as defined by RCCO;
- Serving as RCCO to provide coverage during a defined operational timeframe

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State EOC Principal Representative

May be appointed by the RCCO to serve as the senior representative at the state EOC for large operations and complex events that require sheltering for significant populations for an extended period of time. This representative:

- Reports to the RCCO;
- Does not direct tactical-level decisions, which are left to the DRO leadership team;
- Works directly with Government Operations and all liaison(s) assigned to the state EOC;
- Coordinates with the AD External Relations with a dotted-line relationship with the External Relations team to ensure effective, ongoing communications;
- Coordinates communication about congregate sheltering between the DRO and the state.

DRO Director

DRO Director is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. DRO Directors may be responsible for leading regional, divisional, or

national-level operations. They may be assigned for operations across the disaster cycle, including preparedness, response, and recovery operations. For regional operations, the DRO Director reports to the Regional Executive. For divisional operations, the DRO Director reports to the Division Disaster Executive or designee. For national operations, the DRO Director reports to the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics.

DRO Directors are responsible for:

- Developing the overarching strategy for the disaster relief operation in line with the strategic intent of the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, and
- Providing the DRO leadership team with strategic guidance and a common, understood end state and vision for service delivery;

- Overseeing section leadership and directing all aspects of day-to-day disaster relief operations;
- Coordinating with the RCCO to ensure alignment with Federal and State operational plans and commitments;
- Setting the overall direction and tone of the operation;
- Ensuring appropriate, timely and cost-efficient delivery of services to clients to meet their immediate, disaster-caused and/or preparedness needs consistent with Disaster Services doctrine;
- Ensuring, in divisional and national operations, consistency, and alignment with the strategic intent established by the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics;
- Ensuring controls are in place to avoid reputational or financial risk to the Red Cross;
- Establishing appropriate operational structure;
- Approving the Incident Action Plan, Service Delivery Plan, and *Disaster Operations Control Form 5266* before transmittal;
- Ensuring mutually beneficial coordination and collaboration with community and government partners with a level of transparency that fosters trust;
- Ensuring the operation follows the approved Service Delivery Plan and operates within the approved field operating budget;
- Serving as the operation point of contact for Regional Executives and working to align service delivery with regional expectations and needs;
- Resolving urgent and/or sensitive Elected Official Liaison (EOL) issues in a timely manner;
- Overseeing the Elected Official Liaison Network and ensuring communication flow with AD External Relations, region and other appropriate individuals.

In addition, DRO Directors are accountable for implementing policies and procedures to provide a quality work environment and for ensuring that all personnel deployed to the operation are treated with respect and fairness, and have:

- A job to do;

- The training they need;
- The technology they need to complete their job;
- A supervisor who communicates their responsibilities to them;
- The ability to communicate with their team;
- A place to sleep that is safe and clean;
- A safe method of getting to their respective work location.

DRO Directors are also accountable for ensuring all DRO-assigned responders with direct reports complete a DRO Work Evaluation for those direct reports that serve on the job for seven (7) or more days.

Chief of Staff

Chief of Staff is a discretionary and temporary position within the structure of a division or national disaster relief operation that is appointed by and reports to the DRO Director. The Chief of Staff is responsible for:

- Reviewing and prioritizing operational issues;
- Establishing reporting routines and lines of communication;
- Brokering operating solutions and mediating disputes among and between operating groups for situations that, while important, may not require the attention of the DRO Director;
- Serving in an advisory role to the DRO Director;
- Taking on projects or initiatives as required to facilitate and advance operational objectives;
- Facilitating communication and coordination within the operation's leadership team;
- Ensuring the recognition and appreciation of deployed workers;
- Ensuring overall safety issues and the safety of clients and the workforce; has the authority to direct cessation of operational activities to ensure the safety of the workforce and clients.

Note: The Deputy DRO Director completes these duties when no Chief of Staff is assigned.

Deputy DRO Director

The Deputy DRO Director is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. Deputy Directors report to the DRO Director and are responsible for:

- Reinforcing the overall direction and tone set by the DRO Director for the operation;
- Ensuring the delivery of services to clients in order to meet their immediate disaster-caused needs (for response and long-term recovery operations) or preparedness needs (for preparedness operations);
- Receiving notifications of emergent, elevated, and non-emergent social media monitoring information from the Director of Disaster Public Affairs or designee. Accountable for operation-wide oversight to ensure implementation and

execution of the Doctrine Bulletin: Social Engagement and Resolution During Disaster Response. On relief operations that do not have this position filled, the DRO Director is accountable;

- At the discretion of the DRO Director, providing guidance and oversight to ensure quality of services and appropriate, timely, and cost-effective service delivery;
- At the discretion of the DRO Director, ensuring mutually beneficial coordination with community and government partners;
- Assuming the responsibilities and authority of the DRO Director for designated or specific periods of time as appointed by the DRO Director;
- In absence of the DRO Director, assuming DRO Director's authority; in such situations, the AD Operations assumes the Deputy Director's role.

DRO Disaster Action Team Liaison

When DRO / related event impacts regional capacity, Regional Disaster Officers consult with Division Disaster Executive (DDE) or designee regarding the need for a DRO Disaster Action Team (DAT) Liaison and recommend a candidate for the position. Upon DDE and DRO concurrence, the liaison is assigned to the DRO and reports to the Deputy DRO Director.

The DRO Disaster Action Team Liaison is a temporary appointed position within the structure of a disaster relief operation that reports to the Deputy DRO Director and may be filled virtually. This is a DRO assignment and the candidate must understand the DRO structure and operation. Candidates for this position include (in order of preference):

1. DAT Regional Program Lead from the affected region,
2. DAT Manager or strong DAT Supervisor from the affected region,
3. DAT Regional Program lead or DAT Manager from outside of the affected region.

The DRO DAT Liaison is responsible for:

- Supporting the continuity of in-person steady-state DAT operations within an affected region or regions by coordinating situational awareness and communication between DRO and regional DAT leadership by sharing the following information:
  - Availability of sheltering and other service delivery by the DRO
  - Safety and infrastructure information
  - Client Care Services (including, but not limited to immediate financial assistance) availability and damage assessment efforts
  - Routing of incoming response requests
  - Regional workforce availability
  - Other information that may impact DAT operations.
- Communicating concerns about the ability of the region to deliver DAT Operations from the region to the DRO-Deputy including:

- Shortfalls in regional DAT responders stemming from deployment of those workers to the DRO or impact from the disaster.
- Local situational awareness that may benefit DRO Operations.

DAT DRO Liaison should not occupy any operational or steady-state role in regional response (for example, Duty Officer) while serving as the DRO DAT Liaison. Continuation of the role on the operation is based on ongoing conversations between the division and DRO regarding the impact of the DRO and related event on the ability of the region to maintain continuity of in-person operations for Level 1 and 2 responses.

Community Adaptation Program Liaison

When a DRO is established in an area where there is a Community Adaptation Program (CAP), a Community Adaptation Program Liaison will be assigned to the disaster relief operation to serve as the strategic link between to the Community Adaptation Program team, their partners and the DRO.

The Community Adaptation Program Liaison:

- Coordinates CAP program partner activities and resources with the DRO
- Supports the disaster relief operation through effective communication with the Community Adaptation Program team
- Promotes the integration of the CAP partner services and resources in the DRO's service delivery
- Remains in consistent, regular contact with the Community Adaptation Program team and serves as the conduit for communication, collaboration and cooperation between the DRO, the CAP team, and their partners
- Reports directly to the Deputy DRO Director
- Maintains a close working relationship with:
  - Assistant Director External Relations
  - Assistant Director Operations
  - Elected Official Liaison Chief

Community Adaptation Program Liaisons are appointed by the Executive Director of Operations Policy and Mission Adaptation for Level 3+ DROs when there is a Community Adaptation Program established in the disaster-affected area. Community Adaptation Program Liaisons may be assigned to specified Level 2 DROs when a need is identified. Community Adaptation Program Liaisons are selected from the Community Adaptation Program workforce.

Assistant Director Operations

Assistant Director (AD) of Operations is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation.

For divisional and national-level operations, the Assistant Director Operations is accompanied by a Mass Care Chief and a Client Care Chief. The AD Operations may also assign a Deputy AD Operations.

Assistant Directors of Operations report directly to the DRO Director and are responsible for:

- Managing all operations related to the disaster relief operation;
- Providing tactical assignments documented in the Incident Action Plan and directing their execution and developing the Advance Operational Plan in concert with the Assistant Director Information & Planning.
- Making expedient changes to operations based on evolving situations;
- Ensuring the safety and welfare of all operational responders;
- Ensuring responders assigned to Operations section activities promptly receive a work assignment upon arrival;
- Supervising and configuring the Operations Section and districts when established;
- Ensuring that the overall direction and tone set by the DRO Director is executed, in coordination with established districts;
- Approving requests for human and material resources in accordance with the approved Service Delivery Plan to support service delivery tactics.
- Ensuring the flow of information and intelligence to and from districts and the operation's leadership team. This includes the vetting and resolution of social media Issues.

Deputy AD Operations

The Deputy AD Operations is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation used when Zone Coordinators are assigned or districts are established. The AD Operations determines the need for a deputy when fewer than 3 zones are established. The Deputy AD Operations reports directly to the AD Operations and is responsible for:

- Supporting and monitoring the tactical implementation of the current operational period's incident action plan;
- Ensuring consistent service delivery across geographically assigned zones or districts;
- Managing Zone Coordinators and District Directors.

District Director

District Director is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. District Directors are appointed based on the needs of an impacted geographic jurisdiction and report to the Deputy Assistant Director Operations.

As part of the operation's senior leadership team, District Directors are responsible for:

- Leading service delivery for a designated geographic jurisdiction, in alignment with the priorities and objectives established by the DRO Director;

- Determining requirements and coordinating with disaster leadership to ensure efficient and effective service delivery;
- Identifying operation-specific requirements and sources of information;
- Facilitating communication with and between stakeholders within the district jurisdiction;
- Following processes for communicating and reporting;
- Approving, consolidating, and forwarding to the Assistant Director Operations all resources requests from the district for action;
- Identifying resources and gaps, and requesting and allocating assets;
- Providing administrative oversight and care of assigned district staff, including support staff, service delivery workers, and assigned event-based volunteers;
- Ensuring visibility of and effective coordination with partners operating within the district.

Deputy District Director

Deputy District Director is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. Deputy District Directors report to the District Director and are responsible for:

- Reinforcing the overall direction and tone set by the District Director;
- Ensuring the delivery of services to clients to meet their immediate disaster-caused needs;
- Facilitating communication and coordination within the district's leadership team;
- Serving as the executive liaison from the District to the Assistant Director External Relations and closely coordinating with the Assistant Director External Relations on behalf of the district to:
    - Support the Emergency Operations Center Liaison with local emergency management officials;
    - Engage Community Engagement & Partnerships as necessary for service delivery in the district;
    - Directly and promptly resolve operational issues within the district as identified by External Relations;
    - Keep External Relations apprised of all significant external issues arising in the district.
- At the discretion of the District Director, providing guidance and oversight to ensure quality of services and appropriate, timely, and cost-effective service delivery;
- At the discretion of the District Director, ensuring mutually beneficial coordination with community and government partners;
- Gathering, understanding, and verifying information processed through social media monitoring, and implementing a coordinated solution with associated field level activity leads, and communication back through the chain of command. If there is no Deputy District Director in place, the District Director is responsible for assigning a dedicated individual who is responsible for social

media monitoring issue resolution and is empowered to resolve social media monitoring issues.

Zone Coordinator

Each Zone Coordinator (formerly Itinerating Deputy AD/IDAD Response) is assigned to a designated geography and is responsible for supporting the Deputy AD Operations in fulfilling their responsibilities by:

- Meeting with the Deputy AD-Operations to determine their work plan and priorities;
- Itinerating as directed by the Deputy AD-Operations to ensure:
    - Services are being provided in alignment with operational plans;
    - Service delivery sites are receiving the support needed to provide services and meet program standards.
- Coordinating closely with the Mass Care Chief and Client Care Chief to adjust service delivery;
- Supporting the initiation and sustainment of service delivery;
- Identifying communities on the front line of the climate crisis and areas requiring services;
- Possibly meeting the immediate needs of a service delivery site through delegated financial authorities;
- Inform Deputy AD Operations when services are lacking within their assigned geography or when IAP tactics are not being achieved to Red Cross standards;
- Act as point of contact for chapter Executive Directors for reported concerns and problems with service delivery.

Zone Coordinators are not assigned to geographies where districts have been established.

Mass Care Chief

Mass Care Chief is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. For division and national-level operations, Mass Care Chiefs always report to the Assistant Director Operations and are accompanied by a Client Care Chief.

The Mass Care Chief is responsible for working closely with the Client Care Chief to ensure coordinated planning and resource adjudication.

Mass Care Chiefs are responsible for ensuring:

- The availability of sufficient staff, resources, tools, and systems to achieve the mission;
- Activities for sheltering, feeding, and distribution of emergency supplies are completed in alignment with the Advance Operational Plan, the Service Delivery Plan, program standards, and organizational intent.

- Established shelter transition casework in shelters, often within the first week of operations, to ensure smooth transitions;
- The provision of Reunification services;
- Accessibility to all recipients of Red Cross services at all sites and entry points (including telephonic and computer-based entry points) and ensuring the provision of guidance to all members of the Red Cross workforce and their partners regarding appropriate actions needed to successfully meet the disaster-caused needs of all people impacted by or responding to disasters, including people with disabilities and others with access and functional needs.

DRO Pet Liaison

- Subject matter expert(s) on the role of Red Cross providing support for pets.
- Collaborates with External Relations and HQ Sheltering Manager to ensure that all shelter sites where household pets are present have an animal welfare agency identified to support with daily care of and resources for pets.
- Collaborates with HQ Sheltering Manager to ensure the needs of clients with household pets are being addressed.
- Works with External Relations and/or Logistics to procure resources when the animal welfare agency isn't able to.
- Deployed by the NAD Operations to large disaster relief operations to help support pet sheltering operations.
- DRO Pet Liaison(s) reports to the HQ Mass Care Chief.

Client Care Chief

The Client Care Chief is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. For divisional and national-level operations, Client Care Chiefs always report to an Assistant Director Operations and are accompanied by a Mass Care Chief.

The Client Care Chief is expected to be a part of the leadership team of the disaster relief operation as soon as that team formalizes. While the operational focus remains on delivery of mass care services, the Client Care Chief is responsible for initiating resource requirements to establish the client care operations structure and coordinating the planning for the delivery of a full range of client care services that meet the immediate disaster-caused needs of individuals and families. These services include disaster casework, mental health, health, spiritual care, and disability integration services.

From the time the disaster relief operation is established, the Client Care Chief works closely with the Mass Care Chief to ensure coordinated planning and resource adjudication.

Client Care Chiefs are responsible for:

- Ensuring the provision of appropriate health, mental health, spiritual care, and disability integration services and other support for clients;

- Ensuring the provision of disaster casework: assistance to families and individuals in developing short-term recovery plans, accessing the full range of community and government resources, advocacy, and problem solving;
- Ensuring the provision of immediate financial assistance where authorized;
- Ensuring the provision of Disaster Health, Disaster Mental Health and Disaster Spiritual Care services and financial assistance;
- Assessing and forecasting for the range of client care service needs within the affected communities, including the use of multi-agency resource centers, and evaluation of potential grant programs and other resources;
- Ensuring the availability of sufficient staff, resources, tools, and systems to achieve the mission;
- Ensuring effective communication among Client Care activities and other units;
- Engaging and supporting external partners involved in client care service provision;
- Participating in operational planning, including initial planning, Service Delivery Plan development, and long-term planning.
- Working with Mass Care to ensure shelter resident needs are assessed and met appropriately;
- Adhering to financial controls and compliance standards;
- Providing community recovery activities through the provision of leadership, technical assistance, preparedness, and resiliency information to the overall long-term recovery efforts in affected communities;
- Coordinating outreach to at-risk and underrepresented segments of the community;
- Transitioning Client Care activities to the region/division or long-term recovery operation (LTRO) and ensuring the region/division or LTRO has the capacity and information needed to continue client support.

Assistant Director Logistics

Assistant Director Logistics is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. The Assistant Director Logistics reports to the DRO Director and is responsible for:

- Ensuring that the overall direction and tone set by the DRO Director is executed;
- Establishing a culture of support across the DRO. Embodies the phrase, “We help, no matter what;”
- Translating the operational strategy into a resource strategy for effective and efficient resourcing of the Service Delivery Plan;
- Communicating operational and resourcing strategy to the Logistics team and relaying any needs of the Logistics functions to disaster leadership.
- Supporting the team that secures human and material resources, as articulated in the approved Service Delivery Plan;
- Ensuring the acquisition, receipt, management, disposition, and protection of accessible infrastructure, material, technology, and vehicle resources;

- Developing a strategy to manage resources across the disaster relief operation, ensuring that the Assistant Director Operations and other disaster leaders are informed when resource requests cannot be fulfilled with internal resources and/or when there may be a delay in fulfilling a request;
- Ensuring expenditures are reported to appropriate personnel;
- Ensuring controls are in place to track, account for, and steward disaster relief operation resources;
- Supporting the establishment of multi-agency sheltering and feeding task forces or working groups;
- Providing subject matter experts and expertise to districts;
- Maintaining awareness relative to staging areas and warehousing not assigned to a district.

Assistant Director Workforce

The Assistant Director Workforce is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. The Assistant Director Workforce reports to the DRO Director and is responsible for:

- Ensuring the deployment, management, support, and administration of human resources including the infusion of disaster event-based volunteers;
- Analyzing feedback that ensures that every member of the operational workforce has a job to do, has the training to do it, has a supervisor who is communicating their responsibilities to them, have the technology they need to do their job, have the ability to communicate with their team, has a place to sleep that is clean and safe, has a safe way to get to their work location, and is treated with respect and fairness;
- Ensuring that the overall direction and tone set by the DRO Director is executed;
- Overseeing the identification and analysis of existing or emerging trends for workers with their disaster relief operation experience, such as through the use of the Pulse Check survey and facilitating problem solving and intervention where needed;
- Translating the operational strategy into a resource strategy for effective and efficient resourcing of the Service Delivery Plan (SDP);
- Ensuring that all leaders have the resources to facilitate a warm, welcoming environment for workers by anticipating workforce needs based on the operational tempo, unique factors of the disaster relief operation, available resources, and limitations;
- Modeling the exemplary customer service skills and behavior desired by all Staff Services workers;
- Seeking to creatively solve problems in the best interests of the workforce;
- Developing a strategy in collaboration with operational leadership to manage resources across the disaster relief operation, ensuring that the Chief of Staff and other operational leadership are informed when requests cannot be fulfilled or there may be a delay in fulfillment;

- Overseeing the establishment and management of staff shelters, staff feeding, and all services related to the care of workforce in collaboration with Logistics and Mass Care leadership.
- Supporting Volunteer Services in ensuring the affected community can easily participate in the response, as appropriate;
- Serving as a champion of change management, supporting workers' understanding of why decisions are being made and identifying the most appropriate communicating tools to get information to the workforce efficiently;
- Supporting Mass Care and Logistics in the set-up, tracking, and resourcing of staff shelters, including comfort items (staff sheltering is a component of Lodging in Staff Services).

Assistant Director Information & Planning

Assistant Director Information & Planning is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. Assistant Directors of Information & Planning report to the DRO Director and are responsible for:

- Providing actionable intelligence based upon deliberate plans, impact assessments, and partner input that allows the disaster relief operation to agree upon initial planning assumptions;
- Directly and promptly informing disaster leadership of any shortfalls, issues, and concerns arising in the planning process;
- Leading an RC View team that collects information from a multitude of internal and external sources and synthesizes and visualizes salient data points in accordance with the DRO Director's critical information requirements;
- Overseeing the collection, analysis, dissemination, evaluation, and use of information to provide situational awareness and decision support analytics, including disaster assessment;
- Leading and implementing the incident action planning cycle, focusing on tactical planning for a designated operational period (each district may be using different tactics based on needs);
- Overseeing and coordinating damage assessment and reporting;
- Ensuring that collected and processed information is translated into actionable intelligence;
- In coordination with the Assistant Director Operations, recommending updates of priorities, objectives, and planning assumptions to the DRO Director;
- Creating the Advance Operational Plan in concert with the Assistant Director Operations for DRO-led, national headquarters-supported operations;
- Facilitating the development of service delivery planning, including documenting functional strategies and the development of the Service Delivery Plan;
- Ensuring the collection of service delivery data and input into the Disaster Operations Control Form (F5266);
- Developing data-driven products to ensure the disaster relief operation can compare planning assumptions with service delivery;

- Ensuring distribution of the Incident Action Plan and other appropriate Command information across the entire disaster relief operation;
- Mapping all district boundaries in RC View within one operational period of establishment and removing the district boundaries from RC View within one operational period of dis-establishment.

DRO Call Center Liaison

The primary duty of the DRO Call Center Liaison is to ensure the National Response Call Center knows where and what services the DRO is providing in real-time at all times. This position is critical to ensuring that client-callers to 1-800-RED-CROSS receive timely and accurate information on where to obtain Red Cross services.

The DRO Call Center Liaison reports to the AD Information & Planning and is responsible for:

- Gathering relevant intelligence from the disaster relief operation and relaying that information to the National Call Center Lead and Call Center agents in real-time;
- Establishing strong, real-time communications Information & Planning team;
- Coordinating closely with members of the Operations and External Relations teams.
    - The External Relations team provides up-to-date information on Red Cross, government, and community resources that are available for disaster-affected populations;
- Ensuring information is directly available for Call Center agents to reference via RC Respond DAT Dispatch;
- Informing the National Call Center LeAD any major shifts in DRO objectives or operating posture;
- Monitoring RC Respond for client requests for specific resources and Red Cross services;
- Identifying the appropriate points of contact within the DRO to manage calls that require additional action from the DRO;
    - Calls may include requests for food, water, shelter, or financial assistance, requests for medical assistance, government inquiries, media inquiries, donations, and Red Cross service complaints;
    - Ensuring that each of these calls has been received by a point of contact within 24 hours of being logged in RC Respond DAT Dispatch.

Assistant Director External Relations

Assistant Director External Relations is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. The Assistant Director External Relations is part of the operation's leadership team and reports to the DRO Director.

The Assistant Director External Relations is responsible for:

- Serving as the primary external relations advisor to the DRO Director and Red Cross Coordinating Officer;
- Leading and managing the operation's primary external-facing activities: Government Operations, Community Engagement & Partnerships, Fundraising, and Public Affairs;
- Ensuring the overall direction and tone set by the DRO Director is executed;
- Developing and executing strategies that allow the disaster relief operation to establish collaborative and transparent relationships with partners.
- Mobilizing incident communications resources to prepare and deliver coordinated, sustained, accessible, and approved messages on preparedness, response, and recovery actions;
- Ensuring Disaster Public Affairs provides the general public, clients, partners, specific communities, and our workforce distilled and appropriate preparedness and safety information, aligned with local/state emergency management;
- Ensuring appropriate Red Cross representation in state, local, and tribal emergency operations centers; FEMA Joint Field Offices; appropriate Joint Information Centers; and partner meetings like Voluntary Organizations Active in Disaster (VOAD);
- Working with national headquarters Disaster Public Affairs and Disaster Fundraising to create or incorporate strategies for external messaging and fundraising needs;
- Ensuring receipt of the *Social Media Monitoring Report* as outlined in the Doctrine Bulletin: Social Engagement and Resolution During Disaster Response.

DRO Housing Liaison

The DRO Housing Liaison is a temporary position for a Level 4 and above disaster relief operation reporting to the AD External Relations and responsible for:

- Working with impacted region to gain situational awareness regarding the area's affordable housing inventory, existing Red Cross regional relationships with housing providers, existing local and state housing coalitions;
- Establishing relationships and maintaining contact with housing partners on a federal, state, tribal, and local levels;
- Providing housing navigation guidance and support to HQ Shelter Resident Transition Manager for the timely transition of clients to interim/sustainable housing solutions;
- Representing the disaster relief operation at non-governmental organization (NGOs) and private/public sector housing meetings;
- Providing support/leadership to multi-agency, collaborative housing efforts;
- Coordinating with the impacted region to:
    - Identify established housing partners and coalitions;

    - Identify continuums of care;
    - Collect external data related to housing and people experiencing homelessness
- Reviewing SRT Triage Data to aid in identifying the immediate and future needs of the shelter residents;
- Coordinating with Government Operations to determine who attends FEMA, HUD, and other housing organizational briefings to understand their capabilities, resources and housing plans;
- Coordinating with DRO functions that interface with external organizations Specifically, Elected Official Liaisons, Government Operations, Community Engagement partners, Elected Official Liaison network;
- Notifying Assistant Director External Relations, SRT Manager/ DRO leadership of emergent issues as reported to them by contacts and partners;
- Ensuring smooth transition of information to local relationship managers upon assignment completion.

Assistant Director Finance

Assistant Director Finance is a temporary position within the structure of a disaster relief operation. The Assistant Director Finance reports to the DRO Director and is responsible for:

- Ensuring that the overall direction and tone set by the DRO Director is executed, in coordination with established districts;
- Representing the Chief Financial Officer in setting the overall direction and tone for all finance-related activities on the operation;
- Supporting the development of the Service Delivery Plan;
- Facilitating the creation of the operation's variable budget;
- Ensuring appropriate financial controls are in place across the entire operation and are monitored by disaster relief operation leadership;
- Facilitating conversations with operation leadership around performance tools;
- Directing review and monitoring activities associated with the control environment;
- Leading the finance function through the planning, approval, implementation, and management of Client Care and Long-Term Recovery operations;
- Providing finance-related guidance to all personnel assigned to the operation;
- Providing support with purchasing tools such as P-cards and purchasing systems, such as Coupa, as necessary.

Task Group

Task Groups: Deployment on an Operation

When disaster relief operation leadership identifies needs that require specific subject matter expertise to address, the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics or the DRO Director may determine the need to deploy an ad-hoc team to supplement the existing operational structure. A task group addresses a unique circumstance that requires its own resources to address, and the assigned task is agreed upon by national headquarters and DRO leadership;

The Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics, the DRO Director, and the Red Cross Coordinating Officer (RCCO) determine if a Task Group is needed to address a circumstance. The task group requester and Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics complete a Task Group Assignment Worksheet (in development). This worksheet outlines the goals, task to be completed, reporting requirements, resources, and fiscal authority delegated to the group.

While these assignments may be at the direction of national headquarters, these task groups report to the DRO Director in a DRO-led operation. The DRO Director, the Red Cross Coordinating Officer, and the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics determine which position on the disaster relief operation the team reports to.

A task group leader coordinates the team and is responsible for communicating the goals of the group to appropriate leadership on the operation. The disaster relief operation supports the team with resources and support to ensure the successful completion of the assigned task.

The DRO Director, in consultation with the Red Cross Coordinating Officer and the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics determines when to dissolve the task group upon the completion of the task. The disposition of the assets is at the discretion of DRO leadership, and staff assigned to the task group may be reassigned on the operation or released as appropriate.

Task Groups: Daily Reporting Requirements

Daily reports prepared by task groups on a disaster relief operation are submitted to the team supervisor on the disaster relief operation. The daily planning cycle of the operation dictates the appropriate time for report submission. The team supervisor discusses any concerns mentioned in the reports and determine who will address concerns and/or take any needed action. After the disaster relief operation reviews these, they may be shared with the DOCC as requested.

Task Groups: Financial Instruments

Task Group members who expect to incur disaster relief operation-related expenses should discuss their financial authority with their respective operational supervisor. If a Mass Care Procurement Card is an appropriate financial instrument for the team members, the team lead submits a *Disaster Requisition Form (F6409)* request for Mass Care Procurement Card and ensures recipients of these cards

understand the process and paperwork required for their use. Where a Mass Care Procurement Card is not an appropriate financial instrument, the group's operational supervisor consults with Disaster Finance to determine the appropriate financial instrument for the team's expenses.

Elected Official Liaison Network

Elected Official Liaison Network (EOLN)

The Elected Official Liaison Network (EOLN) is a carefully selected team of current and former Red Cross executive leaders. These executive-level Red Crossers are trained to support disaster relief operations by ensuring consistent and timely coordination of communication with local elected officials and other local government/public officials and other stakeholders in affected areas.

Because the Regional Executive and Executive Director are the relationship managers in steady state and have greater insight and comprehension of the elected officials and other government executives in their area, there must be an intentional and clear connection between Elected Official Liaisons and these local Red Cross leaders. This connection helps the Elected Official Liaison Network serve as an extension, or force multiplier, for the Regional Executive and Executive Director.

Elected Officials Liaison Network Operations

On a disaster relief operation, the Elected Official Liaisons (EOL) report to the Elected Official Liaison Chief who reports to the DRO Director.

The Elected Official Liaison Chief must maintain a close working relationship with:

- Impacted Regional Executive and Executive Directors.
- HQ Government Operations Manager;

The Elected Official Liaison remains in consistent, regular contact with their assigned elected official(s), building the credibility and trust essential to the interests of the community and the Red Cross. The Elected Official Liaison reports daily on the status of relationships to the Elected Official Liaison Chief who determines how, and which, issues must be elevated or immediately shared with the DRO Director, Assistant Director External Relations, Regional Executive, and Executive Director of the affected area(s). The Elected Official Liaison becomes the accepted conduit of communication and cooperation that facilitates a close working relationship between the elected official or executives and the disaster relief operation.

For more information about Elected Official Liaisons and their responsibilities, see the Doctrine Bulletin: Elected Official Liaisons.

Biomedical Services in Disaster

Biomedical Services: Steady State	During steady state, the Regional Disaster Officer (RDO) is responsible for being a liaison with Biomedical Services for planning, readiness, and joint relationship management.
Biomedical Services: Operational State	During times of response and recovery operations, Biomedical Services identifies a Biomedical Services Liaison to represent and coordinate Biomedical needs, requests, and offers with the disaster relief operation. The Biomedical Services Liaison provides either virtual or in-person support as the situation warrants. Generally, the Biomedical Services Liaison reports to the National Deputy DRO Director at the DOCC. In consultation with the DRO Director, the National Deputy DRO Director may request that a Biomedical Services Liaison be assigned to the disaster relief operation and either support virtually or in person. If assigned to a disaster relief operation, the Biomedical Services Liaison reports to the Deputy DRO Director. The Biomedical Services Liaison participates in all appropriate operational calls and is the primary spokesperson for Biomedical Services on the operation.
Biomedical Services: Steady-State Actions of Mutual Support	During steady state, Biomedical Services: • Participates in joint planning, training, and exercises; • Collaborates with community and government partners; • Shares information and reports with Disaster Services at the local, regional, and national levels; • Shares resources with Disaster Services at the local, regional, and national levels; • Conducts joint messaging and donor appeals with Disaster Services.
Biomedical Services: Operational Actions of Mutual Support	During times of disaster, Biomedical Services may request support from the disaster relief operation for the items/actions below largely through coordination with government partners: • Resources to move blood and blood products. This support would be to move standing blood and blood products orders to healthcare facilities, quick-turn (STAT) orders to healthcare facilities, and the movement of blood, blood products, and supplies between Red Cross facilities; • Communication redundancy support; • Fuel and power restoration;

- Situational awareness and disaster intelligence;
- Donor appeals and joint messaging;
- Human and material resources;
- Re-entry access for Biomedical vehicles and third-party delivery vendors into affected areas.

During times of disaster, the disaster relief operation may request support from Biomedical Services for:

- Human and material resources;
- Use of facilities and vehicles;
- Situational awareness; and
- Joint messaging.

Service to the Armed Forces in Disaster

Service to the Armed Forces: Operational State

During times of response and recovery operations. Service to the Armed Forces (SAF) identifies a Service to the Armed Forces Liaison to represent and coordinate Service to the Armed Forces needs, requests, and offers with the disaster relief operation. The SAF Liaison provides virtual or in-person support as warranted by the situation.

Generally, the SAF Liaison reports to the National Deputy DRO Director at the DOCC. If the situation warrants, and in coordination with the DRO director, the National Deputy DRO Director may request that a SAF Liaison be assigned to the disaster relief operation to support virtually or in person. If assigned to the disaster relief operation, the SAF Liaison reports to the Deputy DRO Director, participates in operational calls as appropriate, and is the primary spokesperson for Service to the Armed Forces on the operation.

DRO SAF Liaison

This position supports the disaster response operation (DRO) and is assigned to assist through effective communication and coordination with SAF facilities and personnel in the impacted area. The DRO SAF Liaison functions as the strategic link between the disaster relief operation and key SAF and military leadership in the disaster-affected area. On a disaster relief operation, the SAF Liaison establishes relationships and consistent, regular contact with assigned SAF leaders, military leadership, and other appropriate stakeholders to monitor and verify emergent issues and perceived resourcing needs, as reported to them by their contacts.

For position requirements, see the DCS Qualifications/Specialty Tracks job tool.

Service to the Armed Forces: Steady State Actions of Mutual Support

During steady state, Service to the Armed Forces:

- Participates in joint planning, training, and exercises;
- Collaborates with community and government partners;
- Shares information and reports with Disaster Services at the local, regional, and national levels;
- Shares resources with Disaster Services at the local, regional, and national levels;
- Supports donor appeals and joint messaging.

Service to the Armed Forces: Operational Actions of Mutual Support

During times of disaster, Service to the Armed Forces may request support from the disaster relief operation or government partners for:

- Support for affected military installations or areas around installations;
- Support for communication redundancy;
- Situational awareness and disaster intelligence;
- Human and material resources;
- Re-entry access for Service to the Armed Forces personnel;
- Reunification / Safe and Well support;
- Repatriation.

During times of disaster, the disaster relief operation may request support from Service to the Armed Forces for:

- Human resources;
- Use of facilities;
- Situational awareness and disaster awareness;
- Joint messaging.

Dual Roles: DVPs, REs, and EDs in Disaster Relief Operations

Dual Roles Overview

As incident complexity grows, accountability for operational performance and budget authority shifts from one level of official to another. Accordingly, Division Vice Presidents, Regional Executives, and Executive Directors often have dual roles in disaster relief operations, and transition between roles during the life cycle of a large or complex incident.

Dual Roles: Accountability and Operational Authorities

Division Vice Presidents and Regional Executives have the accountability, responsibility, support, and oversight functions for the disaster relief operations assigned to them in Chapter 2. These functions are largely tied to operational budget formulation and are meant to provide Division Vice Presidents and Regional Executives with a tool to ensure that the strategic intent of this *Concept of Operations* is translated into effective service delivery.

Dual Roles: Regional Level Operations

Regional Executives exercise budgetary financial authority for regional-level operations, support the Regional Disaster Officer in the exercise of their operational authority, and leverage support from the division to exercise their oversight and management responsibilities.

Regional Executives provide facilitative leadership and perform the FIVE-U role described below to support regional-level disaster relief operations.

Dual Roles: Division level Operations

Division Vice Presidents support the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics and the Division Disaster Executive in the exercise of their operational authority and in meeting their oversight and management responsibilities.

During divisional-level operations, Division Vice Presidents, Regional Executives, and Executive Directors/Community Volunteer Leaders provide facilitative leadership and perform the FIVE-U role described below.

Dual Roles: National Level Operations

When the Vice President, Disaster Operation & Logistics designates a national-level operation, all command functions related to that operation shift to Disaster Services officials in accordance with this *Concept of Operations*. All disaster relief operation positions then report to the Vice President, Disaster Operations & Logistics directly or through the management structures described in this *Concept of Operations*.

This framework ensures that all resources assigned to a disaster relief operation operate under a single leader with the authority to direct all resources employed in pursuit of a common purpose. (This is called “unity of command,” a concept applied to all operations.) This framework, with its cascading transition of authorities, guided by the level and complexity of the event, provides clarity in the manner by which the Division Vice Presidents, Division Disaster Executives, Regional Executives, and Executive Directors/Community Volunteer Leaders remain constructively and meaningfully engaged while supporting the chain of command for a large-scale operation.

The Region-to-DRO transition checklist process ensures a smooth transition from Region and Division level operations to National Operations.

Dual Roles: Facilitative Leadership

Division Vice Presidents, Regional Executives, Division Disaster Executives (when not the Red Cross Coordinating Officer), and Executive Directors experiencing national-level disasters in their jurisdictions exercise many of the functions of

"facilitative leadership." In particular, Division Vice Presidents, Regional Executives, and Executive Directors:

- Establish and maintain a regular communication routine with the DCS Vice Presidents and Red Cross Coordinating Officer, including, but not limited to, participating in daily sync calls (especially in the early and transitional stages of the operation). Participation provides an opportunity to be informed and to offer insights and observations that contribute to the team's evolving momentum;
- Support the DCS Vice Presidents and Red Cross Coordinating Officer by identifying disconcerting issues before they become problems, making connections with key leaders in the community to facilitate constructive relationships, and being attentive to issues and relationships that merit special sensitivity in planning the transition of responsibilities from the disaster relief operation back to the region;
- Identify and discuss the importance of local, political, or cultural issues that an incoming disaster relief operation leadership team may otherwise be unaware of or unwilling to address;
- Provide candid feedback to the DCS Vice Presidents and Red Cross Coordinating Officer in the spirit of complete and constructive awareness;
- Provide a positive presence, both on the disaster relief operation and in the community. On the disaster relief operation, support the responders by serving alongside them, recognizing good performance, and identifying to the AD Workforce any human resource concerns needing attention. In the community, carrying simple credentials and wearing branded clothing are important to ensure executives are viewed as leaders within an operational context. Work with the disaster relief operation to ensure you have access to disaster vests, name badges, and branded vehicles, which are critical to ensure access and recognition by internal responders and external partners;
- Be a supporting leader to the disaster relief operation leadership when detecting or identifying problems or challenges that merit focused attention. If an immediate and unmet need arises, seek approval from the DRO Director to make small emergency food purchases or acquire medical supplies with a disaster relief operation-issued P-card, and/or undertake common sense negotiation with local officials and/or partners This quick coordination will be both appreciated and alleviate the unintended consequence of "crossed wires."

FIVE-U

Division Vice Presidents, Regional Executives, and Executive Directors exercise facilitative leadership on all levels of operations by fulfilling the following specific FIVE-U roles as in the table below.

Table 7.4: The FIVE-U

FIVE=U	Action
F = Fundraising	Help generate revenue for the organization.

I = Influence	Ensure the disaster relief operation leverages steady-state relationships, influencing local officials to help shape the Red Cross mission.
V = Visibility	Be a visible presence to boost morale and support clients.
E = Engage	Act in concert with the Disaster Services leadership team to engage in significant local issues, recruit volunteers, ensure continuity of steady state operations, and contribute to lessons learned/continuous improvement.
U = Utility Player	Fill disaster relief operation roles, such as supporting the Elected Officials Liaison Network or managing a large service site where needed for short periods of time.

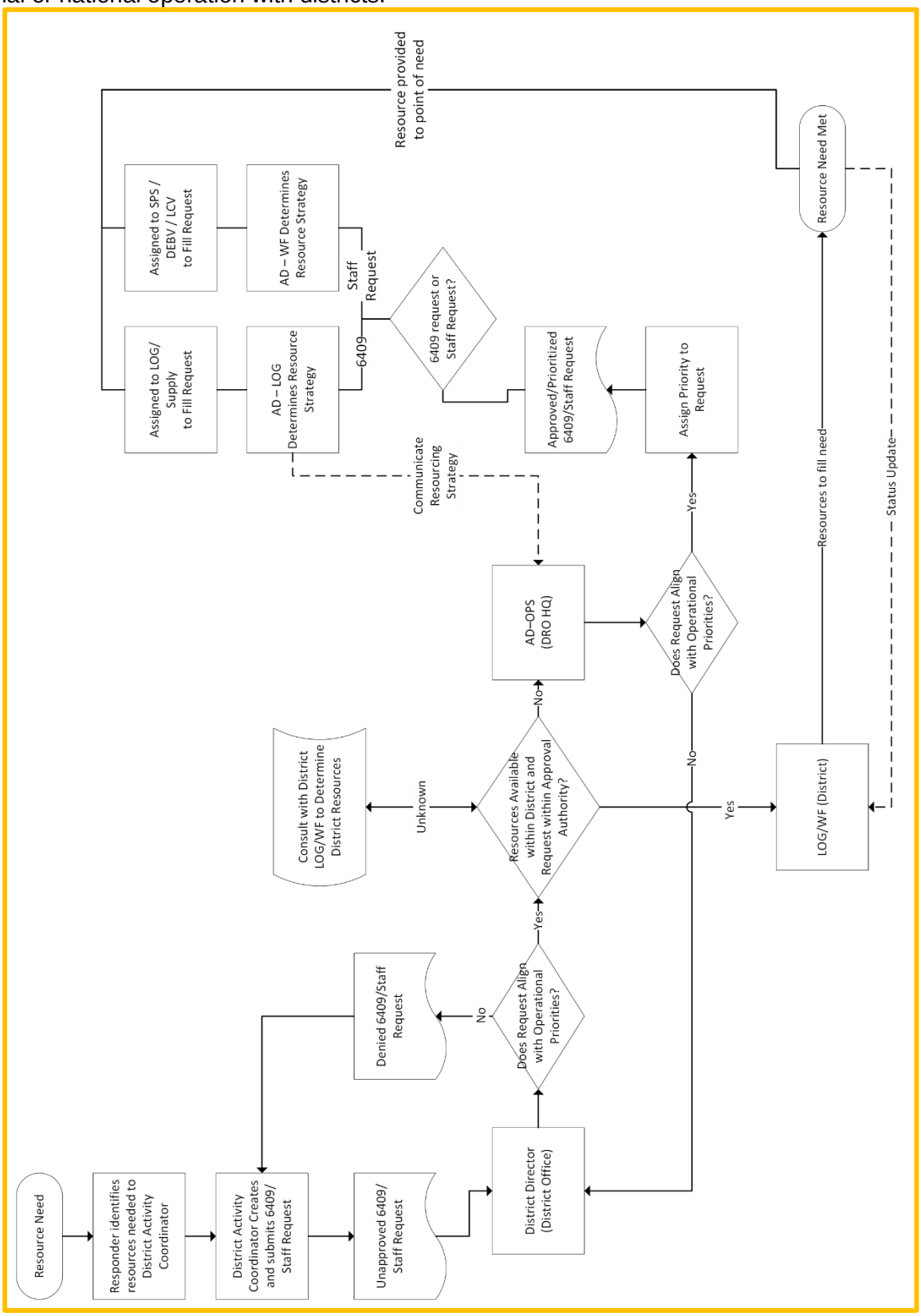
APPENDICES

Appendix Sections

- Detailed Resource Flow for Human and Material Resources
- List of Tables
- List of Figures
- Topical Index
- Tables of Organization and Position-Assignment Charts

Detailed Resource Flow for Human and Material Resources

This is a detailed resource flow diagram of the process for requesting human and material resources in a divisional or national operation with districts.



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Tables of Organization and Position-Assignment Charts

In order to facilitate regular updates, the Operational Tables of Organization and Position Assignment Charts are available on the Disaster Operations Support Toolkit as a separate job tool. This job tool is attached to the end of the published Concept of Operations for ease of access.

Please see the next page for the beginning of the job tool.

Operational Tables of Organization and Position Assignment Charts

Disaster Cycle Services Job Tools

Operations

TABLES OF ORGANIZATION

Concept of Ops (ConOps) includes the following assumptions with respect to the Red Cross organizational structure:

- Tables of organization are scalable, so one person can cover multiple position roles (boxes) depending on the size and complexity of the operation.
- The DRO Director and subordinates assigned to the disaster operation may not modify reporting lines or add management positions not described in these Tables of Organization.
- "Task Groups" report through the DRO chain of command and not to national headquarters.
    - Additional changes are indicated in yellow.

Key

- **Red boxes** indicate Command staff and section leadership.
- **Grey boxes** indicate tactical leadership. Grey boxes are labeled with the *activity* rather than the position title. Depending on complexity, there may be a single position or multiple levels of managers and supervisors.
- **Solid lines** reflect direct reporting relationships.
- **Dotted lines** represent principal coordination relationships. Not all coordination relationships are specified in the tables of organization. There may be times when the role may have multiple dotted line relationships based on the need for coordination.

Districts

- Assistant Director (AD) positions may only be assigned at DRO Headquarters. AD positions are not assigned in districts.
- Operations functions in districts report to the District Director.
- Leaders of support functions in districts (Logistics, Workforce Care, Information & Planning, Government Operations/Community Engagement & Partnerships in External Relations, and Finance) report directly to their respective DRO Headquarters Assistant Director with a dotted line to the District Director or Deputy District Director.
- External Relations does not have a district lead.
- Subordinate coordinators and supervisors in districts report through their district direct management line.

STANDARD POSITION TITLES

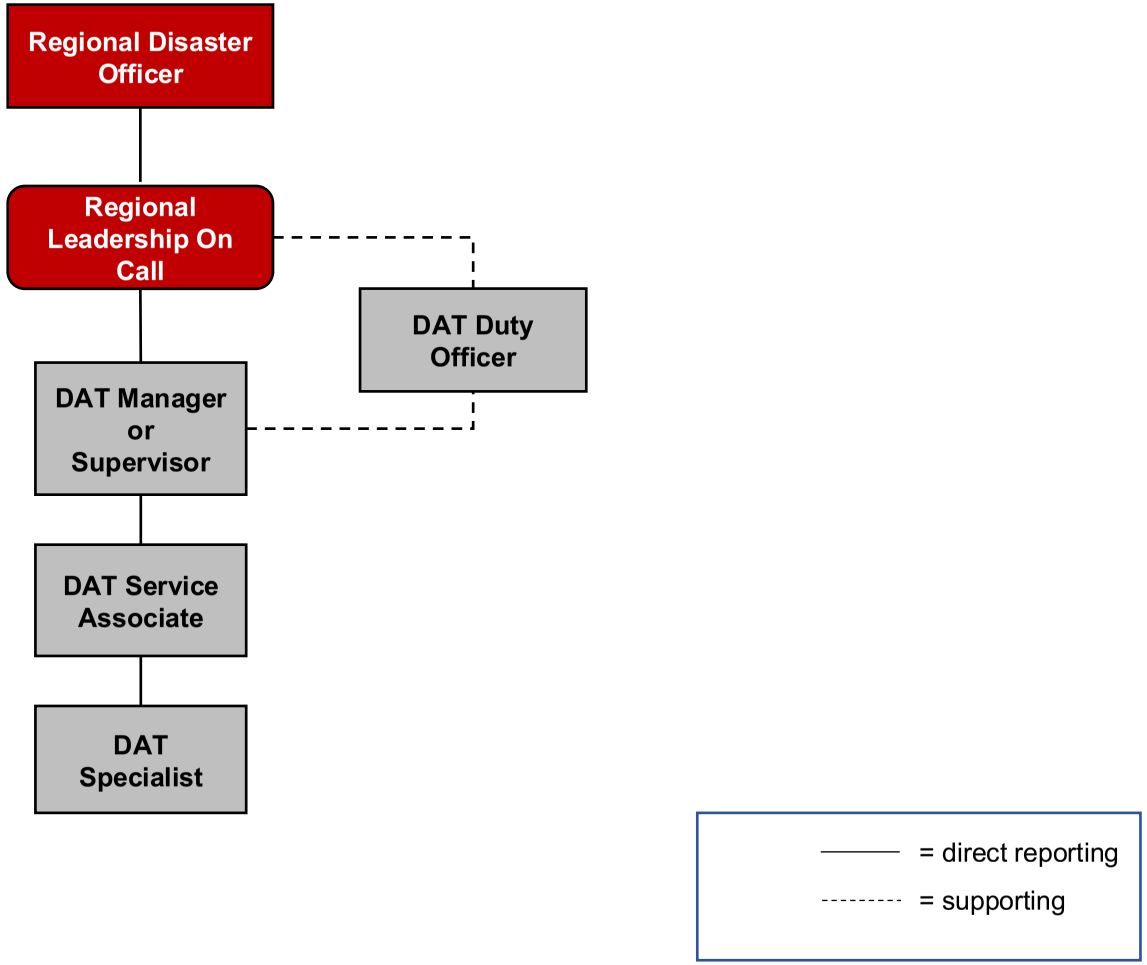
Leadership titles have been standardized for consistency across disaster operations, clarity in reporting lines, and better distinction between District Office and DRO Headquarters positions.

- *Position Assignment Charts* include disaster operation position titles for *supervisors and above*.
- The chart does not include all positions.
- The *Position Assignment Charts* identify the Group/Activity/Positions (GAPs) that may be recruited to fill the positions. The complexity and level of the disaster operation determines the appropriate GAP to fill each position assignment.
- For every GAP listed (for example: SV), any GAP ranking higher may also fill that position (for example: MN or CH).

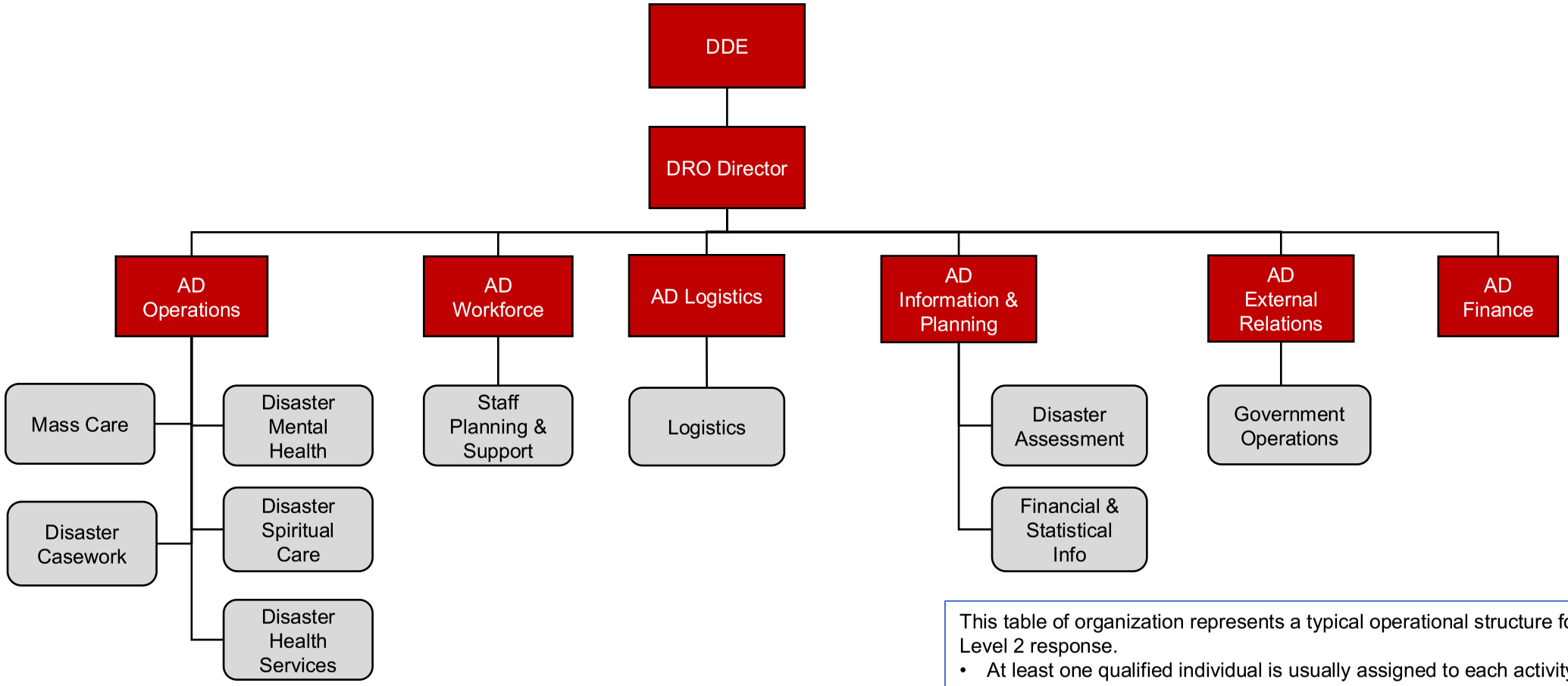
Guidelines for Assigning Position Titles

- Deputy positions are qualified to assume the position under which they serve.
- Deputy positions may only be assigned to serve under Assistant Directors and above or to District Directors.
- "Assistants" can be assigned for any activity when the manager or coordinator's workload requires.
    - Assistants are not authorized to act on behalf of the manager or coordinator to whom they report, so they may have one GAP competency level lower than their supervisor.
    - Specific responsibilities or authorities may be delegated.
- Admins are Service Associate/ Event-Based Volunteer (EBV)-level positions assigned to perform administrative duties and can be assigned at the activity level and above when the workload requires.
- At service delivery sites (like shelters or multi-agency resource centers), all positions assigned to the site have a direct reporting line relationship at the site and receive technical guidance through their function.
- The Site Supervisor coordinates all activities at the site.

Disaster Action Team
Operational Table of Organization



Level 2 Table of Organization



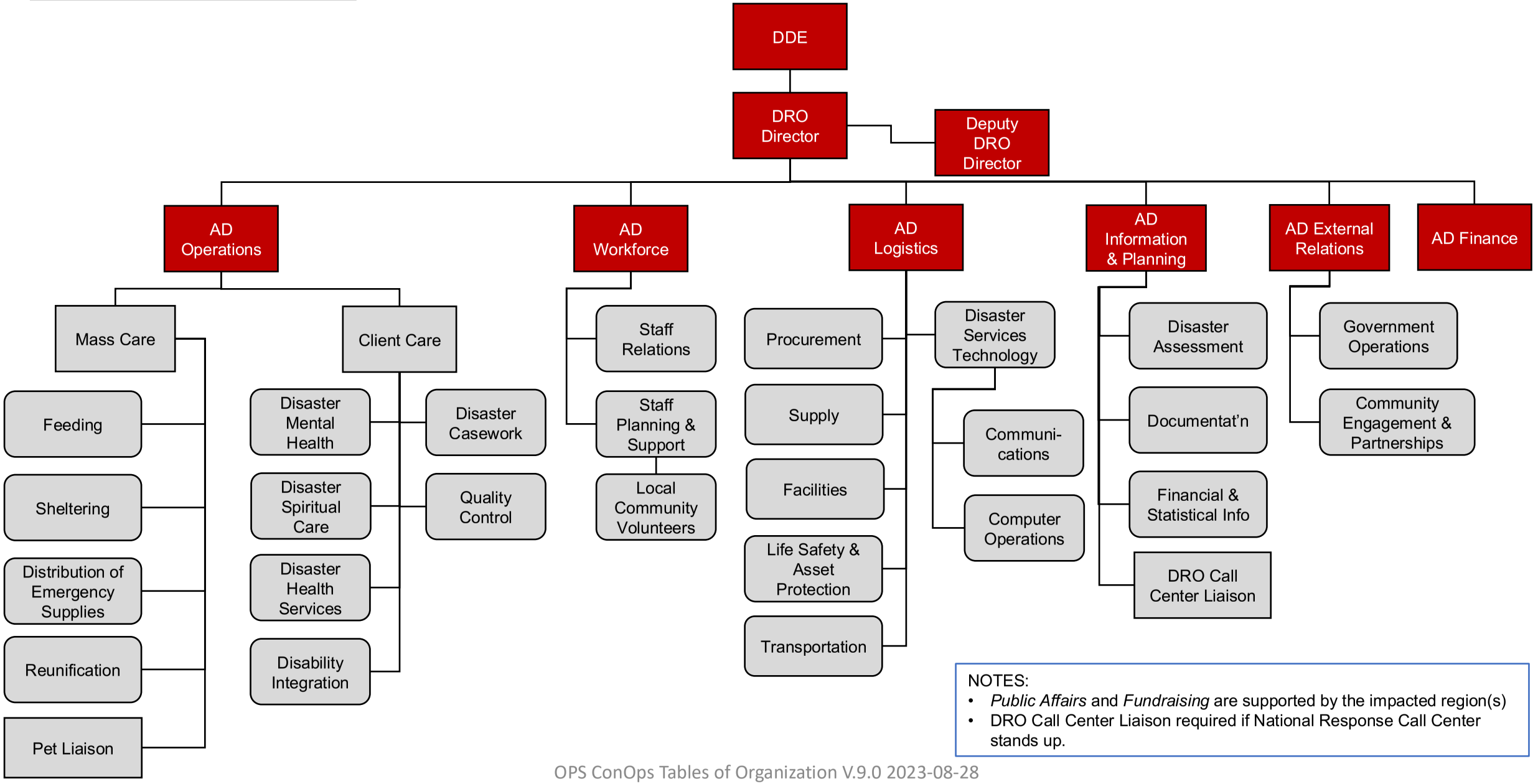
This table of organization represents a typical operational structure for a Level 2 response.

- At least one qualified individual is usually assigned to each activity needed to support clients, represented by a box on the TO.
- This structure is designed to fulfill standard service delivery requirements.
- More complex operational needs may indicate that roles be added as outlined in the Position-Assignment Chart.

NOTES:

- *Disability Integration* consultation provided by division/NHQ.
- *Public Affairs* and *Fundraising* are supported by the impacted region(s)

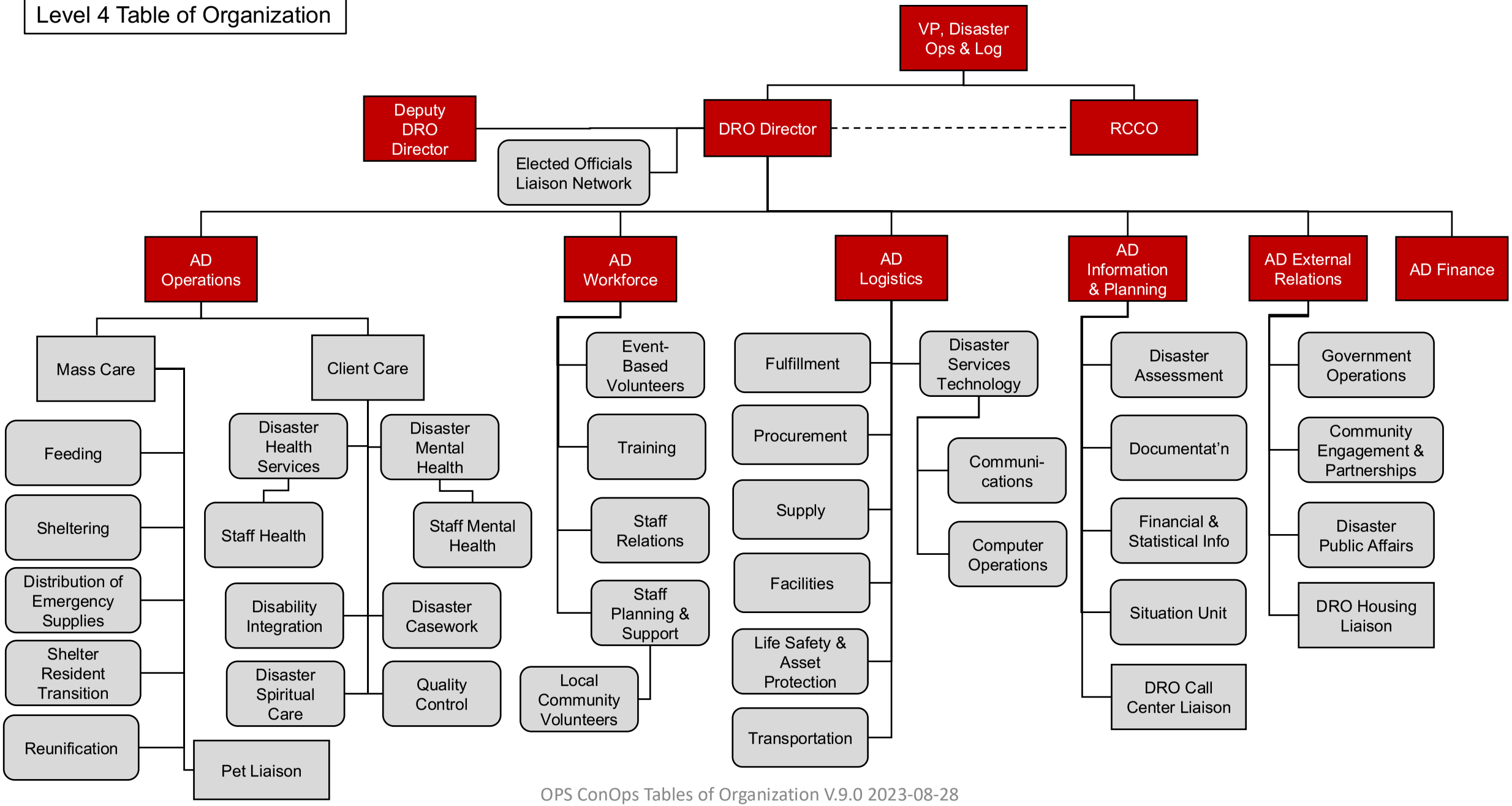
Level 3 Table of Organization



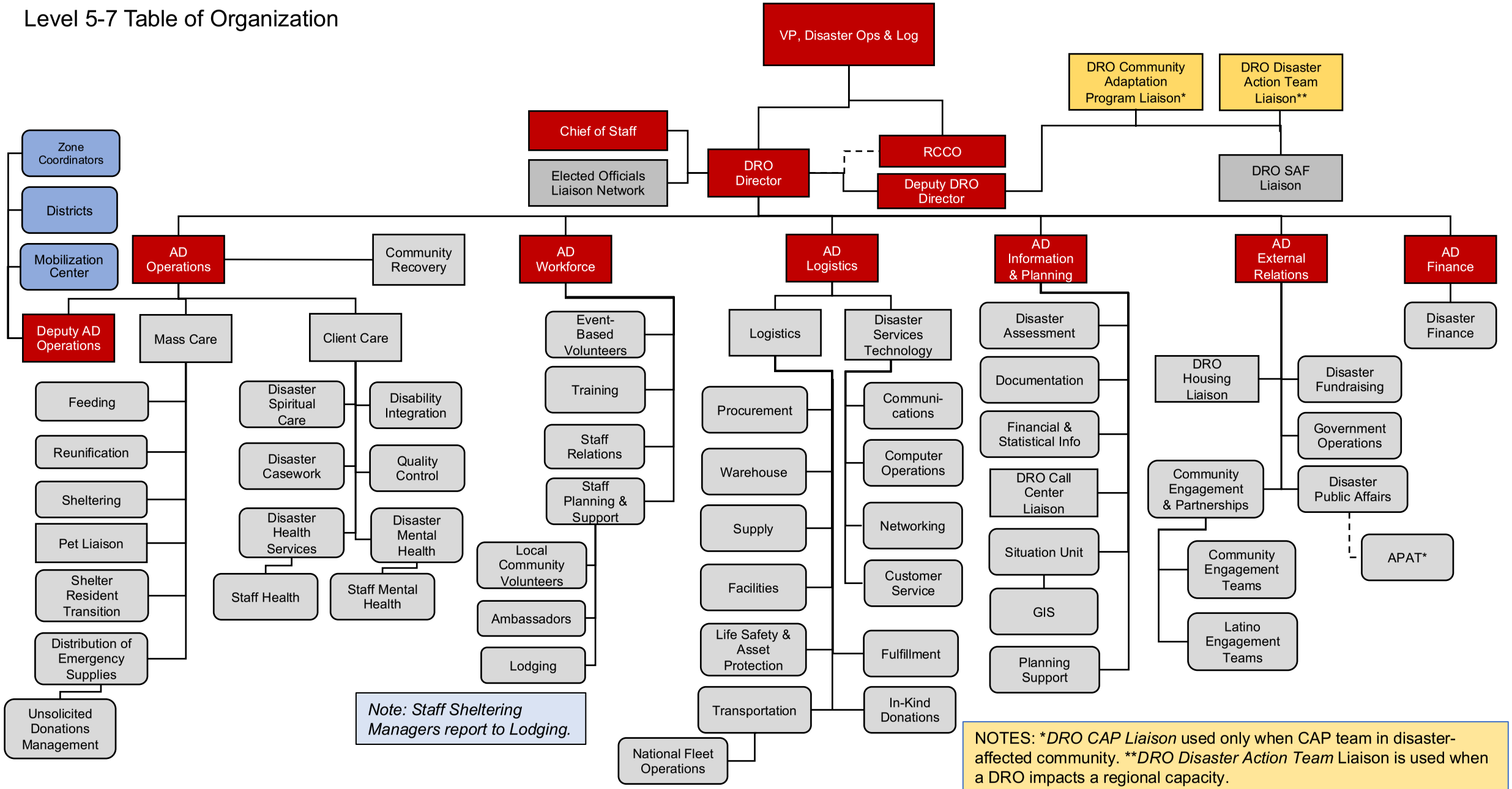
NOTES:

- *Public Affairs* and *Fundraising* are supported by the impacted region(s)
- DRO Call Center Liaison required if National Response Call Center stands up.

Level 4 Table of Organization



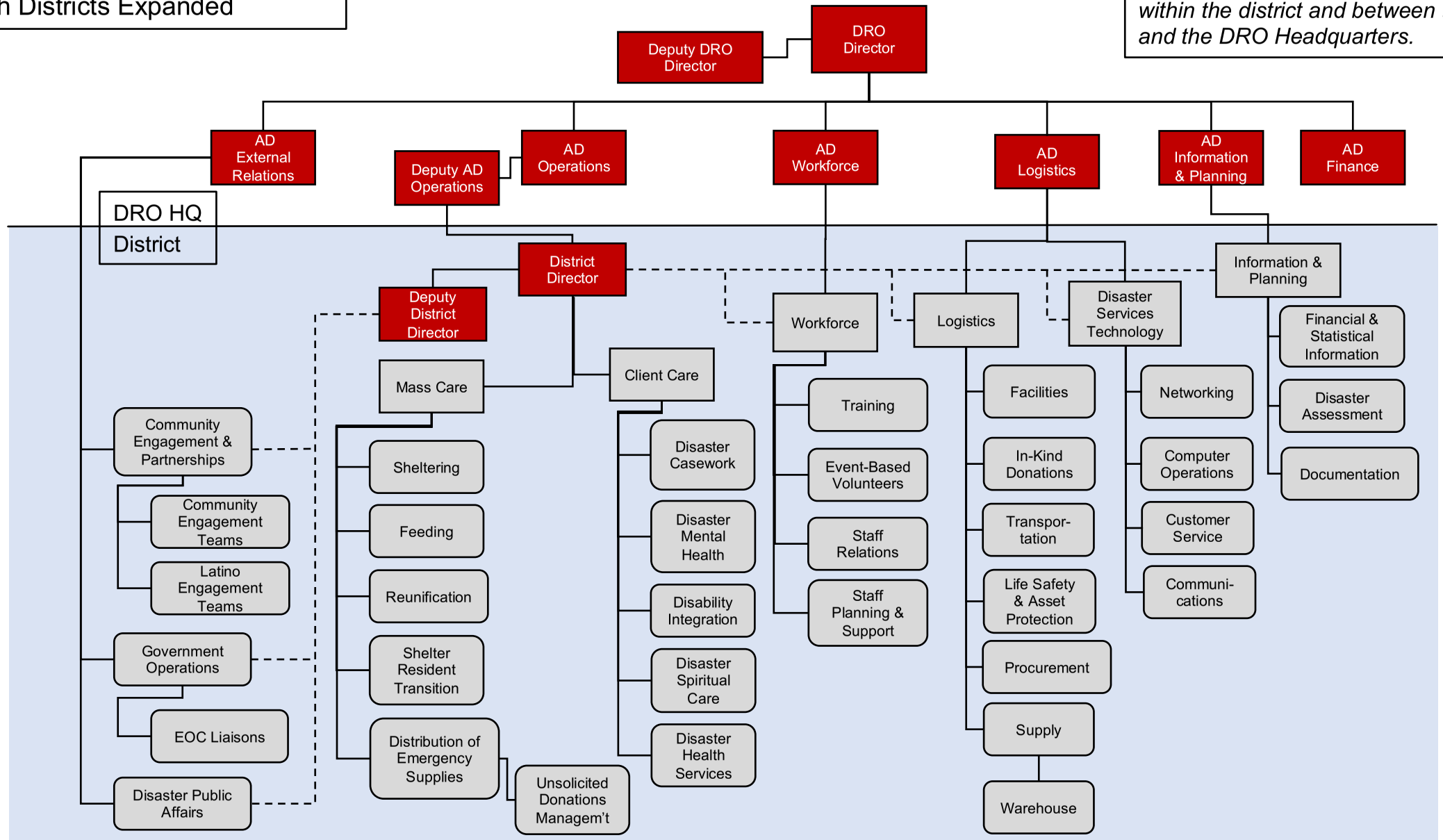
Level 5-7 Table of Organization



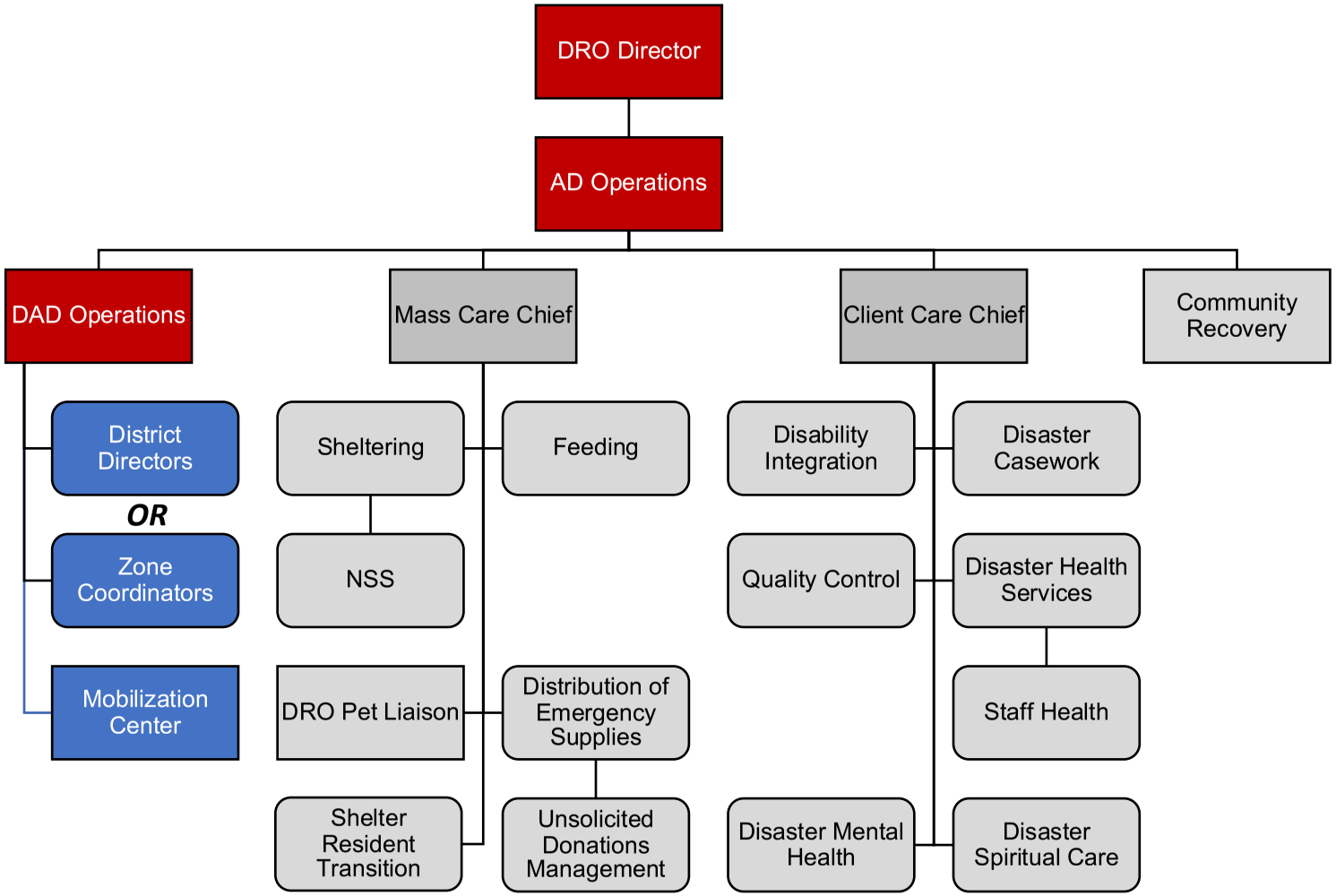
NOTES: **DRO CAP Liaison* used only when CAP team in disaster-affected community. ***DRO Disaster Action Team* Liaison is used when a DRO impacts a regional capacity.

Level 5-7 Table of Organization with Districts Expanded

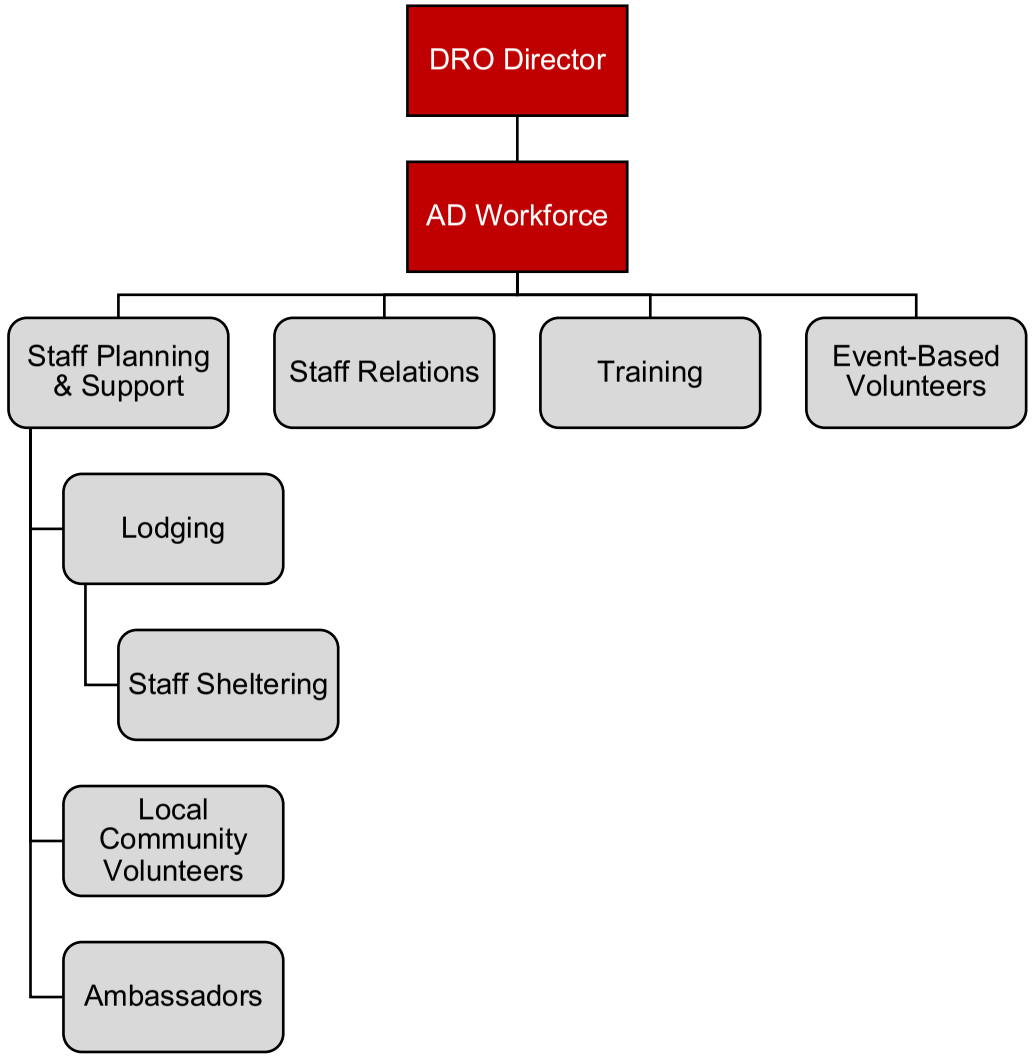
This figure illustrates reporting relationships within the district and between the district and the DRO Headquarters.



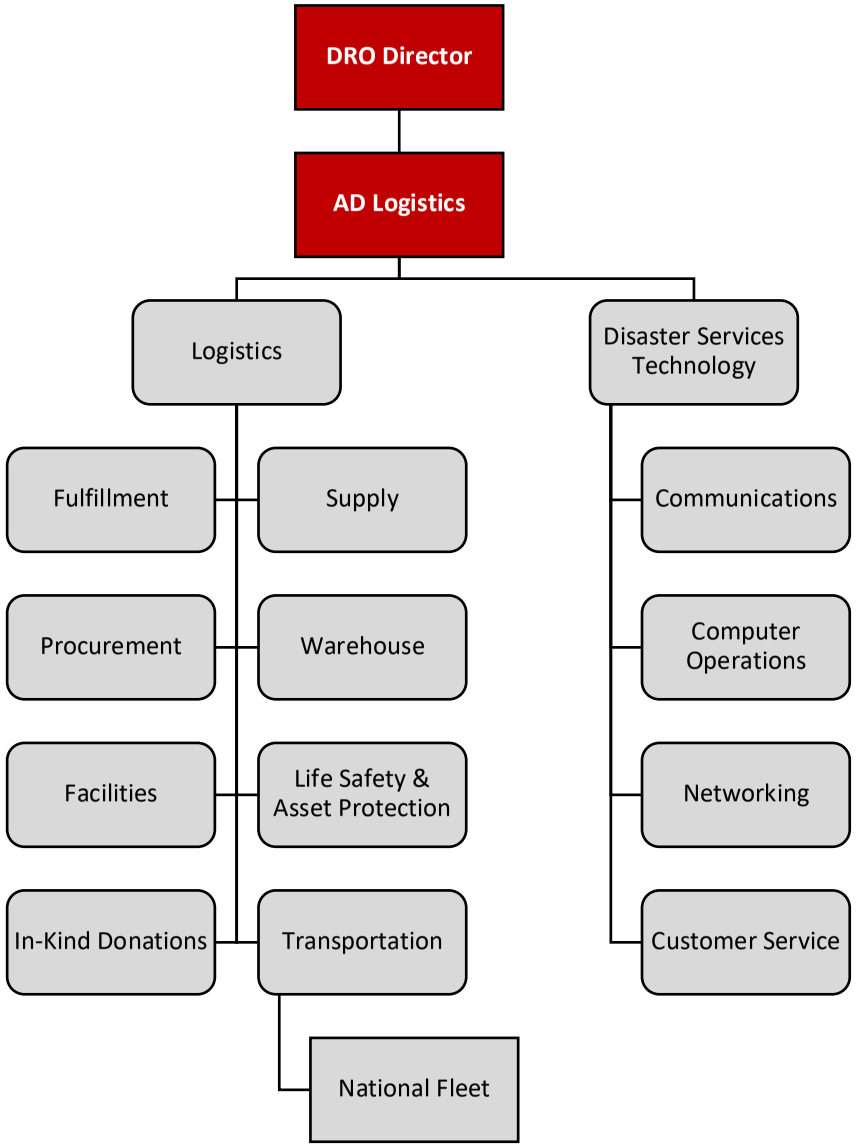
Operations Section



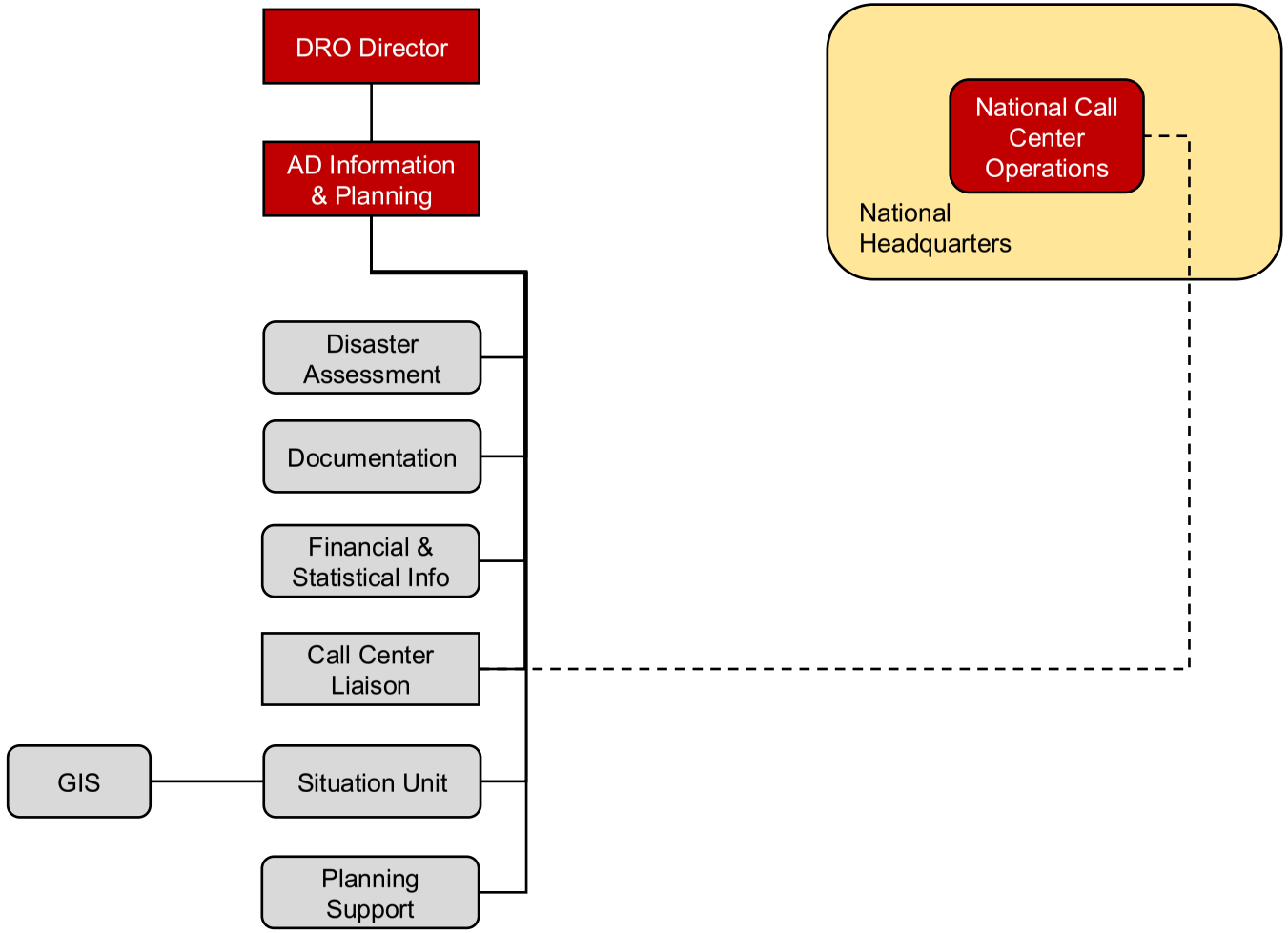
Workforce Section



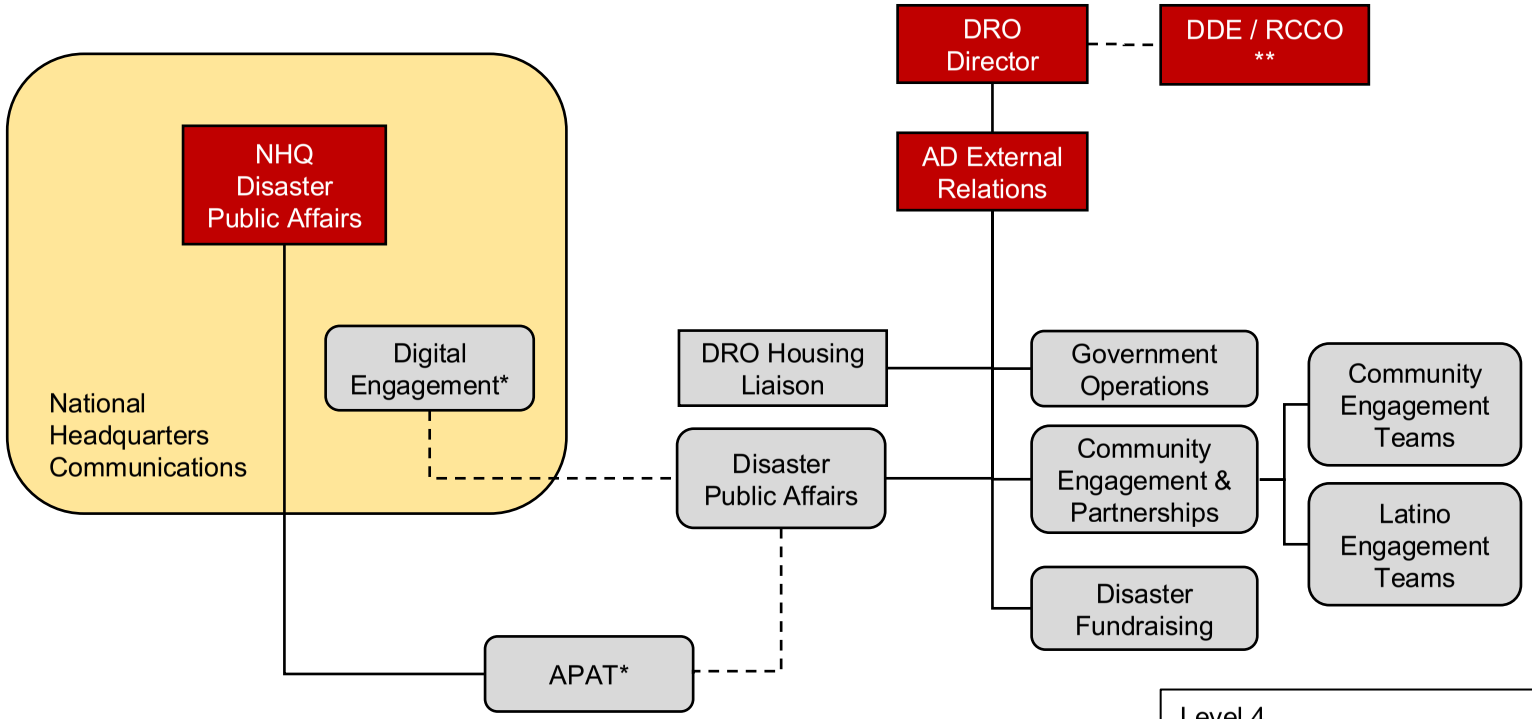
Logistics Section



Information & Planning Section



External Relations Section



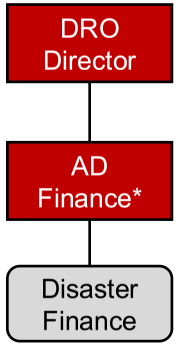
Level 4
* Digital Media / APAT direct line reporting to NHQ Disaster Public Affairs with lines of communication to Public Affairs on the operation
** Division Disaster Executive (DDE)

Public Affairs / Fundraising may be filled by people from steady-state table of organization performing collateral duty for the DRO.

Level 5-7
* Digital Media / APAT direct line reporting to NHQ Disaster Public Affairs with lines of communication to public affairs on the operation
** Red Cross Coordinating Officer (RCCO)

Public Affairs / Fundraising filled by DRO-assigned staff.

Finance Section



* Level 4 - Staffed virtually
Level 5-7 - Possibly staffed virtually

COMMAND

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	DRO Level	Reporting Lines	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reporting Lines
Command	**RCCO**	Red Cross Coordinating Officer	OM//RCCO	NA	Regional	N/A	**N/A**			
					Divisional	VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics				
					National	VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics				
Command	**Deputy RCCO**	Deputy Red Cross Coordinating Officer	OM//RCCO; OM//DIR; OM//DD	NA	All	Red Cross Coordinating Officer				
Command	**DRO Director**	DRO Director	OM//DIR; OM/DD	OM//DIR; OM/DD; OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	Regional	Regional Executive				
					Divisional	Division Disaster Executive				
					National	VP, Disaster Operations & Logistics				
Command	**Deputy DRO Director**	Deputy DRO Director	OM//DD; OM/GEN/MN	NA	All	DRO Director				
Command	**Chief of Staff**	Chief of Staff	OM//COS	NA	Divisonal	DRO Director				
					National					
Command	**EOLN**	Elected Officials Liaison Chief	OM//EOL	NA	All	DRO Director				
Section	**AD/ Deputy AD**	N/A								
Group	**HQ Chief**									
Activity	**HQ Manager**									
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**									

OPS: MASS CARE

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reports To:
Section	AD / Deputy AD	AD of Operations	OM/AD/OPS	MC/CH; MC/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	DRO Director	Director / Deputy	District Director	AD/OPS; OM/GEN/MN	Deputy AD Operations
		Deputy AD of Operations	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	AD Operations		Deputy District Director	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	District Director
		Zone Coordinator	OM/GEN/MN	NA	Deputy AD Operations				
Group	HQ Chief	HQ Mass Care Chief	MC/CH; MC/GEN/MN	NA	AD Operations		District Mass Care Lead	MC/ /CH; MC/GEN/MN	District Director
		HQ Asst Mass Care Chief	MC/CH; MC/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	HQ Mass Care Chief		District Assistant Mass Care Lead	MC/ /CH; MC/GEN/MN	District MC Lead
Activity	HQ Manager	HQ Sheltering Manager	MC/SH/MN	MC/SH/SV; OM/GEN/SV	HQ Mass Care Chief	District Coordinator	District Sheltering Coordinator	MC/SH/MN; MC/SH/SV; MC/GEN/MN	District MC Lead
		HQ Feeding Manager	MC/FF/MN; MC/FF/SV	MC/FF/SV; OM/GEN;SV	HQ Mass Care Chief		District Feeding Coordinator	MC/FF/MN; MC/FF/SV; MC/GEN/MN	District MC Lead
		HQ DES Manager	MC/DES/MN; MC/DES/SV; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ Mass Care Chief		District DES Coordinator	MC/DES/MN; MC/DES/SV; MC/GEN/MN	District MC Lead
		HQ Reunification Manager	MC/REU/MN; MC/REU/SV; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ Mass Care Chief		District Reunification Coordinator	MC/REU/MN; MC/REU/SV	District MC Lead
		HQ Shelter Resident Transition Manager	REC/CARE/SV with Shelter Resident Transition Management specialty track	NA	HQ Mass Care Chief		District SRT Coordinator	REC/CARE/SV with Shelter Resident Transition Caseworker speciality track	District MC Lead
		HQ Pet Liaison	MC/SH/SV; ER/GO/SV; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ Mass Care Chief				
Unit	HQ Coordinator	HQ UDM Coordinator	MC/DES/MN; MC/DES/SV; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ DES Manager	District Supervisor	District UDM Supervisor	MC/DES/MN; MC/DES/SV; MC/GEN/MN	District DES Coordinator
Site	Site Supervisor/ Liaison	Shelter Site Manager	MC/SH/MN; MC/GEN/MN; MC/SH/SV with MC Shelter Site Management specialty track	MC/SH/SV with MC Shelter Site Management specialty track	HQ Sheltering Manager	Site Supervisor/ Liaison	Shelter Manager/Site Supervisor	MC/SH/MN, MC/SH/SV (with specialty track)	District Sheltering Coordinator
							Shelter Assistant Manager/Site Supervisor	MC/SH/MN, MC/SH/SV (with specialty track)	Shelter Manager/Site Supervisor
		Shelter Resident Transition Supervisor	REC/CARE/SV with Shelter Resident Transition Management specialty track	NA	Shelter Manager/Site Supervisor		Shelter Resident Transition Supervisor	REC/CARE/SV with Shelter Resident Transition Management specialty track	Shelter Manager/Site Supervisor
		Kitchen Site Supervisor	MC/FF/MN, MC/FF/SV specialty track; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ Feeding Manager		Kitchen Site Supervisor	MC/FF/MN, MC/FF/SV specialty track; MC/GEN/MN	District Feeding Coordinator
		UDM Warehouse Site Supervisor	MC/DES/SV with UDM specialty track; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ UDM Coordinator		UDM Warehouse Site Supervisor	MC/DES/SV with UDM specialty track; MC/GEN/MN	District UDM Coordinator; District DES Coordinator if no UDM Coordinator
		DES Site Supervisor	MC/DES/SV; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ DES Manager		DES Site Supervisor	MC/DES/SV; MC/GEN;MN	District DES Coordinator
		Feeding Site Supervisor	MC/FF/SV; MC/GEN/MN	NA	HQ Feeding Manager		Feeding Site Supervisor	MC/FF/SV; MC/GEN/MN	District Feeding Coordinator
		Mobilization Center Supervisor	OM/GEN/MN	NA	Deputy AD Operations				

OPS: Client Care

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reports To:
SECTION	**AD / Deputy AD**	AD of Operations	OM/AD/OPS	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV; MC/CH; MC/GEN/MN	DRO Director	**Director / Deputy**	District Director	AD/OPS; OM/GEN/MN	Deputy AD Operations
							Deputy District Director	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	District Director
		Deputy AD of Operations	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	AD Operations	**District Lead**	District Client Care Lead	REC/CARE/MN IDC/DHS/MN IDC/DMH/MN IDC/DSC/MN	District Director
		Zone Coordinator	OM/GEN/MN	NA	Deputy AD Operations				
Group	**HQ Chief**	HQ Client Care Chief	CC//CH	NA	AD of Operations				
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Community Recovery Manager	REC/CMR/MN; REC/CMR/SV	NA	AD Operations	**District Coordinator**			
		HQ Disability Integration Manager	ICS/DI/MN; ICS/DI/SV	NA	HQ Client Care Chief		District Disability Integration Coordinator	IDC/DI/MN IDC/DI/SV	District Client Care Lead
		HQ Disaster Health Services Manager	IDC/DHS/MN	IDC/DHS/SV	HQ Client Care Chief		District Disaster Health Services Coordinator	IDC/DHS/MN: IDC/DHS/SV	District Client Care Lead
		HQ Disaster Mental Health Manager	IDC/DMH/MN	IDC/DMH/SV	HQ Client Care Chief		District Disaster Mental Health Coordinator	IDC/DMH/MN; IDC/DMH/SV	District Client Care Lead
		HQ Disaster Spiritual Care Manager	IDC/DSC/MN; IDC/DSC/SV	NA	HQ Client Care Chief		District Disaster Spiritual Care Coordinator	IDC/DSC/MN; IDC/DSC/SV	District Client Care Lead
		HQ Disaster Casework Manager	REC/CARE/MN	REC/CARE/SV	HQ Client Care Chief		District Disaster Casework Coordinator	REC/CARE/SV	District Client Care Lead
		HQ Quality Control Manager	REC/CARE/MN	NA	HQ Client Care Chief				
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**	HQ Integrated Care Condolence Team Coordinator	IDC/DHS/MN: IDC/DMH/MN; IDC/DSC/MN; REC/CARE/MN + specialty track	NA	HQ Client Care Chief	**District Supervisor (Unit)**	*No Units in the District*		
		HQ Disaster Casework Coordinator	REC/CARE/SV	NA	HQ Disaster Casework Manager				
Site	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	Individual Disaster Care Liaison	IDC/DHS/MN IDC/DMH/MN IDC/DSC/MN	NA	Family Assistance Center (FAC) Site Supervisor	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	None in Districts		
		Integrated Care Condolence Team Supervisor	IDC/DHS/MN; IDC/DHS/SV; IDC/DMH/MN; IDC/DMH/SV; IDC/DSC/MN; IDC/DSC/SV; REC/CARE/MN; REC/CARE/SV + specialty track	NA	HQ ICCT Coordinator				
		Disaster Casework Site Supervisor	REC/CARE/SV	REC/CARE/SV	HQ Disaster Casework Coordinator		Disaster Casework Site Supervisor	REC/CARE/SV	District Disaster Casework Coordinator

WORKFORCE

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reports To:
Section	**AD/ Deputy AD**	AD of Workforce	OM/WF/AD	SS/SPS/MN; SS/SPS/SV; OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	DRO Director	**N/A**			
		Deputy AD of Workforce	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	AD Workforce				
Group	**HQ Chief**	NA	NA	NA	NA	**District Lead**	District Workforce Lead	SS/GEN/MN; SS/SPS/MN; SS/SPS/SV	DRO HQ AD Workforce or Deputy
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Staff Planning & Support Manager	SS/GEN/MN, SS/SPS/MN	SS/SPS/SV	AD Workforce	**District Coordinator**	District Staff Planning & Support Coordinator	SS/GEN/MN; SS/SPS/MN; SS/SPS/SV	District Workforce Lead
		HQ Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Manager	SS/DEBV/MN	NA	AD Workforce		District Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Coordinator	SS/DEBV/MN; SS/DEBV/SV	District Workforce Lead
		HQ Training Manager	SS/TR/MN; SS/TR/SV	NA	AD Workforce		District Training Coordinator	SS/TR/MN; SS/TR/SV	District Workforce Lead
		HQ Staff Relations Manager	SS/SR/MN	NA	AD Workforce		District Staff Relations Coordinator	SS/SR/MN; SS/SR/SV	District Workforce Lead
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**	HQ Ambassador Coordinator	Any staffing GAP SS/SPS/SV, SS/SPS/SA	NA	HQ Staff Planning & Support Manager	**District Supervisor (Unit)**	District Staff Planning & Support Supervisor	SS/SPS/SV; SS/SPS/SA	District Staff Planning & Support Coordinator
		HQ Lodging Coordinator	SS/SPS/SV-SLDG, SS/SPS/SA-SLDG	SS/SPS/SV	HQ Staff Planning & Support Manager				
		HQ Local Community Volunteers Coordinator	SS/LCV/MN, SS/LCV/SV	NA	HQ Staff Planning & Support Manager				
Site	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	Staff Shelter Supervisor	MC/SH/SV	NA	HQ Lodging Coordinator	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	District Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Recruiter	SS/DEBV/SV	District DEBV Coordinator
		Volunteer Intake Center (VIC) Site Supervisor	SS/DEBV/SV	NA	HQ DEBV Manager		District Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Scheduler	SS/DEBV/SV	District DEBV Coordinator
		Staff In-Processing Center Training Supervisor	SS/TR/MN; SS/TR/SV	NA	HQ Training Manager		District Disaster Event-Based Volunteer Engagement	SS/DEBV/SV	District DEBV Coordinator
							District Disaster Event-Based Volunteer / Volunteer Connection	SS/DEBV/SV	District DEBV Coordinator

INFORMATION & PLANNING

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	EDRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Position Assignment Titles	GAPS	Reports To:
Section	**AD / Deputy AD**	AD Information & Planning	OM/IP/AD	IP/GEN/MN; IP/GEN/SV; OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	DRO Director	**N/A**			
		Deputy AD Information & Planning	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	AD Information & Planning				
Group	**HQ Chief**					**District Lead**	District Information & Planning Lead	IP/GEN/MN	AD Information & Planning
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Disaster Assessment Manager	IP/DA/MN	IP/DA/SV	AD Information & Planning	**District Coordinator**	District Disaster Assessment Coordinator	IP/DA/SV	District Information & Planning Lead
		HQ Financial & Statistical Information Manager	IP/GEN/MN + FSI speciality track	NA	AD Information & Planning		District Financial & Statistical Information Coordinator	IP/GEN/SV+ FSI specialty track	District Information & Planning Lead
		HQ Information Dissemination Manager	IP/GEN/MN; IP/GEN/SV	NA	AD Information & Planning				
		HQ Planning Support Manager	IP/GEN/MN; IP/GEN/SV + Advance Planner speciality track	NA	AD Information & Planning				
		HQ Call Center Support Manager	IP/GEN/MN; IP/GEN/SV	NA	AD Information & Planning				
		HQ Situation Unit Manager	IP/GEN/MN; IP/GEN/SV	NA	AD Information & Planning				
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**	HQ GIS Coordinator	IP/GEN/SV+ GIS Specialty Track	NA	AD Information & Planning	**District Supervisor (Unit)**	No units in district		
Site	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	No sites.				**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	No units in district		

LOGISTICS

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reports To:
Section	**AD/ Deputy AD**	AD of Logistics	OM/LOG/AD	LOG/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	DRO Director	**N/A**			
		Deputy AD of Logistics	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV;	NA	AD Logistics				
Group	**HQ Chief**	HQ Logistics Chief	LOG/CH; LOG/GEN/MN	NA	AD Logistics	**District Lead**	District Logistics Lead	LOG/GEN/MN; LOG/ /MN; LOG/ /SV	HQ Logistics Chief
		HQ Disaster Services Technology Chief	DST/CH, DST/MN	NA	AD Logistics		District Disaster Services Technology Lead	LOG/DST/CH; LOG/DST/MN; LOG/DST/SV	HQ Disaster Services Technology Chief
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Fulfillment Manager	LOG/FUL/MN	NA	AD Logistics	**District Supervisor (Unit)**	District Facilities Coordinator	*LOG/FAC/MN; LOG/FAC/SV*	District Logistics Lead
		HQ Facilities Manager	LOG/FAC/MN; LOG/FAC/SV	NA	HQ Logistics Chief				
		HQ Supply Manager	LOG/SUP/MN; LOG/SUP/SV	LOG/SUP/SV	HQ Logistics Chief		District Supply Coordinator	LOG/SUP/MN; LOG/SUP/SV;	District Logistics Lead
		HQ Procurement Manager	LOG/PRO/MN; LOG/PRO/SV	NA	HQ Logistics Chief		District Procurement Coordinator	LOG/PRO/MN; LOG/PRO/SV	District Logistics Lead
		HQ In-Kind Donations Manager	LOG/IKD/MN; LOG/IKD/SV	NA	HQ Logistics Chief		District In-Kind Donations Coordinator	LOG/IKD/MN; LOG/IKD/SV	District Logistics Lead
		HQ Transportation Manager	LOG/TRA/MN; LOG/TRA/SV	NA	HQ Logistics Chief		District Transportation Coordinator	LOG/TRA/MN; LOG/TRA/SV	District Logistics Lead
		HQ Life Safety & Asset Protection Manager	LOG/LSAP/MN; LOG/LSAP/SV	NA	HQ Logistics Chief		District Life Safety and Asset Protection Coordinator	LOG/LSAP/MN; LOG/LSAP/SV	District Logistics Lead
		HQ Warehousing Manager	LOG/WHS/MN; LOG/WHS/SV	NA	HQ Logistics Chief				
		HQ Computer Operations Manager	DST/CO/MN; DST/CO/SV	NA	Disaster Services Technology Chief		District Computer Operations Coordinator	DST/CO/MN; DST/CO/SV; DST/CO/SA	District Disaster Services Technology Lead
		HQ Disaster Services Technology Customer Service Manager	DST/CS/MN; DST/CS/SV	NA	Disaster Services Technology Chief		District Disaster Services Technology Customer Service Coordinator	DST/CS/MN; DST/CS/SV: DST/CS/SA	District Disaster Services Technology Lead
		HQ Disaster Services Technology Networking Manager	DST/NT/MN; DST/NT/SV	NA	Disaster Services Technology Chief		District Disaster Services Technology Networking Coordinator	DST/NT/MN; DST/NT/SV; DST/NT/SA	District Disaster Services Technology Lead
		HQ Disaster Services Technology Communications Manager	DST/CM/MN; DST/CM/SV	NA	Disaster Services Technology Chief		District Disaster Services Technology Communications Coordinator	DST/CM/MN; DST/CM/SV; DST/CM/SA	District Disaster Services Technology Lead
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**	NA				**Unit Supervisor**	No Units in District		
Site	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	Fulfillment Site Supervisor	LOG/FUL/SV	NA	HQ Fulfillment Manager				
		Warehouse Site Supervisor	LOG/WHS/MN, LOG/WHS/SV	NA	Reports to HQ Supply Manager	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	District Warehouse Supervisor	LOG/WHS/MN, LOG/WHS/SV	District Supply Lead

ER: GOVERNMENT OPERATIONS

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reports To:
Section	**AD/ Deputy AD**	AD of External Relations	OM/ER/AD	OM/GEN/SV; ER/GO/MN; ER/CEP/MN	DRO Director	**N/A**			
		Deputy AD of External Relations	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	AD External Relations				
Group	**HQ Chief**					**District Lead**	**N/A**		
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Government Operations Manager	ER/GO/CH; ER/GO/MN	NA	AD of External Relations or Deputy AD of External Relations	**District Coordinator**	District Government Operations Coordinator	ER/GO/MN; ER/GO/SV	HQ Government Operations Manager
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**					**District Supervisor (Unit)**	N/A		
Site	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	State EOC Liaison	ER/GO/SV	ER/GO/SV	HQ Government Operations Manager	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	Local EOC Liaison	ER/GO/SA	District Government Operations Coordinator
		JFSOC Liaison	ER/GO/MN; ER/GO/SV	NA	Report to HQ Gov Ops Manager				
		JFO Liaison	ER/GO/MN; ER/GO/SV	NA	HQ Government Operations Manage				
		NRCC Liaison**	ER/GO/MN; ER/GO/SV	NA	**Report to DOCC Government Operations				
		RRCC Liaison**	ER/GO/MN; ER/GO/SV	NA	**Report to DOCC Government Operations				
		Local EOC Liaison	ER/GO/SA	ER/GO/SA	HQ Government Operations Manager				

ER: COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT & PARTNERSHIPS

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reports To:
Section	**AD/ Deputy AD**	AD of External Relations	OM/ER/AD	OM/GEN/SV; ER/GO/MN; ER/CEP/MN	DRO Director	**N/A**			
		Deputy AD of External Relations	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	Deputy DRO Director				
Group	**HQ Chief**					**District Lead**	N/A		
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Community Engagement & Partnership Manager	ER/CEP/CH; ER/CEP/MN	NA	AD of External Relations	**District Coordinator**	District Community Engagement & Partnerships Coordinator	ER/CEP/SV	HQ Community Engagement & Partnerships Manager
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**	HQ Community Engagement Coordinator	ER/CEP/MN; ER/CEP/SV	NA	HQ Community Engagement & Partnerships Manager				
		HQ Partnership Coordinator	ER/CEP/MN; ER/CEP/SV	NA	HQ Community Engagement & Partnerships Manager	**District Supervisor (Unit)**	N/A		
Site	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	Latino Engagement Liaison	ER/CEP/MN + Latino Engagement specialty track; ER/CEP/SV + Latino Engagement specialty track	NA	HQ Community Engagement Coordinator	**Site Supervisor/ Liaison**	Community Engagement Team Supervisor	ER/CEP/SV	District Community Engagement & Partnerships Coordinator
							Latino Engagement Team Supervisor	ER/CEP/SV+ Latino Engagement Speciality Track	District Community Engagement & Partnerships Coordinator

ER: PUBLIC AFFAIRS

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP	Reports To:
Section	**AD/ Deputy AD**	AD of External Relations	OM/ER/AD	OM/GEN/SV; ER/GO/MN; ER/CEP/MN	DRO Director	**N/A**			
		Deputy AD of External Relations	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	AD of External Relations				
Group	**HQ Chief**					**District Lead**	No Leads in District		
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Disaster Public Affairs Manager	ER/PA/CH | ER/PA/MN	Provided by regional steady state staff	HQ Disaster Public Affairs Chief	**District Coordinator**	No Coordinators in District		
Unit	**HQ Coordinator**	N/A				**District Supervisor (Unit)**	District Public Affairs Supervisor	ER/PA/MN |ER/PA/SV	HQ Disaster Public Affairs Manager

ER: FUNDRAISING

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reports To:	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP
Section	**AD/ Deputy AD**	AD of External Relations	OM/AD/ER	OM/GEN/SV; ER/GO/MN; ER/CEP/MN	DRO Director	**Not in District**		
		Deputy AD of External Relations	OM/GEN/MN; OM/GEN/SV	NA	AD External Relations			
Group	**HQ Chief**							
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Fundraising Manager	ER/FR/MN; ER/FR/SV	Provided by regional steady-state staff	AD External Relations			
Unit	N/A							
Site	N/A							

FINANCE

Red Cross Function Name	DRO HQ Assignments	DRO HQ Position Assignment Titles	GAP to Fill Assignment	GAP Level 2 Only	Reporting Lines	District Assignments	District Office Position Assignment Titles	GAP
Section	**AD**	AD of Finance	OM/FIN/AD	Provided by regional steady-state staff	DRO Director	**Not in District**		
Activity	**HQ Manager**	HQ Finance Manager	FIN/GEN/MN		AD Finance			
Unit	N/A							
Site	N/A							